“十二五”普通高等教育本科国家级规划教材

NEW HORIZON COLLEGE ENGLISH 第四版 FOURTH EDITION

新视野大学英语

总主编：郑树棠

读写教程 4

READING AND WRITING

思政智慧版

外语教学与研究出版社
FOREIGN LANGUAGE TEACHING AND RESEARCH PRESS

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前　言

党的二十大擘画了全面建成社会主义现代化强国、实现第二个百年奋斗目标的宏伟蓝图，指明了以中国式现代化全面推进中华民族伟大复兴的发展道路，从“实施科教兴国战略，强化现代化建设人才支撑”的高度，将教育、科技、人才进行统筹部署，并指出以高水平对外开放推动高质量发展，构建人类命运共同体。

面对新形势与新要求，我国高等教育必须全面贯彻党的教育方针，坚持为党育人、为国育才，全面提高人才培养质量，才能开拓教育新局面。作为高等教育的重要组成部分，大学外语教育应与时俱进，立足我国现代化发展全局，深化改革、探索创新，扎根中国、融通中外，为党和国家培养更多高层次国际化人才，讲好中国故事，传播好中国声音，为引领中国更好走向世界、世界更好了解中国作出新贡献。《新视野大学英语》（第四版）系列教材正是在这样的时代背景下设计编写而成。

《新视野大学英语》是一套根据国家高等教育教学质量要求和改革精神、针对全国普通高等院校非英语专业学生编写的通用英语教材。自 2001 年首次出版以来，以其独到的教学理念、创新的教学模式得到高校师生的广泛好评。为服务新时代国家战略发展需求，《新视野大学英语》编写团队认真学习最新政策文件，广泛收集教材使用反馈，持续进行系统的修订与完善。《新视野大学英语》（第四版）在继承原有特色的基础上，深入落实课程思政，全面优化教材设计，深度融合先进技术，进一步提升教材的思想性、科学性与时代性，体现我国高等外语教育发展的新趋势与新要求。

编写依据

《新视野大学英语》（第四版）以党的二十大精神为引领，以新时期高等外语教育改革和人才培养方向为指导，参照最新政策文件要求，通过先进的教学理念、科学的教学设计、数智化的教学手段，全方位支持大学英语教学，助推中国式教育现代化。

在教学目标上体现课程思政，落实立德树人根本任务

培养什么人、怎样培养人、为谁培养人是教育的根本问题。育人的根本在于立德。第四版教材全面贯彻党的教育方针，以落实立德树人根本任务为核心指导思想，深入践行《高等学校课程思政建设指导纲要》，内容设计寓价值塑造于知识传授和能力培养之中，致力于培养德智体美劳全面发展、堪当民族复兴大任的社会主义建设者和接班人。

在教学内容上实现工具性与人文性有机结合

第四版教材充分体现大学英语教育兼具工具性和人文性的特点，依据《大学英语教学指南（2020 版）》“基础目标”和“提高目标”的教学要求进行设计，有机衔接《普通高中英语课程标准》和《中国英语能力等级量表》。教材编写遵循语言学习规律，着力培养学生英语听、说、读、写、译等语言技能，全面提高语言综合应用能力。同时，通过主题丰富、视角多元、语料真实的选材以及生动多样的活动设计，帮助学生在探索世界的过程中传递中国声音，提高跨文化交际能力和思辨能力，实现综合发展。

在教学理念上体现“以教师为主导、以学生为主体”

第四版教材依据“以教师为主导、以学生为主体”的教学理念，结合当代大学生的心理特征、学习特点与教师的教学需求，设计讨论式、探究式、项目式等学习活动，提供科学实用、深入浅出的策略讲解。上述设计既有利于学生锤炼语言、提升能力，进行自主学习和合作学习，也便于教师灵活指导，有效组织教学，启发学生深度思考，使教学活动真正调动“教”和“学”的双向主动性与积极性。

在教学模式上依托先进技术重构数智教学新生态

第四版教材依托全新升级的“U 校园智慧教学云平台 3.0”（以下简称“U 校园 3.0”），为教、学、测、评、研提供一站式教学解决方案。通过科学智能的教学管理平台、高效便捷的备授课工具、丰富立体的教学资源与无缝对接的多终端支持，推动院校更新教学理念、创新教学模式、重构教学流程，加快数字化转型；帮助教师将课内课外、线上线下有机结合，优化教学流程，丰富教学设计，同步开展教学研究，实现教研相长。灵活多样的学习资源满足学生在多模态环境下的个性化学习需求，优化学习体验，实现智慧学习。

教材特色

价值引领，深化课程思政

教材从主题设定、素材选择和活动设计等方面入手，全方位融入党的二十大精神与社会主义核心价值观，弘扬正能量，深化爱国主义、集体主义、社会主义教育，将价值塑造、知识传授和能力培养融为一体，以润物无声的方式帮助学生提升政治觉悟、思想水平、道德修养，树立正确的世界观、人生观、价值观，成为担当民族复兴大任的时代新人。

选材丰富，彰显中国文化

话题选材强调经典性、时代性与趣味性的结合，使学生在学习语言的同时，开阔视野、了解世界，探索人与自我、人与社会、人与自然的关系。教材多维度彰显中国文化，将社会主义先进文化、革命文化和中华优秀传统文化有机融入到选材、练习活动与单元任务中；不同分册还专设特色板块，集中呈现中国相关内容，帮助学生坚定文化自信，厚植爱国情怀。

因材施教，促进全面发展

在对大学生英语水平和大学英语教学现状广泛调研的基础上，教材优化主题内容，合理调整难度梯度，满足不同水平学生需求，同时注重培养多元能力，系统提升练习活动的丰富性、应用性与思想性。一方面，遵循语言学习的内在规律，提高常用词汇的覆盖率与复现率，确保语言技能讲解与训练环环相扣，既提供单项技能训练，夯实基础语言能力，也设置综合语言运用活动，引导学以致用。另一方面，活动设计注重思维培养，通过批判性问题启发学生深度思考、进行跨文化反思，通过场景真实的产出任务培养学生讲好中国故事以及解决实际问题的能力。

数智创新，赋能智慧教学

教材充分体现信息化时代的最新技术变革，通过完善的服务体系、先进的数字平台、优质的线上资源，智能驱动外语教学创新模式、提质增效。U 校园 3.0 实现升级迭代，完善备课功能，实现教学课件、试题库与其他教学资源的有效融通；优化授课与测评功能，提供灵活多样的授课工具与智能测评手段，多维度收集学生学习数据，支持完善的全景化数据分析，实现教评研一体化发展。教材还配备数字课程、微课视频、随身学、“外研 U 词”小程序和伴学数字人等丰富的学习资源与工具，助力学生主动学习、个性化学习，创新学习模式，提升学习效果。

教材构成

《新视野大学英语》（第四版）系列教材包含 1—4 级，供两个学年使用。每一级别包含《读写教程》（配教师用书）、《视听说教程》（配教师用书）、《综合训练》和《长篇阅读》。教材提供教学管理平台、数字课程、微课视频、移动学习应用、教学课件、试题库等立体丰富的教学资源。不同课程、不同媒介资源之间紧密联系，互为补充，共同构建立体化、个性化教学环境。

《读写教程》以价值塑造为导向，以夯实语言基础为核心，提供角度多元、内涵丰富的选篇以及循序渐进的练习活动，在着重提高学生读、写、译能力的同时，坚定理想信念，锤炼思维品质。新增 Stories of China 板块，集中展现中国在经济、社会、文化、科技与生态文明建设等方面的成就，培养家国情怀，提升民族自豪感。

《视听说教程》改编自培生教育出版集团的经典教材 *Speakout*，视听资源生动地道，文化信息丰富，交际场景真实，帮助学生在轻松愉快的学习氛围中提升听说能力和跨文化交际能力。特别增设 Listening to China 板块，引导学生讲好中国故事，传播好中国声音。

《综合训练》与《读写教程》紧密相联，对标学业考试最新要求，提供相关词汇、语法、阅读、翻译和写作等方面的练习，形式多样、可操作性强，助力学生巩固语言知识，提高语言能力。

《长篇阅读》通过科学训练，帮助学生掌握阅读策略，提高在快速阅读中获取、理解关键信息的能力。每单元新增一篇中国选篇，引导学生在阅读中了解中国，在思考中融贯中西。

使用建议

《新视野大学英语》(第四版)遵循“分类指导、因材施教”的原则，设置不同级别与不同分册，配备丰富立体的教学资源，为各校教学提供广阔的选择空间。第四版教材的编写基于对全国高校大学生英语水平和大学英语教学情况的调研，起点词汇约为3200词。覆盖的词汇有大学通用英语阶段应该掌握的词汇，尤其是搭配能力强、词义多重、使用面广的词汇，也有与学生专业学习或未来工作密切相关的词汇。中学阶段已经学过的重要词汇在教材中也有复现和巩固，体现语言学习必要的重复和循环。

认真学习《新视野大学英语》(第四版)1—3级，能够达到通用英语阶段的“基础目标”教学要求；学习1—4级，能够达到通用英语阶段的“提高目标”教学要求。院校可根据人才培养目标、课程设置方案以及学生起点水平，对教材进行个性化选择和灵活搭配。教师也可根据不同的教学目标和课时情况，自主选择教学材料、教学方法和教学模式，落实有效教学。

编写团队

《新视野大学英语》(第四版)教材总主编为上海交通大学郑树棠教授。来自上海交通大学、同济大学、中国人民大学、西北工业大学、郑州大学等全国数十所高校的几十名专家学者和中青年骨干教师参与了系列教材的设计与编写。

自本世纪初第一版出版以来，《新视野大学英语》始终不忘初心，担当使命，服务国家战略需求与高校外语教育发展。《新视野大学英语》(第四版)诞生于全面建设社会主义现代化强国的关键时期，教材坚持正确政治方向，落实立德树人根本任务，体现思想性与科学性相统一，力争更好地服务新时代高校大学英语教学改革创新，为广大师生打开新思路、开启新视野。欢迎各位专家、教师和同学在审阅与使用教材的过程中，多提宝贵意见，以使教材不断更新与完善。

编写及使用说明

《读写教程》是《新视野大学英语》（第四版）系列教材的主干教材之一。本教程充分考虑新时期国家人才需求以及当代大学生的学习特点和兴趣，以《大学英语教学指南（2020 版）》为指导，对接《中国英语能力等级量表》，充分融合先进信息技术，帮助学生在夯实语言综合运用能力的基础上，锤炼道德品质和思维能力，落实立德树人根本任务。

编写重点

本教程在秉承第三版教材特色的基础上，对原有内容结构进行全面优化和调整，篇幅上适当减少，质量上进一步提升，整体设计更贴近当前大学英语教学改革需求。本次编写重点如下：

融合课程思政要求，落实立德树人

教材全方位、多维度融入党的二十大精神和社会主义核心价值观等关键议题。单元开篇即点明单元蕴含的思政要素，提炼并阐述选篇蕴含的价值观念和精神内涵，如爱国、富强、敬业、和谐、友善等。同时，教材将价值塑造有机融于话题素材、练习设计、思辨论点、单元任务之中，在润物细无声中达到立德树人的目的。

凸显中华文化元素，充满时代气息

教材在保留原有优秀内容的基础上，新增多个全新话题与选篇，生动体现当今时代发展与文明进步，特别反映中国在经济、社会、文化、科技与生态文明建设等方面的最新成就。每册均有数篇课文与中国紧密相关，涉及航天成就、英雄人物、智慧城市、新时代青年等。每单元单设阅读板块 Stories of China，集中讲述中国故事，帮助学生增强文化自信，厚植家国情怀。

合理调整教材内容，设计循序渐进

根据语言难度和认知规律，重新编排各册话题与选篇，调整阅读、写作、构词等技巧讲解的顺序和详略程度，确保梯度呈螺旋式上升。同时，语言练习和单元任务设计等紧贴学习需求，注重搭建脚手架，在夯实语言基础的同时，引导学生举一反三、学以致用，提高语言综合应用能力。

技术深度赋能教学，创新教学模式

对教材内容、教学平台和资源进行一体化设计，打造纸质教材与数字产品深度融合的新形态。基于 U 校园 3.0，实现线上教学管理、课堂互动、智能评测、大数据分析等功能，推动教学提质增效。数字课程突出思政育人与思辨培养，提供丰富的微课视频与相关练习，实现价值观培养与语言能力提升。“外研 U 词”小程序为学生提供移动单词学习工具，支持随时随地背单词，拓展学习空间，提升学习成就感。

单元结构

《读写教程》设置 1—4 级，每级包含 6 个单元。每单元内容围绕特定主题展开，层层深入。单元结构具体如下：

Quotation

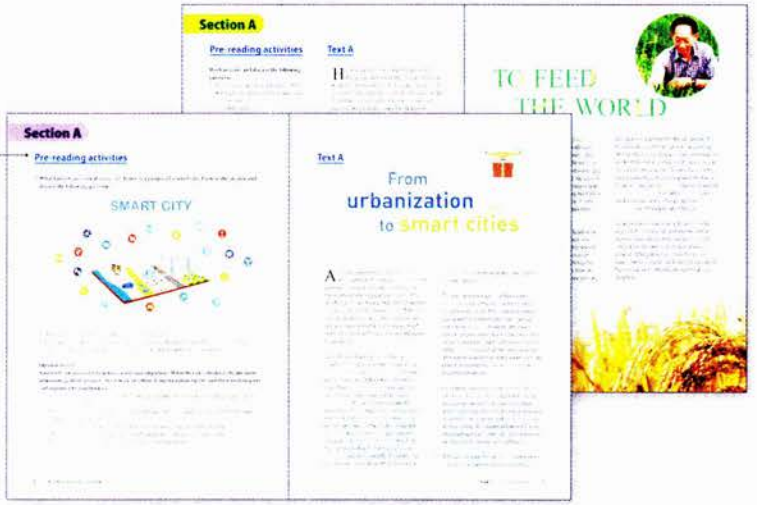
精选与单元主题相关的中外名言警句，凸显主题内涵。

Preview

由一段简洁生动的文字引出单元主题，点明单元蕴含的思政要素，同时以启发式的问题激发学生学习兴趣和深入思考。

Section A

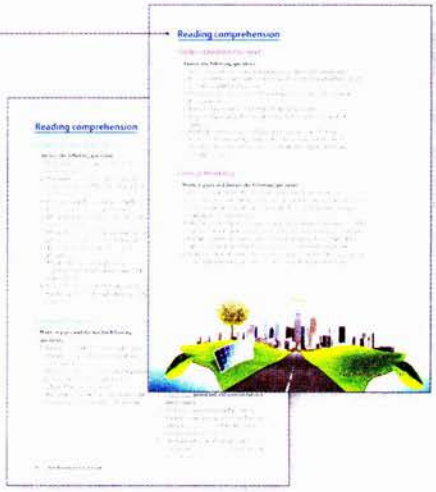
单元主要学习板块，包括一篇课文（Text A）、写作技巧讲解和相关练习。



Pre-reading activities

通过听力理解、图片讨论、调研问卷、信息匹配等生动有趣的活动，引出文章主题和思政要素，激活知识储备，为深入学习文章做好铺垫。

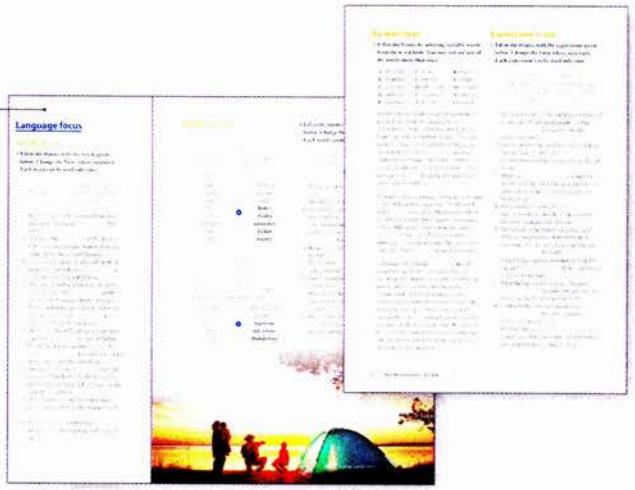
Reading comprehension



- Understanding the text 通过问答题的形式，剖析文章大意、重要细节以及作者写作手法、写作意图等深层信息，帮助学生由浅入深地领悟课文，全方位提高阅读理解能力。
- Critical thinking 围绕课文设置开放式问题，引导学生就主题内容和思政要素进行延伸讨论，培养探究能力和思辨能力。

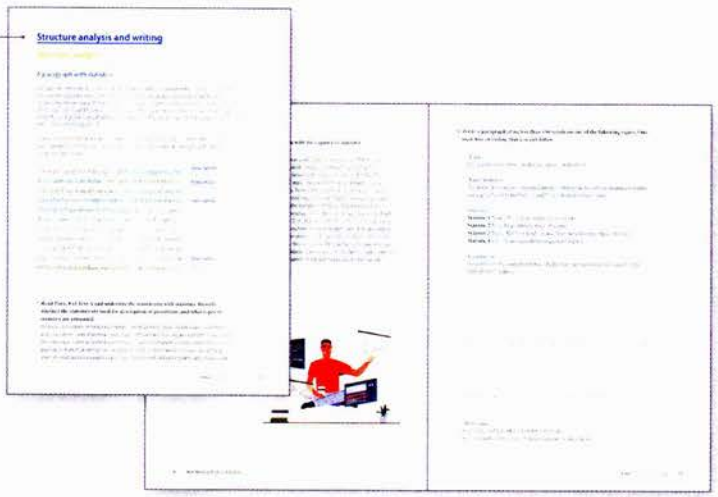
Language focus

包括 Words in use、Word building、Banked cloze 和 Expressions in use。从词、句、篇章入手，通过多样的语言练习加强学生对核心词汇的理解和运用，并提供词汇学习策略指导，帮助学生掌握构词法，扩展词汇量。



Structure analysis and writing

包括 Structure analysis（结构分析）和 Structured writing（基于结构分析的写作练习），两部分互为依托，相辅相成。结构分析以 Text A 为范例，分析典型段落或篇章的结构特点；写作练习基于结构分析，辅以提纲和范文，训练和培养学生完成段落或篇章写作的能力。

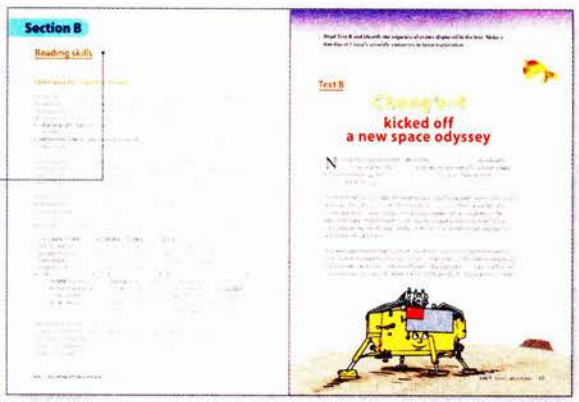


Section B

提供一篇课文（Text B）、阅读技巧讲解和相关练习。

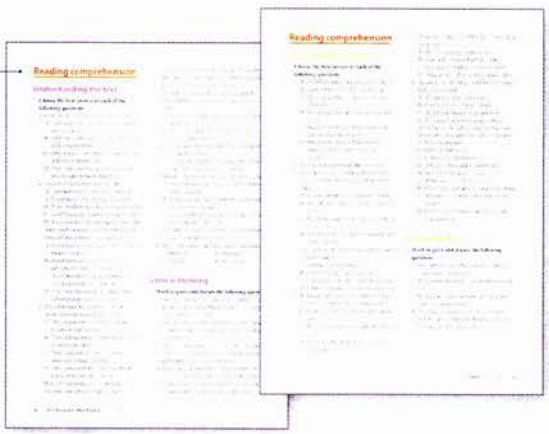
Reading skills

以 Text A 为实例详细阐述阅读技巧，并通过 Text B 落实应用，侧重培养阅读技巧和策略，讲练结合，有效提升阅读能力。



Reading comprehension

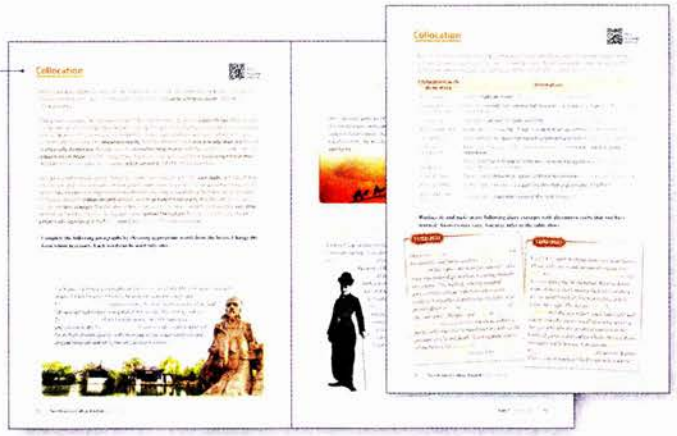
- Understanding the text 配合相关语言阅读能力测试，设置单项选择题，帮助学生对课文进行不同层次内容的理解。
- Critical thinking 同 Text A 相应部分。



Collocation

选取与主题相关的语篇素材，通过课文重点搭配讲解以及配套练习，帮助学生掌握核心、通用词汇的常用搭配，提高语言实际运用能力。

此外，学生可扫描二维码，在线上进行更多补充语言练习，加强对核心词汇、句型及语法点的训练。



Section C

集中呈现中国相关内容，包括一篇阅读短篇和一道翻译练习。

Stories of China

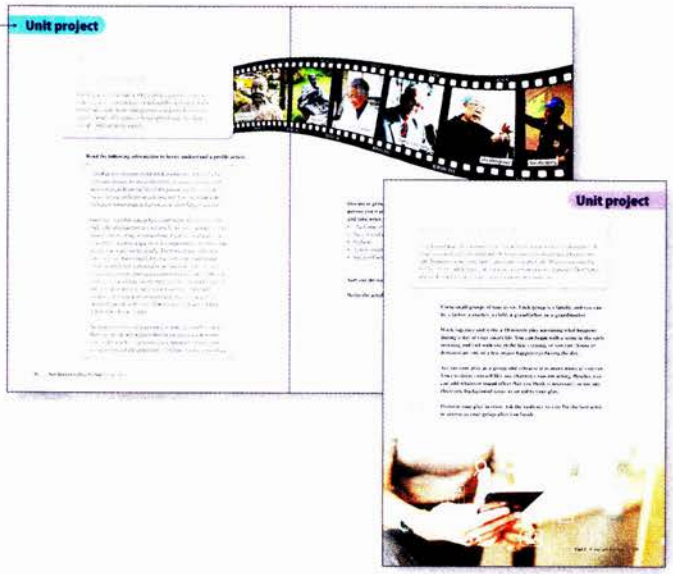
提供一篇中国内容的阅读短篇。题材生动时新、文本类型多样，既注重呈现新时代中国社会的发展成就和人民的精神风貌，如航空航天、清洁能源、乡村振兴等，也大力弘扬包括五四精神、京剧文化等在内的革命文化和中华优秀传统文化。学生可扫描二维码进行线上练习，领悟中国智慧，坚定文化自信。

Translation

翻译内容聚焦中国文化。1—2 级为句子翻译，各句之间主题相关，帮助学生提高对同类主题内容的翻译能力；3—4 级为段落翻译，确保难度循序渐进，切实提高学生的翻译和文化沟通能力。

Unit project

依据单元主题，设计口头汇报、写作、短剧等形式多样的综合性语言任务，特别加大中国情境下的交际任务比重。基于真实的情境设计、清晰的步骤指导，引导学生通过调研、信息搜索、讨论等方式完成交际任务，在培养创新思维、沟通能力和合作意识的同时，提高讲好中国故事、传播好中国声音的能力。



数字课程

《新视野大学英语》（第四版）数字课程依托 U 校园 3.0，将自主学习、课堂教学与数字技术深度结合。通过微课视频、补充练习等丰富的学习资源，以及在线交互式课件、智能评阅引擎等全新升级的教学工具，全方位提升学习体验和教学效果，支持师生合力打造智慧课堂，开展智慧教学。

打造优质微课视频，纸数深度融合

提供优质的微课视频，包括单元导学、思政讲解和思辨指导三类，与纸质教材有机结合、相互支持。通过形式活泼、内容实用的讲解以及练习，导入单元话题，解读思政育人元素，传递中华文化思想精髓，同时进行正向思辨指导，培养学生正确分析、评价信息与观点的思维能力。

提供全新教学工具，提升教学效果

教学云平台新增在线交互式课件，教师可直接编辑并生成个性化在线教学课件，教学课件与平台的课中互动功能深度融合，创设师生高效互动、便捷协作的智慧课堂。数字课程引入写作智能评阅引擎，丰富评价方式，帮助教师高效检查作业，掌握学习动态，提升教学效果。

拓展学习模式与内容，推动自主学习

打造伴随学生学习的专属数字人“子言”，创设数字人导学、伴学、促学模式，为学生自主学习提供全流程指导，增强沉浸式学习的体验感。同时，通过设置词汇卡学习、补充拓展练习活动、提供单元测试题目，延展学习内容，构建以学生为中心的语言学习环境，推动学生自主学习。

《新视野大学英语》系列教材一贯秉承“以教师为主导、以学生为主体”的教学理念，为广大师生提供高质量、体系化、多类型的数字教育资源与工具。各校教师可结合实际教学需求，有选择地使用相关资源或工具，开展混合式教学，实现线上线下融合互动，以此推动课堂教学模式更新，有效提升教学效果，落实课程思政建设。

以下为《读写教程》数字课程单元结构示意图，以及混合式教学模式使用建议，供各校教师在教学实践中参考：

线上
学生在U校园观看单元导学微课，提前熟悉单元内容，激发学习兴趣
Unit preview
单元导学微课
Section A
线上
学生在U校园完成读前导入练习、交互式课文和词汇学习，并通过思政讲解微课及配套练习，初步理解思政元素
教师可在后台查看学生自主学习数据，掌握预习情况，为课堂教学作准备
Reading the text
Pre-reading activities 读前导入练习
Reading in detail 交互式课文学习
Chinese view 思政讲解微课及练习
Vocabulary learning 词汇卡学习
Reading comprehension
Understanding the text 课文理解练习
Critical thinking 思辨指导微课及练习
线下
教师课上讲解、剖析Text A重难点，启发学生进行深入讨论。同时可结合微课讲解思政要素、进行思辨指导，并引导学生完成相关练习
线上
学生在U校园完成语言练习
Language focus
教材配套语言练习
线上
学生在U校园学习结构分析讲解、完成写作任务，并通过写作智能评阅引擎，进行自动评分
教师可在后台查看智能评阅数据，了解学生写作的薄弱环节
Structure analysis and writing
Structure analysis 结构分析讲解
Structured writing 写作范文及练习
线下
教师课上进一步讲解结构分析及写作技巧，展示引擎评阅情况，并讲评学生作文
Section B
Reading skills
阅读技巧讲解与练习
线下
教师课上讲解阅读技巧，并引导学生完成练习
线上
学生在U校园完成交互式课文学习和词汇学习
Reading the text
Reading in detail 交互式课文学习
Vocabulary learning 词汇卡学习
Reading comprehension
Understanding the text 课文理解练习
Critical thinking 思辨练习
线下
教师课上组织学生完成Text B的理解练习和思辨练习
线上
学生在U校园完成语言练习和词汇搭配练习
Language focus
补充语言练习
Collocation
词汇搭配讲解与练习

编写团队

《新视野大学英语》（第四版）系列教材总主编为上海交通大学郑树棠教授。

《新视野大学英语（第四版）读写教程 4》主编为赵晓红和苗瑞琴。参加编写的人员有赵晓红、苗瑞琴、王冬燕、李琤。

《新视野大学英语（第四版）读写教程 4》由郑树棠教授审定全稿。

Map of the book

Unit	Section A		Section B
	Text A	Structure analysis and writing	Reading skills
1 **Urban development** *p2*	From urbanization to smart cities *p5*	Writing an expository essay *p15*	Skimming *p18*
2 **Secrets to beauty** *p30*	Making the choice to be truly beautiful *p33*	Using parallelism in essay writing *p43*	Identifying the topic sentence *p46*
3 **Business success in the new age** *p60*	China's new wave of young innovators *p63*	Using supporting details in an expository essay *p72*	Finding out word meanings *p76*
4 **Man and nature** *p90*	Save the earth, save life *p93*	Rebutting counter-arguments in argumentative essay writing *p102*	Reading between the lines *p106*
5 **Passion guides life choices** *p118*	A meaningful life *p120*	Writing a personal narrative *p129*	Understanding figurative language *p132*
6 **Energy and food crises** *p146*	The coming energy crisis *p149*	Writing a cause-and-effect essay *p159*	Identifying the author's purpose *p162*

	Section C	Unit project
Text B	Stories of China	
Embrace the trend of deurbanization *p18*	Limited space, unlimited growth *p27*	Role-playing: Living in a smart city *p29*
The exploration of beauty *p48*	A beautiful heart that has made a difference *p57*	Discovering and enhancing your inner beauty *p59*
Culture makes the business world go round *p78*	The rise of modern entrepreneurship in China *p87*	Sharing an innovative product idea *p89*
What nature is telling you *p107*	A green finish line *p115*	Writing a report on college students' awareness of environmental protection *p117*
A turning point in my life *p133*	Passion and dedication have propelled China's space science to new heights *p143*	Talking about a person who has made a difference in your community *p145*
A worldwide food crisis? *p164*	An important milestone in China's solar energy development *p173*	Raising college students' consciousness of conserving energy and food *p175*

Unit 1

Urban development

City plans must fit the people, not the other way round!

— Jane Jacobs
(*American-Canadian urbanologist and writer*)

Preview

Over the past decades, China's tremendous economic growth has enabled the country to become the world's second largest economy and to eliminate absolute poverty. To **build a modern socialist country in all respects**, China is now striving for **high-quality development**. With more and more people expected to live in cities in the future, Chinese cities are facing increasing challenges in infrastructure and public resources, but they also see significant opportunities for **promoting economic development and urban livability**.

How can cities host growing populations while keeping the urban space safe and clean? How can the authorities use data technology to address traditional urban challenges around transportation, waste management, energy consumption, health care, etc.? How can local governments and technology companies work together to make cities more efficient and climate-friendly? Our efforts to answer these questions innovatively will determine how our cities can be better-designed and how people will live more happily in the future.

Section A

Pre-reading activities

1 What kind of city is ideal to live in? Below is a picture of a smart city. Look at the picture and discuss the following questions.

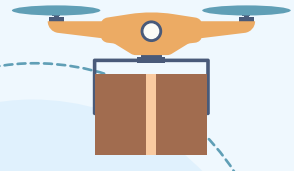
1 What can you learn about a smart city from the picture?
2 Compared with the ideas of a smart city in the picture, do you consider the city you are living in now a smart one? In what ways is it already smart, and in what ways is it still not?

2 Opinion survey

Smart city projects seek to achieve some core objectives. What do you consider to be the most important goals of a smart city? Check (✔) three from the following list, and then work in pairs and explain why you think so.

- ☐ A Efficiency of services – to optimize the use of public resources and provide a high level of service to citizens
- ☐ B Safety & security – to improve public safety and security in everyday life and be best prepared for possible emergencies
- ☐ C Mobility – to make it easy for citizens and visitors to move around in the city
- ☐ D Sustainability – to develop the city with a minimum impact on the environment
- ☐ E City reputation – to improve the city's image and reputation

Text A



From urbanization to smart cities

1 As China is transitioning to a **modernized** nation and has become a **benchmark** of economic progress, the rate of urbanization has accelerated to unparalleled levels. The population living in cities has been projected to increase to nearly 70 percent by 2050. In fact, urbanization is reshaping not only the physical environment but also the cultural fabric of society and has a massive impact on the economy.

2 Nevertheless, the model of urban life mainly revolved around the technological, **demographic**, and **infrastructural** needs of life in the late 20th century. As such, it has been **predominantly** dependent on the abundance and easy availability of **fossil fuels**. We can appreciate that this dependence has caused a waste of resources and has made a **devastating** impact on the environment and public health. It has led to **excess** and waste-**prone** development that proves to be **detrimental**. Therefore, the traditional model of urbanization is **outdated** and unsustainable. Currently, the only way to avoid the problem from being **escalated** is through building "smart cities", in contemporary **jargon**.

3 The idea of smart cities – infrastructure **interlinked** by software – isn't new, but it's undeniably cool. Who wouldn't want to live somewhere where data and evidence, rather than **intuitive** thinking, are used to actively improve their day-to-day lives? In a sense, a smart city can be defined as one that makes **optimal** use of all the interconnected information available to better understand and control its operations and to **optimize** the use of limited resources.

4 From the perspective of the **inhabitants**, a smart city is **equated** to a space that has all the core functionality of a city integrated with and enhanced by technology to deliver a sustainable, prosperous, and **inclusive** future for its citizens. With more and more Chinese cities starting their "smart city" transformations, the idea will be increasingly embraced.

5 Why can such an idea be **poised** to become a common standard of assessment of life

in modern developed cities? There are a variety of factors and reasons. Generally speaking, cities are the core engines of growth for all modern societies. They provide numerous benefits to people – they are places where people have more opportunities to seek various jobs, enjoy the convenience of public **transit**, share abundant resources, and access **lavish** facilities.

6 Another important reason is the swift rise of smartphones, **cellular** broadband, and low-power-high-efficiency embedded **computing**. Everything from business to human social life has changed. The **parameters** of what **constitutes** a smart city have also changed with it. With the combination of the Internet of Things (IoT), cloud computing, big data, and AI, cities are no longer static masses of steel and **concrete**; instead, they have the potential to become highly efficient, safe, well-designed, and enjoyable.

7 Therefore, some key features of a smart city can be efficient design, maximization of green spaces, minimization of traffic jams, sustainability of infrastructure and buildings, in-depth monitoring of every data point that can be obtained through **sensors** to enable optimal safety, and effective access to facilities with **minimal** waste. In addition, when an emergency occurs anywhere in the city, regular traffic can be routed through alternate routes to ensure minimum disruption of life in the surrounding areas.

8 In other words, what is being imagined about smart cities now is based on such a **hypothesis**: Living places are built around the convenience of human life, with technology integrated into every facet from design to construction, monitoring functionality, and maintenance. Entire urban areas are built to maximize green areas and ensure the smoothest flow of traffic. As a result, it is possible to fine-tune operation to the minutest detail.

9 To elaborate, if a fire breaks out in a building, not only can the inhabitants be immediately **alerted** through their smartphones, but they can also be directed to

the nearest exits and safe spaces. Furthermore, the message of the incident will be **instantaneously** conveyed throughout the system, and thus the building's safety measures can be implemented right away. On top of that, emergency search and rescue services can be **dispatched** within a moment's notice, and their path through traffic can be cleared and an optimal route provided.

10 The possibilities for similar improvements and enhancements in all aspects of urban life are immense. However, neither **tangible** nor **intangible** improvements to the quality of life are just within grasp, as many large cities are becoming unmanageable. The goal, ultimately, is to rid cities of the traditional problems and create **fabulous** living spaces where the inhabitants feel safe, comfortable, and productive without unnecessary or undesirable **hurdles**.

11 To that end, China has been investing billions in designing and defining the standards of the future, from 5G technology to IoT, striving to **evoke** the best response from the public for its remarkable projects. Foreseeably, this will benefit not only China, but also the world.

12 China's southern city of Shenzhen has been one of the pioneering cities seeking to build a smart city. Another remarkable step on the nation's development roadmap is the massive Jing-Jin-Ji (namely Beijing-Tianjin-Hebei) urban cluster, which aims to optimize the economic structure in the area, **streamline** many aspects of urban life, and achieve a new **mode** of coordinated growth. All this will be invaluable for future urban design, since development in the coming years and decades will be modeled on the results achieved now. There is no doubt that China will continue to advance in the development of smart cities.

(*897 words*)

Shenzhen, China

New words

▲ **urbanization** /ˌɜːbənaɪˈzeɪʃən/ *n.* [U] the process by which towns and cities grow bigger and more and more people go to live in them 城市化

▲ **modernize** /ˈmɒdənaɪz/
vt. make sth. such as a system or building more modern 使（系统、建筑物等）现代化
vi. start using more modern methods and equipment 采用现代方法和设备；现代化

benchmark /ˈbentʃmɑːk/ *n.* [C] sth. that is used as a standard by which other things can be judged or measured 基准；规范

demographic /ˌdeməˈgræfɪk/
a. relating to human populations and the information collected about them, such as their size, growth, ages, and education 人口的；人口统计的；人口学的
n. (**~s**) [pl.] information about a group such as the people who live in a particular area 人口统计数据；人口统计资料

▲ **infrastructure** /ˈɪnfrəˌstrʌktʃə/ *n.* [C, U] the basic systems and structures that a country or organization needs in order to work properly, e.g. roads, railways, banks 基础设施（如公路、铁路、银行等）；基础结构

infrastructural /ˈɪnfrəˌstrʌktʃ(ə)rəl/ *a.* connected with infrastructure 基础设施的；基础结构的

predominant /prɪˈdɒmɪnənt/ *a.* more powerful, more common, or more easily noticed than others 占优势的；占主导地位的；显著的

predominantly /prɪˈdɒmənəntli/ *ad.* mostly or mainly 绝大多数地；主要地

▲ **fossil** /ˈfɒsəl/ *n.* [C] 化石

fossil fuel *n.* [C, U] 矿物燃料（如煤、石油等）

devastating /ˈdevəsteɪtɪŋ/ *a.*
1 badly damaging or destroying sth. 毁灭性的；破坏力极强的
2 causing severe shock 令人十分震惊的；具有强大冲击力的

▲ **excess**
a. /ˈekses/ (*only before noun*) additional and not needed because there is already enough of sth. 过多的；多余的
n. /ɪkˈses/ [sing., U] a larger amount of sth. than is allowed or needed 过多；过量

prone /prəʊn/ *a.* likely to do sth. or suffer from sth., esp. sth. bad or harmful 易于发生某事（尤指不好或有害的事）的；很可能…的

detrimental /ˌdetrəˈmentl/ *a.* causing harm or damage 有害的；不利的

▲ **outdated** /ˌaʊtˈdeɪtɪd/ *a.* old and no longer suitable for modern purposes, methods, or situations 过时的；陈旧的

escalate /ˈeskəleɪt/ *v.* become much worse or more serious, or make sth. do this （使）升级；（使）恶化

jargon /ˈdʒɑːgən/ *n.* [U] words and expressions used in a particular profession or by a particular group of people, which are difficult for other people to understand 术语；行话

interlink /ˌɪntəˈlɪŋk/ *v.* connect or be connected with each other （使）相互连接

intuitive /ɪnˈtjuːətɪv/ *a.*
1 based on a feeling rather than on knowledge or facts 直觉的；来自直觉的
2 able to understand situations without being told or having any proof about them 有直觉力的

optimal /ˈɒptəməl/ *a.* (*fml.*) the best or most suitable 最佳的；最适宜的

optimize /ˈɒptəmaɪz/ *vt.* improve the way that sth. is done or used so that it is as effective as

注：标▲单词为四级词，未做标记单词为六级词，斜体单词为超纲词。

possible 使最优化；使尽可能完善

▲ **inhabitant** /ɪnˈhæbɪtənt/ *n.* [C] one of the people who live in a particular place 居民

equate /ɪˈkweɪt/ *vt.* consider that two things are similar or connected 使等同

▲ **inclusive** /ɪnˈkluːsɪv/ *a.*
1 including a wide variety of people, things, etc. 包容广阔的；范围广的
2 having the total cost contained in the price （价钱或费用）包括一切的

poised /pɔɪzd/ *a.*
1 (*not before noun*) completely ready to do sth. or for sth. to happen 准备好的；准备就绪的
2 behaving in a calm, confident way, and able to control your feelings and reactions 镇定的；自信的；沉着的

▲ **transit** /ˈtrænsɪt / *n.* [U]
1 a system for moving people from place to place 交通运输系统
2 the process of moving goods or people from one place to another （货物或人的）运输

lavish /ˈlævɪʃ/
a. 1 large in quantity and expensive or impressive 大量的；昂贵的；使人印象深刻的
2 very generous 慷慨的；大方的
vt. give sb. or sth. a lot of love, praise, money, etc. 慷慨给予

cellular /ˈseljələ/ *a.*
1 working by using a network of radio stations to send signals instead of by a wire 蜂窝状的；蜂窝式的
2 consisting of or relating to the cells of plants or animals 由细胞组成的；细胞的

computing /kəmˈpjuːtɪŋ/ *n.* [U] the activity or skill of using computers or programming computers 计算机使用；计算机技能；计算机编程

parameter /pəˈræmɪtə/ *n.* [C, usu. pl.] factors or limits which affect the way that sth. can be done or made 参数；界限；范围

▲ **constitute** /ˈkɒnstɪtjuːt/ *linking verb*
1 form or make sth. 形成；构成；组成
2 be considered to be sth. 被视为；被算作

▲ **concrete** /ˈkɒŋkriːt/
n. [U] 混凝土
a. 1 made of concrete 混凝土的
2 definite and specific 具体的

▲ **sensor** /ˈsensə/ *n.* [C] a piece of equipment used for discovering the presence of light, heat, movement, etc.（探测光、热、活动等的）传感器，感应装置

▲ **minimal** /ˈmɪnəməl/ *a.* very small in degree or amount, esp. the smallest degree or amount possible 极小的；极少的；（尤指）最小的，最少的

hypothesis /haɪˈpɒθəsɪs/ *n.* [C] an idea that is suggested as an explanation for sth., but that has not yet been proved to be true 假设；假说

▲ **alert** /əˈlɜːt/
vt. officially warn sb. about a problem or danger so that they are ready to deal with it 使警觉；向…发出警报
a. 1 giving all your attention to what is happening, being said, etc. 警惕的；警觉的
2 able to think quickly and clearly 机警的；机敏的

▲ **instantaneous** /ˌɪnstənˈteɪniəs/ *a.* happening immediately 即刻的；即时的

instantaneously /ˌɪnstənˈteɪniəsli/ *ad.* 即刻地；即时地

dispatch /dɪˈspætʃ/
vt. (*fml.*) send sb. or sth. somewhere for a particular purpose 派遣；发送
n. 1 [sing.] the act of sending people or things to a particular place 派遣；发送
2 [C] a message sent between military or government officials （军官或政府官员之间来往的）公文，信件

▲ **tangible** /ˈtændʒəbəl/ *a.*

1 able to be touched or felt 可触摸的；可触知的；有形的

2 clear enough or definite enough to be easily seen or noticed 确凿的；明显的；实在的

▲ **intangible** /ɪnˈtændʒəbəl/ *a.*

1 not able to be touched or measured, and difficult to describe or explain 触摸不到的；难以捉摸的；不易形容的

2 (of a business asset) that has no physical existence（企业资产）无形的

fabulous /ˈfæbjələs/ *a.*

1 extremely good or impressive 极好的；绝妙的

2 (*only before noun*) very large in amount or size 巨额的；巨大的

hurdle /ˈhɜːdl/

n. [C] 1 a problem or difficulty that you must deal with before you can achieve sth. 障碍；困难

2 one of a series of small fences that a person or horse has to jump over during a race（跨栏赛跑或马术比赛中用的）栏架

v. jump over sth. while you are running（跑步过程中）跨越

evoke /ɪˈvəʊk/ *vt.* produce a strong feeling or memory in sb. 引起，唤起（强烈的感情或回忆）

streamline /ˈstriːmlaɪn/ *vt.*

1 make sth. such as a business, organization, etc. work more simply and effectively 精简（企业、组织等）使效率更高

2 form sth. into a smooth shape, so that it moves easily through the air or water 使…成为流线型

▲ **mode** /məʊd/ *n.* [C]

1 (*fml.*) a particular way or style of behaving, living, or doing sth. 方式；方法；做法

2 a particular way in which a machine or piece of equipment can operate（机器、设备的）运行方式，状态，模式

Phrases and expressions

be projected to do sth. be forecasted to happen in a certain way 预计要

define sth. as describe or label sth. as sth. 把…定义为；把…描述为

equate sth. to / with sth. consider sth. as equal or equivalent to sth. else 认为某物与另一事物相等或相仿

integrate (sth.) with / into sth. combine sth. in such a way that it becomes fully a part of sth. else（将某事物）与另一事物结合成为一体

be poised to do sth. be ready to take action at any moment 准备好做某事；准备行动

on top of sth. in addition to sth. 除…之外

within / at a moment's notice within a short period of time 立刻；马上

within (one's) grasp able to be obtained or achieved by sb. 在（某人）掌握之中的；触手可及的

rid sth. / sb. of sth. take action so that a person, place, etc. is no longer affected by sth. bad or no longer has it 使摆脱掉；使除掉

to that end (*fml.*) for that reason; in order to achieve that goal 为此；鉴于此；为达此目标

be modeled on be designed in a way that copies another system or way of doing sth. 模仿；效仿；仿制

Proper names

Internet of Things 物联网

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

1 Answer the following questions.

1 Why is the traditional model of urbanization outdated and unsustainable?
2 Why can smart city development be a solution to the traditional problems faced by cities according to Paras. 3-4?
3 Why can the idea of smart cities be a standard for assessing life in modern developed cities?
4 What are the key features of a smart city according to Para. 7?
5 What specific example does the author give to illustrate the operation of a smart city?
6 What is the ultimate goal of building smart cities according to the text?
7 What has China been doing to realize the ultimate goal of smart cities?
8 What does the phrase "on the nation's development roadmap" in the last paragraph suggest?

Critical thinking

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 How do you understand the significance of China building smart cities?
2 To enable urban sustainability in a smart city, city managers try to monitor various things in real time through using embedded IoT sensors. Can you give a few examples to illustrate this point?
3 There are likely to be many challenges with the development of a smart city. What challenges do you think may have to be addressed while developing a smart city?
4 Building a smart city requires a lot of preparation and careful planning. What steps do you think should be followed in deciding on a smart city project?
5 A city can't be built smart unless its citizens are ready to participate. How should we as individuals engage ourselves actively in the development of smart cities?

Language focus

Words in use

3 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

detrimental escalate evoke hurdle
hypothesis instantaneous lavish
poised streamline tangible

1 With your generous support, our charity fund will be _____ for continued growth and success for many years to come.
2 The dock was constructed on a(n) _____ scale with the most modern equipment, designed to enable rapid loading and discharge of vessels.
3 Advances in mobile phone technology have enabled the rapid development of _____ communication, such as instant messaging and voice chatting.
4 Computers, vehicles, paintings, furniture, etc. are all _____ assets that are characterized by their movability.
5 Students are a fairly adaptable community and their strength lies in their teamwork along with the ability to overcome _____ together.
6 For the convenience of drivers, China rolled out digital driver's licenses across the country amid efforts to _____ services.
7 Studies have shown that long-term confinement is _____ to the physical and psychological well-being of animals.
8 The new museum is designed in a manner to _____ the interest of children and young adults in science and technology.
9 This study was conducted to test the _____ that exposure to urban air pollution contributes to the development of chronic lung diseases.
10 If your stress is _____ into more serious issues, you should reach out to a licensed professional to get a treatment plan that will help you.

Word building

-cy

与某些形容词结合构成名词，表示形容词所描述的状态或性质。形容词末尾的 t 或 te 被替换为 cy，但 t 偶尔也被保留。

fluent	>	fluency
frequent		frequency
private		privacy
bankrupt		**bankruptcy**
delicate		**delicacy**
secret		**secrecy**
urgent		**urgency**
vacant		**vacancy**

-ic

与某些名词结合构成形容词，表示与名词所指的事物相似或相关。

artist	>	artistic
irony		ironic
symbol		symbolic
atmosphere		**atmospheric**
geography		**geographic**
idiom		**idiomatic**
microscope		**microscopic**

注：粗体单词为本单元新学派生词。

4 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

atmospheric bankruptcy delicacy
geographic idiomatic microscopic
secrecy urgency vacancy

1 The fall in demand for new cars could cause a wave of _____ in the car retail business.
2 The transport sector is trying to curb _____ pollution in urban areas, by setting traffic restrictions and promoting public transport.
3 When it comes to Sichuan cuisine, I feel very excited because there are so many local _____ I'd like to try.
4 When your customers receive an email, the _____ of opening it often depends on the message that is written in the subject line.
5 Slang terms and _____ expressions often create confusion for the learners of a foreign language.
6 Not limited by time and _____ location, online courses provide an excellent opportunity for people to learn new skills.
7 With our powerful job search tools, you can find job _____ that meet your exact requirements.
8 Because of the use of sophisticated technology and the need for _____, nicknames have been given to such equipment.
9 Scientists wanted to examine the internal structures of the virus, but previous _____ studies provided information on only the surface features.

Banked cloze

5 Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

A affordable
B capability
C demand
D disputable
E disrupt
F embedded
G enhance
H escalation
I exceeds
J modernized
K optimal
L proceeds
M streamlining
N sustainability
O undermining

Cities are getting smarter every day, so are their transit options. One emerging option is autonomous vehicles (AVs), or simply cars with self-driving 1) _____. However, as experts say, before we enter a reality where AVs are 2) _____ into our daily lives, we will see the continued rise of electric vehicles (EVs) all over the world.

Besides saving costs for consumers, EVs can bring many 3) _____ benefits to the environment because they use electricity instead of gas to drive their wheels. Many large cities are trying to encourage the use of EVs by installing public charging stations throughout the city and 4) _____ the vehicle registration process. At the same time, many automakers are working to 5) _____ the charging speed of EVs and to make EVs more 6) _____.

As the use of EVs rises, greater 7) _____ will be placed on the power industry. In some areas where energy resources are stressed already, the increasing use of EVs could well 8) _____ the electrical supply system.

EVs can also impact urban planning. Thus, consideration of commute options, location of charging stations, and open data should be part of a city's future mobility plans. It is important for automakers to partner with urban planners

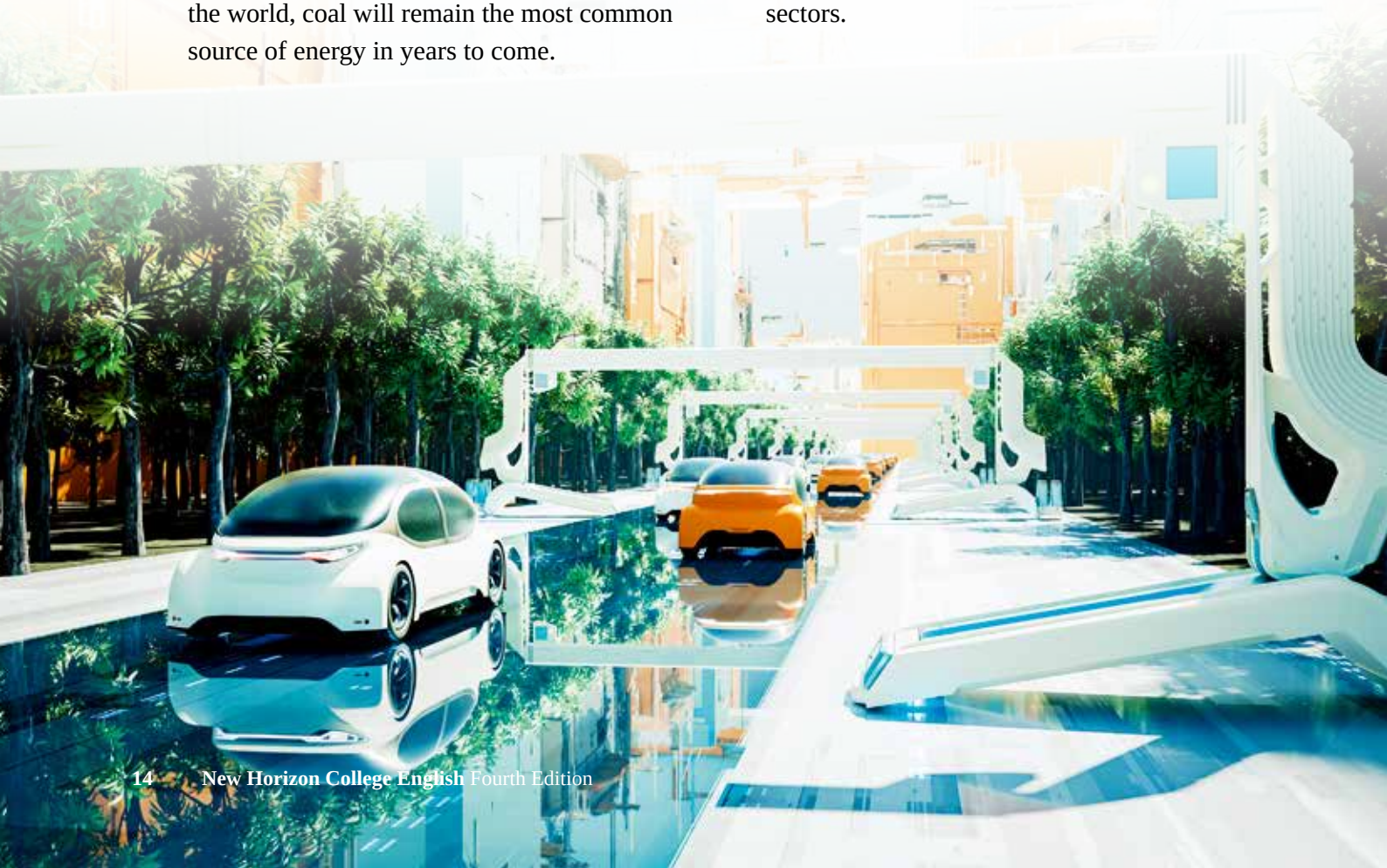
and utility companies to provide 9) _____ experiences for consumers and residents. Imagine one day a driverless EV picks you up and drops you off, and then 10) _____ to the location of the next passenger without ever stopping to recharge because of wireless power transfer from nearby energy sources. The technology is on the way, but we need to wait for our cities and energy industry to get ready as well.

Expressions in use

6 Fill in the blanks with the expressions given below. Change the form where necessary. Each expression can be used only once.

be modeled on be projected to
equate ... to on top of rid ... of
to that end within a moment's notice
within one's grasp

1 While the energy market share for coal _____ decline in many parts of the world, coal will remain the most common source of energy in years to come.
2 After many years of hard work and struggle, the kind of lifestyle he has always wanted to live is _____.
3 Since AI-driven machines _____ the human brain, they are built to imitate our behavioral patterns.
4 After a change to a low-fat diet, Dennis was able to _____ himself _____ the overweight problem.
5 I am flexible with my hours, so I can respond to your questions _____ via email, live chat, or other electronic means.
6 We believe that every visitor's safety is important. _____, we require all visitors to sign in at the front desk before entry to the tower building.
7 We shouldn't _____ success _____ financial status. Rather, our gauge for success should be other things, such as the positive impact we can make on the people around us.
8 _____ the health risks, smoking also makes finding a job harder sometimes, especially in the healthcare and childcare sectors.



Structure analysis and writing

Structure analysis

Writing an expository essay

An expository essay is a type of writing which tries to explain, illustrate, or clarify something in a way that it becomes clearer to the reader. The core task behind an expository essay, as one can understand from its name, is to "expose" information.

Unlike in an argumentative essay where you take a position on a controversial issue and try to persuade your reader to think in a certain way, in an expository essay you keep to the facts and maintain a neutral tone. You try to inform your reader of or expose them to certain information concisely and objectively, so that the reader can gain a better understanding of the subject matter.

There are different types of expository essays, such as the descriptive type, the process type, the comparison and contrast type, and the cause-and-effect type. The descriptive type is the most common, and it requires you to define different aspects or characteristics of a main topic, usually for the purpose of clarifying a well-established idea about it.

Take Text A of this unit, for example. It is an expository essay of the descriptive type. In the body of the essay (Paras. 3-11), the author deals with several different aspects of the concept "a smart city":

- its meaning (Paras. 3-4);
- factors contributing to the appeal of the idea (Paras. 5-6);
- its key features (Paras. 7-9);
- its ultimate goal (Paras. 10-11).

Through explaining these aspects of a smart city, the author aims to help the reader understand what smart cities are and why building smart cities can be a good solution to the problems experienced by the traditional model of urban life.

Structured writing

Read the sample essay and see how an expository essay is developed.

Topic
Internet slang

Introduction
It is necessary that we understand what Internet slang is and how we can use it appropriately.

Body
- The meaning of slang
- The meaning of Internet slang
- Negative effects of inappropriate use of Internet slang

Conclusion
We have to be careful when using Internet slang.

Exchanging messages online is now one of the most popular forms of communication around the world. Every day, we send lots of messages using emails or social media networks, which, along with the valued speed of information exchange, has led to the development of Internet slang. Considering the widespread use of Internet slang today, it is absolutely necessary that we understand what Internet slang is and how we can use it appropriately.

But to start with, what is slang? Slang is a specific category of conventional language used in speech, especially by people who belong to a particular social group or have the same interests. It consists of words and expressions that are informal but can efficiently convey information to the related people. They can be either completely made up, or based on existing language constructions.

Internet slang, as its name suggests, refers to various kinds of slang used by people on the Internet. It is represented by abbreviations of words used in electronic messaging. Among the most common Internet slang words are “bb” for “bye-bye”, “brb” for “be right back”, “cu” for “see you”, “u2” for “you too”, “btw” for “by the way”, and so on. It is not strange that we send and receive text messages which contain such abbreviated words and expressions.

Although Internet slang can facilitate communication, it can have negative effects if used in inappropriate situations. For example, some students now have moved Internet slang from online communication to serious academic situations. When they write emails to teachers or do their assignments, they habitually use such abbreviations, and they often do not capitalize words or use punctuation marks, which makes them appear disrespectful. It’s not difficult to see that inappropriate use of Internet slang will have a negative effect on their communication.

It is hard to deny that Internet slang has become part of our everyday communication. But as we enjoy the convenience and efficiency brought by it, we also have to be careful and use it where it belongs.

7 Write an expository essay of no less than 150 words on one of the following topics. One topic has an outline that you can follow.

Topic

The impact of smartphones on our life

Introduction

Smartphone technology has changed our life in many respects.

Body

- Changes to how we connect with people
- Changes to how we access information
- Changes to how we do shopping

Conclusion

It is not hard to imagine how helpless we would feel without smartphones.

More topics

- Benefits and potential risks of self-driving vehicles
- Positive and negative impacts of digital media

Section B

Reading skills: Skimming

1 Skim Text B to find answers to the following questions.

1 What is the text mainly about?
2 What is the main factor that triggers deurbanization according to the author?
3 Which paragraphs of the text focus on the disadvantages of living in cities?

Text B

Embrace the trend of deurbanization

1 Although the global financial crisis following a housing bubble occurred between 2007 and 2010, it's still scary and unforgettable to many of us today. Chances are that the next financial crisis will focus on cities because we may soon see the end of urbanization. Many may consider this an exaggeration – after all, cities provide numerous benefits to people. This is true, but new technologies nowadays are making urbanization unnecessary, so it's time for deurbanization.

2 It makes sense that **proximity**, or closeness, brought about by urbanization or **centralization**, lets you reduce **commuting** time and expenses. The more people

Liyang, Jiangsu Province, China

live close together, the larger your sales market is. Cities also offer job and education opportunities as factories, schools, and service providers are within easy reach. In addition, proximity allows the cost of infrastructures, such as roads, sewers, and electricity lines, to be shared. As a result, cities become **magnets** for wealth, money, services, opportunities, and people.

3 Doesn't that mean we will continue to live in cities? I think not, because of the Fourth **Industrial** Revolution, which is marked by emerging technology breakthroughs in a number of fields. Among these are **robotics**, artificial intelligence, nanotechnology, biotechnology, the Internet of Things, autonomous vehicles and others, which are leading to profound changes in the entire systems of production and management of our society.

4 These new technologies will, in one way or another, reduce the benefits of cities. The need for proximity will decline with new technologies, whether it's remote working, online dating, or online shopping. Though the home-delivery market for food and **merchandise** is in the **midst** of a boom, new technologies do not need roads, just transportation, whether by plane or flying car.

5 In fact, decentralization in the supply systems of daily necessities is on the horizon. For **instance**, many people receive drinking water from the tap, while decentralized **alternatives** can now harvest water from the air and create clean water in substantial quantities. Decentralized sewer systems can also take care of waste water. We can also generate electricity with **solar panels**, **wind turbines**, and living plants to charge our tablet, bake a cake, warm our house, and fuel our car.

6 Back in the late 1990s, even many **eminent** people were vague about digital technology. They **underestimated** its massive impact, thinking mobile phones were an unrealistic idea and going wireless with the Internet of Things seemed to be the distant future. They never imagined what it would be like today. Smartphones are now unquestionably **popularized**. With 4G and 5G being used, virtual proximity will reach a whole new level beyond what is possible with our current apps.

7 Furthermore, **automation** and robotization will undoubtedly have significant implications for both blue-collar and white-collar work, with about half of the jobs giving way to computerization. New jobs will inevitably be created by technology – yet the types of jobs will be different and the number can be rather small compared to that of the jobs lost. This will **erode** many people's confidence in landing jobs in cities. So contemplating your future career prospects is a must now.

8 Removing the advantages of city-living leaves only its disadvantages, such as the hectic pace of life, **constraints** on household or rent **expenditure**, and little available

space for personal **recreation**. If you are in a financially **vulnerable** state, or worry about living on the **fringe** of society, you may feel compelled to work harder and change your status quo. Without a clear way out – the way to live better – this mental state can cause **anguish** and distress, a breeding ground for bigger problems.

9 But the problems don't end there. Cities can form urban heat islands. Simply put, this means urban areas become much warmer and more **humid** than their **rural** surroundings. Dark surfaces absorb sunlight more effectively, and the **thermal** properties of concrete and steel indicate they contain far more heat than plants. Plants cool their surroundings through **evapotranspiration**; concrete and steel are unable to do this. Consequently, heat islands can significantly decrease air and water quality, which is catastrophic since it brings diseases, **ailments**, and **allergies**.

10 Another phenomenon that is associated with the decreasing desirability of cities is that not every city is growing. The departure of large employers from an area, unable to keep their business **afloat**, can put cities in an economic dilemma. This starts a **vicious circle** involving falling housing demand and prices, a lack of money to maintain properties, and declining tax incomes, possibly provoking a new financial crisis. With automation and artificial intelligence leading to large job reductions in many industries, we may expect to see more shrinking cities.

11 Given the many downsides of cities, why should we still move into cities when their **leverage** and vigor are diminishing? Why should we pay a lot of money to live in close quarters with other people and not reap the benefits? It seems irrational to continue moving into cities when things are becoming decentralized. Yet, it seems that almost everybody in the world assumes urbanization will remain and continue. Have they ever thought about the cumulative effects of urbanization?

12 Deurbanization is **imperative**. While the advantages of a city may outweigh the disadvantages for some people, it's no longer the case for everyone. Even if some jobs wouldn't be affected by shifts in technology, there is still the fact of shrinking cities to consider. We have moved toward cities because they're where the opportunities used to be, but we can **deduce** that the prospects of the future will be somewhere else. Therefore, let's bid farewell to the heartland of major cities and embrace the trend of deurbanization!

(*934 words*)

New words

proximity /prɒkˈsɪməti/ *n.* [U] (*fml.*) nearness in distance or time（距离或时间的）接近，临近；邻近

centralization /ˌsentrəlaɪˈzeɪʃən/ *n.* [U] the process of gathering to a center 集于中心；集中

▲ **commute** /kəˈmjuːt/ *vi.* travel a long distance every day between one's home and place of work 长途上下班；通勤

▲ **magnet** /ˈmægnɪt/ *n.* [C]
1 sth. or sb. that attracts many people or things 有吸引力的事物或人
2 a piece of iron or steel that can stick to metal or make other metal objects move toward it 磁铁；磁石；吸铁石

▲ **industrial** /ɪnˈdʌstriəl/ *a.*
1 relating to industry or the people working in it 工业的；产业工人的
2 having many industries 有很多工业的；工业发达的

robotics /rəʊˈbɒtɪks/ *n.* [U] the science of making and using robots 机器人学；机器人技术

merchandise /ˈmɜːtʃəndaɪz/ *n.* [U] (*fml.*) goods that are being sold 商品；货品

midst /mɪdst/ *n.* **(in the ~ of sth.)**
1 while an event or situation is happening 在某事的进行过程中；正当某事发生的时候
2 in the middle of a place or a group of things or people 在（某地）中部；在（一堆事物或一群人）中间

▲ **instance** /ˈɪnstəns/ *n.*
1 **(for ~)** for example 例如
2 [C] an example of a particular kind of situation （特定情况的）例子，实例

▲ **alternative** /ɔːlˈtɜːnətɪv/
n. [C] sth. that you can choose instead of sth. else 供替代的选择；供选择的东西
a. (*only before noun*) different from sth. else and able to be used instead of it 供替代的；供选择的

▲ **solar** /ˈsəʊlə/ *a.* (*only before noun*)
1 using the power of the sun's light and heat 利用太阳光（能）的
2 relating to the sun 太阳的；和太阳有关的

▲ **panel** /ˈpænl/ *n.* [C]
1 a flat piece of wood, glass, etc. with straight sides, which forms part of a door, wall, fence, etc.（门、墙、栅栏等的）镶板，嵌板；窗玻璃片
2 a group of people with skills or specialist knowledge who have been chosen to give advice or opinions on a particular subject （由选定人员组成的）专家咨询组

solar panel *n.* [C] a piece of equipment, usu. kept on a roof, that collects and uses energy from the sun to heat water or make electricity （通常放在屋顶的）太阳能电池板

wind turbine /ˈwɪnd ˌtɜːbaɪn/ *n.* [C] 风力发电机

eminent /ˈemɪnənt/ *a.* famous, important, and respected 著名的；杰出的；显赫的

▲ **underestimate** /ˌʌndərˈestɪmeɪt/
v. think or guess that sth. is smaller, cheaper, easier, etc. than it really is（对…）估计不足；低估；看轻
vt. think that sb. is not as good, clever, or skillful as they really are 轻视，小看（某人）

popularize /ˈpɒpjələraɪz/ *vt.*
1 make sth. popular with many people 使受欢迎；宣传；推广
2 make a difficult subject or idea able to be easily understood by ordinary people 使通俗化；使大众化；使易懂

▲ **automation** /ˌɔːtəˈmeɪʃən/ *n.* [C] the use of computers and machines instead of people to do a job 自动化

erode /ɪˈrəʊd/ *v.*

1 gradually reduce sth. such as sb.'s power or confidence 逐步损害，逐渐削弱（权力或信心）

2 gradually destroy the surface of rock or land so that it begins to disappear, or be gradually destroyed in this way 侵蚀；腐蚀；风化

constraint /kənˈstreɪnt/ *n.*

1 [C] sth. that limits your freedom to do what you want 限制；束缚；约束力

2 [U] control over the way people are allowed to behave, so that they cannot do what they want 行为约束

▲ **expenditure** /ɪkˈspendɪtʃə/ *n.*

1 [C, U] money spent by a government, organization, or person 花费；开销；支出

2 [U] the use of time, money, energy, etc. doing sth. 耗费；使用

▲ **recreation** /ˌrekriˈeɪʃən/ *n.* [C, U] an activity that you do for pleasure or amusement 消遣；娱乐

▲ **vulnerable** /ˈvʌlnərəbəl/ *a.*

1 easily damaged or hurt by sth. negative or harmful 脆弱的；易受伤的

2 easy to attack or criticize 易受攻击的；易受责难的

fringe /frɪndʒ/ *n.* [C]

1 the outer or less important part of an area, group, or activity（地区或群体的）边缘，外围；（活动的）次要部分

2 (*BrE*) short hair that hangs down over your forehead 刘海；额前短垂发

anguish /ˈæŋgwɪʃ/ *n.* (*fml.*) [U] mental or physical suffering caused by extreme pain or worry （精神或身体上的）极度痛苦

humid /ˈhjuːmɪd/ *a.* hot and wet in a way that makes you feel uncomfortable（天气）潮湿（炎热）的

▲ **rural** /ˈrʊərəl/ *a.*

1 happening in or relating to the countryside, not the city 农村的；乡村的；田园的

2 like the countryside or reminding you of the countryside 像农村的；使人想起农村的

thermal /ˈθɜːməl/ *a.* (*only before noun*)

1 relating to or caused by heat 热的；热量的；由热引起的

2 made from special material to keep you warm in very cold weather（衣服）保温的，保暖的

evapotranspiration /ɪˈvæpəˌtrænspɪˈreɪʃən/ *n.* [U] the process by which water moves from the earth to the air through evaporation and transpiration (= water lost from plants) 蒸散

ailment /ˈeɪlmənt/ *n.* [C] an illness that is not very serious（不严重的）疾病；微恙

allergy /ˈælədʒi/ *n.* [C, U] a medical condition in which you become ill or in which your skin becomes red and painful because you have eaten or touched a particular substance 过敏性反应；过敏症

afloat /əˈfləʊt/ *a.* (*not before noun*)

1 having enough money to operate or stay out of debt 经济上周转得开的；不欠债的

2 floating on water 漂浮的

vicious /ˈvɪʃəs/ *a.*

1 violent and cruel in a way that hurts sb. physically 凶险的；会造成伤害的

2 very unkind or unpleasant 狠毒的；恶毒的；恶意的

vicious circle *n.* (*also* **vicious cycle**) [sing.] a situation in which one problem causes another problem that then causes the first problem again, so that the whole process continues to be repeated 恶性循环

leverage /ˈliːvərɪdʒ/ *n.* [U]

1 power to influence people and get the results you want 影响力

2 the action, power, or use of a lever 杠杆作用；杠杆力量；杠杆的使用

imperative /ɪm'perətɪv/

a. extremely important or urgent 极重要的；紧急的；迫切的

n. [C] sth. that is very important and urgent 必要的事；紧急的事

deduce /dɪ'dju:s/ *vt.* (*fml.*) use the knowledge and information you have in order to understand sth. or form an opinion about it 推论；推断；演绎

Phrases and expressions

on the horizon likely to happen in the near future 将要发生的；即将来临的

on the fringe(s) (of sth.)

1 not completely belonging to or accepted by a group of people who share the same job, activities, etc. 属于（…的）边缘的

2 at the part of sth. that is farthest from the center 在（…的）边缘；在（…的）外围

simply put / put simply if explained in a clear and simple way / if explaining it in a clear and simple way 简单地说

keep (sth. / sb.) afloat

1 have enough money to keep sth. or sb. in operation or out of debt（使）经济上周转得开；（使）不欠债

2 keep sth. or sb. in a state of floating on water （使）漂浮

bid farewell to say goodbye to sb. or sth. 告别；向…道别

Proper names

the Fourth Industrial Revolution 第四次工业革命

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

2 Choose the best answer to each of the following questions.

1 In what way have cities been attractive?
- A They encourage businesses to increase service varieties.
- B They ensure the quality of infrastructure in downtown areas.
- C They lower living expenses and provide different opportunities.
- D They improve long-distance commuting and expand the sales market.

2 According to the text, how will the development of new technologies affect cities?
- A It will reduce the advantages of cities.
- B It will weaken the need for transportation.
- C It will disrupt the decentralized supply system.
- D It will slow down the automation of industries.

3 What can be inferred about future delivery of food and merchandise to consumers?
- A It will increase the market share of home-based businesses.
- B It will allow consumers to enjoy free delivery of goods to their homes.
- C It will become less popular because of increasing traffic congestions.
- D It will use transportation means much different from today's vehicles.

4 What did many famous people think of digital technology in the late 1990s?
- A They did not believe mobile phones would be popular soon.
- B They did not think the Internet of Things would be possible.
- C They were certain about the positive impact of virtual proximity.
- D They were confident about the bright future of 4G and 5G technology.

5 How will automation and robotization influence the jobs of urban residents?
- A They will prevent the creation of new jobs.
- B They will cause many residents to lose jobs.
- C They will create more jobs in cities.
- D They will create more white-collar jobs.

6 Why does the author mention "heat islands" in Para. 9?
- A To clarify the real cause of health problems in urban areas.
- B To give an additional example of the disadvantages of cities.
- C To demonstrate the importance of rural areas to the environment.
- D To suggest the need to replace concrete and steel with other building materials.

7 Which of the following is a sign of shrinking cities?
- A Automation creates new job opportunities for urban residents.
- B Housing prices are lowered by changes in the government's tax policy.
- C Large employers leave cities because they can't maintain operation.
- D Industries experience difficulties in growing due to limitations of land.

8 What is the author's attitude toward deurbanization?
- A Opposing.
- B Skeptical.
- C Neutral.
- D Welcoming.

Critical thinking

3 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 Do you agree with the author that technological advances will reduce the advantages of living in cities? Why or why not?

2 Do you prefer working remotely from a suburban home or working on site in a downtown office, and why?

3 How do you compare living in a big city and living in a small town? List the three biggest differences and give explanations.

4 Where is your hometown, in the countryside or in a city? What do you like and dislike about it?

5 Of all the cities you have been to, which one do you consider the best to live in, and why?

Collocation

More language exercises

The concept of smart cities is becoming increasingly popular among urban governors. Smart planning is driven by technological advances and innovations achieved in recent decades. In particular, the Internet of Things will have a ***massive impact*** (B4U1A) on the quality of future urban life. It can ***actively improve*** (B4U1A) and even transform the ***core functionality*** (B4U1A) of cities in diverse areas such as infrastructure, business operation, and waste management. Smart cities promise to deliver ***optimal safety*** (B4U1A), a clean environment featuring ***minimal waste*** (B4U1A), smooth flow of traffic, ***highly efficient*** (B4U1A) energy use, and ***easy availability*** (B4U1A) of services. In fact, we are already ***reaping the benefits*** (B4U1B) of smart cities. For instance, thanks to the ***virtual proximity*** (B4U1B) made possible by digital technology, many companies allow their employees to work fully or partly from home. This saves time and resources in ***substantial quantities*** (B4U1B). In addition, people can live in less crowded areas rather than in ***close quarters*** (B4U1B) in cities. With all the advantages of smart cities, no wonder policy makers and urban scientists around the world ***embrace the trend*** (B4U1B) of smart planning. With the ***profound changes*** (B4U1B) in urban design brought by new technologies, a new age for urban living and a ***sustainable future*** (B4U1A) of cities are on the horizon.

4 Professor Cohen is teaching a course on urban design and planning. At the end of his last class, he asked the students to do some reading about intelligent urban planning and the features of future cities. Today his students are presenting their findings. Here are some excerpts of these presentations. While reading them, complete the blanks with appropriate collocations from the texts.

Cindy

Intelligent city planning will have a 1) ***ma_____*** ***impact*** on the urban environment we live in. Promoting 2) ***mi_____*** ***waste*** of resources, it will help make the cities of the future cleaner, greener, and safer. Environmental technologies will effectively decrease air pollution, significantly increase the use of renewable energy, and 3) ***a_____*** ***improve*** waste control. For instance, infrastructure will be more eco-friendly in that consumption of natural resources will decrease in 4) ***sub_____*** ***quantities***. I am confident that smart technology will bring a more 5) ***sus_____*** ***future*** to our resources and environment.

Smart cities ensure the 6) ***o_____*** ***safety*** of human lives. For example, fire detection devices integrated into building design can eliminate potential dangers. Crime prevention measures can enhance public safety based on real-time data. Sensors in the homes of seniors living alone can connect them to medical services whenever needed.

Sam

Smart city planning will dramatically change the 7) ***co_____ functionality*** of cities and make them more comfortable to live in. We know urban development used to evolve around industrial development and economic activities, so a lot of land was used to build factories, roads, offices, and houses. People used to live in 8) ***c_____ quarters*** within cities because of the 9) ***e_____ availability*** of services and abundance of job opportunities. However, with the use of smart technology, the landscape of our cities may undergo 10) ***pr_____ changes***. Smart management of parking and transportation, wireless delivery of services, as well as increasing automation of production, will largely reduce the need for industrial land, and hence create more space for parks, entertainment, and leisure. As someone living in a tiny apartment on a noisy street, I cannot wait to 11) ***r_____ the benefits*** of smart cities.

Jerry

Smart cities will use wireless networks and mobile-based applications to connect people, objects, and entities. This further opens the door to a wide range of technological advances and innovations that will make our society 12) ***h_____ efficient***.

Communication of real-time data across platforms can help improve various aspects of urban life. I am really fascinated by the prospect of 13) ***vir_____ proximity***, with which many things we do physically today can be accomplished digitally in the future. Governments around the world are 14) ***em_____ the trend*** of digital services. In the near future, citizens can be served online with greater speed and transparency.

Stories of China

Limited space, unlimited growth

As a famous Chinese saying goes, "Up in heaven, there is paradise; down on earth, there are Suzhou and Hangzhou." Hangzhou, capital of east China's Zhejiang Province, is well-known for its beautiful scenery and abundant natural resources. During the past decades of reform and opening up, Hangzhou achieved prosperity through industrialization.

Today, with the boom in information technology, Hangzhou has grown into a paradise for innovation and entrepreneurship, especially in the emerging Internet Plus industries. As reform and opening up entered a new phase, Hangzhou seized the opportunity to develop its digital economy, and its efforts have paid off. Today, it is known as "the capital of e-commerce".

In this digital city, residents can pay for their commute, access medical services, place an order, get a receipt, and do many other things by simply scanning barcodes (条形码) or QR codes with their phones.

The city's infrastructure has also been upgraded to promote the emerging digital economy. Big blocks of high-rise buildings now stand near the northern bank of the Qiantang River. This area used to be villages. Early this century, tall stylish buildings began to spring up here, creating a new "digital forest" in Shangcheng District (上城区).

Shangcheng District not only supports the development of its hi-tech industries but also applies digital technology to urban management to achieve “all-weather, wide-coverage, and high-efficiency” intelligent management. Compared with traditional urban management, intelligent urban management is more convenient and more humane.

There are many examples of this. In the past, if a manhole cover (窨井盖) was displaced or lost, it was usually unknown and could result in people falling in or cars getting their wheels caught. Today, intelligent equipment has been installed on manhole covers to trigger an alarm if they are being moved away. The devices have been installed on all the 4,000-plus manhole covers and the government has the copyright to the software.

Some elderly people live on their own as their children have grown up and are employed elsewhere. Shangcheng District has launched smart homecare projects for these people. The intelligent care system for the elderly makes it easy for the aged to call for help in an emergency and ask for housekeeping services.

As was said by a government official of Hangzhou, “In the past, people regarded the Internet merely as a tool, but now they find it to be a resource, too. By using the Internet, we can achieve unlimited growth even in a limited space.”

Exercises

Translation

Translate the following paragraph into English.

城乡一体化（urban-rural integration）是我国现代化和城市化发展的一个新阶段。其目的是通过对城乡发展进行统筹规划，并通过体制改革和政策调整，破除城乡二元经济结构（the urban-rural dual economic structure），从而实现城乡在政策上平等、在产业发展模式上互补，让农村居民享受到与城镇居民同样的文明和福利。只有大力推进城乡一体化，我国整个城乡经济才能实现全面、可持续发展。

Unit project

Role-playing: Living in a smart city

Text A introduces what a smart city is like and how it will work in an emergency. A smart city can benefit its inhabitants by being connected, intelligent, efficient, and safe. Suppose you and your family are living in a smart city. What would your life be like? In this unit project, you and your group members will pretend to be a family and work together to role-play a day of your life in a smart city.

Step 1 **Form small groups of four to six. Each group is a family, and you can be a father, a mother, a child, a grandfather, or a grandmother.**

Step 2 **Work together and write a 10-minute play narrating what happens during a day of your smart life. You can begin with a scene in the early morning and end with one in the late evening, or you can choose to demonstrate one or a few major happenings during the day.**

Step 3 **Act out your play as a group and rehearse it as many times as you can. You can dress yourself like any character you are acting. Besides, you can add whatever sound effect that you think is necessary, or use any electronic background scene as an aid to your play.**

Step 4 **Perform your play in class. Ask the audience to vote for the best actor or actress in your group after you finish.**

Unit 2 Secrets to beauty

Beautiful words can win people's respect; beautiful deeds can earn people's admiration.

— Laozi
(*Chinese philosopher*)

美言可以市尊，美行可以加人。

——老子
（中国哲学家）

Preview

Beauty has been an important part of human life across cultures around the world. While the love of beauty is universal, we all have life experiences that influence how we **perceive beauty and develop our own beauty**. In modern times, the media sometimes presents misleading images of idealized beauty, making people believe that they can attain perfect looks through artificial means. Yet, all who live will grow old, and outward beauty alone can never bring a truly beautiful life. **What ultimately makes a person beautiful and happy is inner beauty** – positive qualities of mind and character, and what truly makes our society beautiful are the words and actions of people who have beautiful souls. How do you define true beauty? How can you achieve a beautiful and happy life?

Section A

Pre-reading activities

1 Look at the pictures below and answer the following questions.

A

B

C

D

1 What kinds of beauty do the pictures show?
2 Have you ever seen or experienced these types of beauty? Give one or two specific examples.

2 Work in pairs and discuss why the various kinds of beauty shown in the pictures are important in our life.

Text A

Making the choice to be truly beautiful

1 Extreme makeovers are all the rage these days, with so many people addicted to beauty salons and reality shows. Many people are trying to match the extraordinary measures some actors and actresses take to look perfect on the screen. Yet, the shortcuts to attaining physical beauty don't usually fulfill their promise. Besides, beautiful people are not automatically happy people.

2 Attaining the highest degree of beauty is not about looking good during social interactions or achieving physical perfection, and you can't get there via technology. It's a growth process, a transformation of self through awareness and learning. It's about meaning and being real. It's an emotional and spiritual walk, requiring faith fueled with liberal doses of loving kindness.

3 Every day, I have the delight and **privilege** of loving Richard, my husband, a real, human, and emotionally accessible man. We're about the same age, and our looks have **corroded** a bit over time. After almost 20 years, though, we have grown together in ways that go far deeper than the surface of our skin. Our life is lovely even if it doesn't match the criteria of love in movie fantasies. We laugh together, we share the struggles of daily life together, and

the thought that he might die before I do fills me with **dread**. All the muscle-bound male models in the world couldn't replace my very own, **outgoing** soul mate. It took me over 30 years to find him, and I'm not about to replace him with the so-called "**esthetic** perfection".

4 I work as a psychotherapist, and clients come to my office every day **scarred** with emotional pain because their lives aren't "perfect" enough. They feel inadequate, hopeless, and frustrated because they can't attain life as they see it on the big screen. It helps when I **preface** our sessions with the mention that tens of thousands of dollars go into every second of media they see, that actors and actresses have dozens of people devoted exclusively to making them look good, and that the effort to maintain their images is an exhausting, full-time job. The "beautiful" people in the media are under enormous pressure to maintain their looks, and to me, it's a good thing that my clients are **exempt** from that predominant pressure.

5 I **underscore** that no face creams, **dietary** fads, **protein supplements**, vitamin **capsules**, or **meditation regiments** are going to make people's lives, bodies, or mental state much better. In fact, these things often **hamper** happiness by distracting them from what leads to real inner beauty. Life is not about maintaining some young and **stylish** outward **costume** for one to hide behind, as some people believe. It's about growing and deepening one's soul.

6 The only way I know to develop my soul is through feelings. Witnessing natural phenomena – the star-lit **galaxy**, a centuries-old redwood, the **symphony** of birds' songs in spring – stretches it, making me feel humble and **majestic**, all at the same time. Human relationships **bruise**, **collide**, and comfort, teaching me maturity and passion. Love urges my soul to blossom and glow, and affection **elicits** feelings of **eternity**, so I learn to accept others as they are.

7 Most people in my life are not like those who are "beautiful" but **barren** and self-absorbed. We're ordinary, real, and imperfect people. Together we work hard, **stumbling** through life, trying to be our best selves, **knitting** together families and friendships, and striving to **illuminate** the world with our personal ethics and aspirations.

8 We come from numerous backgrounds and don't always approve of each other's decisions, but we care for each other the best we can. We struggle to be less **self-indulgent**,

more compassionate and understanding. We try to resist the lure of novelty fads and the **manipulations** of advertising. We survive through social phenomena that we don't agree with, through **interwoven** natural and unnatural disasters that take our loved ones and possessions, and through fads and fancies that are often unhealthy. From each event, we learn, we stretch, we sometimes **fracture**, we process the emotional outcome, and we move on. These life events are the soul's workout, and though we may groan and complain, we can feel the growth eventually.

9 The secret is that this growth is visible to others, and the effort **registers** on our entire being. It becomes an **authentic** element that makes our spirit glow **radiantly**. Have you ever seen elderly people whose wisdom shows in their eyes and whose love is evident as they gently **enquire** about your health and offer a brief sentiment that calms and affirms? The spirit that shines from within these people is true beauty, and it can't be bought in a jar.

10 The miracle is that each of us has the total capacity to achieve this perspective, this fullest **embodiment** of the highest expression of soul, even as our **mortal** bodies wear out and degenerate.

11 In other words, true beauty is not about looks. It's about choices. As we move through life and grow through each of its **checkpoints**, we should seek out and build the kinds of experiences that reveal and **purify** our inner beauty. We must look at our own lives and decisions from a more valuable perspective.

12 The decisions we make today affect the rest of our lives. We ourselves are ultimately the only people to whom we are accountable and for whom we are responsible. Each new decision we make can be a new **resolution** to build the beautiful future we long to have.

(*914 words*)

New words

▲ **privilege** /ˈprɪvəlɪdʒ/ *n.*

1 [sing.] sth. nice that you feel lucky to have 荣幸；殊荣

2 [C] a special advantage that is given only to one person or group of people 特权；特殊待遇

corrode /kəˈrəʊd/ *v.*

1 become or make weak by causing gradual damage（逐渐地）损害，伤害

2 destroy sth. slowly, or be destroyed slowly, esp. by chemicals（使）腐蚀；（使）侵蚀

dread /dred/

n. [sing., U] a strong fear of sth. that is going to happen or may happen 恐惧；害怕

vt. feel anxious or worried about sth. that is going to happen or may happen 畏惧；惧怕；担心

▲ **outgoing** /ˌaʊtˈgəʊɪŋ/ *a.*

1 being friendly and enjoying meeting and talking to people 外向的；好交际的

2 (*only before noun*) soon to leave a position of authority or power 即将离任的

esthetic /iːsˈθetɪk/

a. (*BrE* **aesthetic**) 1 relating to beauty or the study of beauty 审美的；美学的；艺术的

2 (*fml.*) nice to look at 美的

n. [U] (*fml.*) (**~s**) the study of beauty, esp. beauty in art 美学；审美学

▲ **scar** /skɑː/

vt. (*usu. passive*) 1 leave you a feeling of unpleasant experience or fear that continues for a long time 使遭受（精神）创伤

2 leave a permanent mark on your skin or on an object 在…上留下疤痕（或伤痕）

n. [C] 1 a feeling of fear or sadness that remains with you for a long time after an unpleasant experience 精神创伤

2 a permanent mark on your skin or an object 伤疤；伤痕；斑痕

▲ **preface** /ˈprefɪs/

vt. (*fml.*) say, do, or write sth. before you say, do, or write the main part 给…做开场白；为…写序言

n. [C] an introduction to a book or a speech（书的）前言，序言；（演讲的）开场白

exempt /ɪgˈzempt/ *a.* not affected by sth., or not having to do it or pay it 被免除（义务）的；被豁免的

underscore /ˌʌndəˈskɔː/ *vt.*

1 emphasize the fact that sth. is important or true 强调

2 draw a line under a word or sentence to show that it is important 在…的底下画线（以示强调）

▲ **dietary** /ˈdaɪətəri/ *a.* related to the food sb. eats 与饮食有关的

▲ **protein** /ˈprəʊtiːn/ *n.* [C, U] a substance in food such as meat, eggs, and milk that people need in order to grow and be healthy 蛋白质

▲ **supplement** /ˈsʌpləmənt/

n. [C] 1 sth. extra that you add to make sth. better or complete 增补物；补充物；补给品

2 an additional part at the end of a book, or a separate part of a newspaper, magazine, etc.（书的）附录；补编；（报纸、杂志等的）增刊，副刊

vt. add sth. extra in order to improve sth. or make it bigger 补充；增补；增加

capsule /ˈkæpsjuːl/ *n.* [C]

1 a small plastic container filled with medicine that you swallow whole 胶囊

2 the part of a space vehicle in which people travel（太空飞行器的）密封舱，太空舱

meditation /ˌmedɪˈteɪʃən/ *n.*

1 [U] the practice of emptying your mind of thoughts and feelings in order to relax completely or for religious reasons 打坐；冥想；默念

2 [C, usu. pl., U] the act of thinking deeply and seriously about sth. 沉思；深思；思考

regiment /ˈredʒəmənt/ *n.* [C]
1 a large group of people, animals, or things, esp. an organized one 大群；大量
2 a large group of soldiers, usu. consisting of several battalions （军队的）团

hamper /ˈhæmpə/ *vt.*
1 prevent sth. from happening or progressing normally 阻碍；妨碍
2 limit sb.'s freedom to move 束缚；限制

▲**stylish** /ˈstaɪlɪʃ/ *a.* attractive in a fashionable way 时髦的；有品位的

▲**costume** /ˈkɒstjʊm/ *n.* [C, U]
1 clothes that are typical of a particular place or period of time in history （代表某一特定地方或历史时期的）服装，装束
2 clothes that performers wear in a play, film, etc. 演出服；戏装

galaxy /ˈgæləksi/ *n.*
1 [C] a large group of stars and planets that make up the universe 星系
2 [sing.] a large number of people or things that are similar 一大批（相似的人或物）

symphony /ˈsɪmfəni/ *n.* [C] a long piece of classical music played by a large orchestra 交响曲；交响乐

majestic /məˈdʒestɪk/ *a.* big, beautiful, or impressive in a calm and serious way 雄伟的；壮丽的；威严的

bruise /bruːz/
v. get or cause a mark on sb.'s body by hitting or knocking it （使）碰伤；擦伤；（使）成淤伤
vt. affect sb. badly and make them feel less confident 打击，挫伤（自信心）

collide /kəˈlaɪd/ *vi.*
1 disagree strongly with a person or group 冲突；抵触
2 crash into each other 碰撞；相撞

elicit /ɪˈlɪsɪt/ *vt.*
1 make sb. react in a certain way 引出，引起（某人的某种反应）
2 manage to get information from sb. 探出（信息）；套出（情报等）

▲**eternity** /ɪˈtɜːnəti/ *n.*
1 [U] the whole of time without any end 永恒
2 [C] (**an ~**) a very long time 极长一段时间

barren /ˈbærən/ *a.*
1 without any interesting, attractive, or positive features 无趣的；无吸引力的
2 (of land or soil) dry and with no plants growing （土地或土壤）贫瘠的，荒芜的

stumble /ˈstʌmbəl/ *vi.*
1 walk in an unsteady way and often almost fall 蹒跚而行；踉跄
2 hit your foot against sth. while you are walking or running, so that you fall or almost fall 绊脚；绊了一下
3 stop or make a mistake when you are speaking （说话时）打结巴；说错

▲**knit** /nɪt/ *v.*
1 (**knit, knit**) join closely together as a group （使）紧密结合
2 (**knitted, knitted**) make clothes, etc. by using wool and long needles 编织；针织

illuminate /ɪˈluːmɪneɪt/ *vt.*
1 make a light shine on sth., or fill a place with light 照亮；照明；照射
2 (*fml.*) make sth. clearer and easier to understand 阐明；解释

indulgent /ɪnˈdʌldʒənt/ *a.* willing to allow sb., esp. a child, to do or have whatever they want, even if this is not good for them （尤指对孩子）溺爱的，纵容的，放任的

self-indulgent *a.* allowing yourself to do or have sth. special that you like very much, often sth. that you should not do or have 自我放纵的

▲ **manipulation** /məˌnɪpjəˈleɪʃən/ *n.*
1 [C, U] behavior that influences sb. or controls sth. in a clever or dishonest way （巧妙或不诚实的）影响，操纵，控制
2 [U] the process of skillfully handling, controlling, or using sth. （熟练的）操作，控制，使用

interwoven /ˌɪntəˈwəʊvən/ *a.* closely related or mixed together 交织的；紧密结合的

fracture /ˈfræktʃə/
v. 1 break or crack （使）折断；（使）断裂
2 divide into parts because of disagreement （使团体或组织）分裂
n. [C] a break or crack in a bone or other hard substance 骨折；裂缝；裂痕

▲ **register** /ˈredʒɪstə/ *v.*
1 record, show, or express sth. 显示；指示；表达
2 put sb.'s or sth.'s name on an official list 记录；登记

▲ **authentic** /ɔːˈθentɪk/ *a.*
1 based on facts 可靠的；真实的
2 real, not false or copied 真的；非复制的
3 traditional or original, or very similar to this 正宗的；地道的

radiant /ˈreɪdiənt/ *a.*
1 (*only before noun*) (*literary*) very bright 灿烂的；明亮的
2 very happy 容光焕发的；喜悦的

radiantly /ˈreɪdiəntli/ *ad.*
1 灿烂地；明亮地
2 容光焕发地；喜悦地

▲ **enquire** /ɪnˈkwaɪə/ *v.* (*esp. BrE*) (*also* **inquire**) (*fml.*) ask sb. for information 询问；打听

embodiment /ɪmˈbɒdɪmənt/ *n.* [sing.] sb. or sth. that represents or is very typical of an idea or quality 体现；化身

mortal /ˈmɔːtl/ *a.*
1 human and not able to live forever 凡人的；不能永生的
2 serious enough to cause death 致命的；致死的

checkpoint /ˈtʃekpɔɪnt/ *n.* [C] a place, esp. on a border, where an official person examines vehicles or people （尤指边境的）关卡，检查站

▲ **purify** /ˈpjʊərɪfaɪ/ *vt.*
1 make sb. pure by removing evil from their soul 净化（灵魂）
2 make sth. clean by removing dirty or harmful substances from it 净化；使纯净

▲ **resolution** /ˌrezəˈluːʃən/ *n.* [C]
1 a promise to yourself to do sth. （做某事的）决心
2 a formal decision or statement agreed on by a group of people, esp. after a vote （尤指投票后作出的）决议，正式决定

Phrases and expressions

be addicted to
1 like sth. so much that you do not want to stop doing it or having it 对…痴迷；沉迷于…
2 be unable to stop taking an illegal or harmful substance, esp. a drug （吸毒）成瘾的，上瘾的

be exempt from be free from an obligation, duty, or payment 被免除（义务、责任或付款）

stumble through / across / into, etc. move or walk unsteadily in a specified direction 摇摇晃晃地移动；步履蹒跚

approve of think that sb. or sth. is good, right, or suitable 赞成；同意；赞许

enquire about (*fml.*) ask sb. about sth. or sb. 询问；打听

wear sth. out become damaged or useless, or make sth. like this by using it a lot or for a long time 用坏；（使）磨损

seek out try to find sth. or sb., esp. when that is difficult 找出；找到

be accountable to be responsible for the effects of your actions and willing to explain or be criticized for them 对…负有责任

Proper names

Richard 理查德（人名）

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

1 Answer the following questions.

1 What does the author think of the shortcuts some people take to obtain physical beauty?
2 Why does the author consider her marriage life lovely even though it does not match the kind of love shown in movies?
3 What does the text imply about the life of some actors and actresses despite their beautiful looks?
4 Why do beauty products and treatments prevent people from attaining true happiness?
5 According to the text, what is the only way to develop the soul?
6 By using the word "barren" in Para. 7, what does the author imply about some "beautiful" people?
7 Why does the author mention various life events in Para. 8?
8 According to the text, what should we do as we move through life?

Critical thinking

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 Do you agree with the author that different life events and experiences help our soul grow and develop, and why?
2 Is there a person or a life experience that has influenced your understanding of true beauty, and how?
3 How is inner beauty different from physical beauty, and why is it more important?
4 What do you think are the most important traits that make a person beautiful?
5 How do you think college students can develop and enhance their inner beauty?

Language focus

Words in use

3 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

authentic collide corrode
costume dietary elicit hamper
interwoven knit preface

1 To encourage innovation among employees, the company has canceled a number of regulations and procedures that may _____ creative ideas.
2 Chinese consumers embrace healthy lifestyles, and many are changing their _____ habits to further reduce the consumption of sugar.
3 If a couple treat each other with trust, respect, and honesty, nothing can make the bond of their marriage _____.
4 The professor usually _____ his lecture by providing some interesting background information, which helps students better understand the subject.
5 Humorous and good at telling jokes, he _____ laughter and applause from the audience whenever he is on the stage.
6 Technology is _____ with many things we do today, making our lives far more convenient and efficient than before.
7 The railroad, which was about 2,000 kilometers long, _____ the whole country together and made its rapid industrialization possible.
8 The novel tells the story of a young man who struggles hard to accomplish his dreams that _____ with reality.
9 What attracted me most in the museum was a stone sculpture of an ancient warrior in a(n) _____, complete with helmet, sword, and shield.
10 He fully researched the history of European immigration to North America to write a(n) _____ account of immigrant life.

Word building

与某些动词结合构成名词，表示动作的状态或过程，也可指完成动作的具体实例。出现在单词中的拼写形式不一，最常见的有 -tion、-ation、-sion 和 -ition。

accuse		accusation
contribute		contribution
expand		expansion
repeat		repetition
confront		**confrontation**
dominate		**domination**

与某些动词结合构成名词，通常表示执行动作的物体或从事某种职业的人。

browse		browser
print		printer
transmit		transmitter
loan		**loaner**
scan		**scanner**

与某些名词或形容词结合构成新的名词，表示具有某种信念或从事某种职业的人。

active		activist
science		scientist
social		socialist
human		**humanist**
imperial		**imperialist**
left		**leftist**
terror		**terrorist**

4 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

confrontation domination humanist
imperialist leftist loaner
scanner terrorist

1 The Internet is posing a strong challenge to the _____ of traditional media such as newspapers and television as the main sources of news.
2 A common security measure at airports is screening luggage and passengers with X-ray _____ to detect hazardous items.
3 People generally think that a(n) _____ should have very strong morals, in addition to beliefs in a philosophy that focuses on human values and concerns.
4 The police interviewed all six witnesses, but none of them could describe clearly how the _____ began and who started the fight.
5 The _____ usually object to such conservative proposals, but this time they are trying to seek some middle ground with the rightist opposition parties.
6 After the conference, nations from around the globe issued a joint statement to protect world security by improving international cooperation in the fight against _____.
7 This small island became a colony after the European _____ decided to use it as their trading port in the 19th century.
8 After a customer submits a loan application, the _____, usually a bank or a credit union, will check the person's credit scores to determine their eligibility.

Banked cloze

5 Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

A associate	**F** hesitation	**K** ridiculous
B collaborate	**G** ideological	**L** striving
C concepts	**H** mortal	**M** stylish
D dedication	**I** physical	**N** survived
E depriving	**J** populous	**O** traits

When I was young, I had a very narrow understanding of beauty. I used to 1) _____ it with only physical things. It was about what the eye could see: soft hair, clear skin, 2) _____ clothes, a good figure ... I think some other people may also have gone through this phase of wanting the perfect shell defined solely in terms of 3) _____ standards.

When I first entered the modeling industry, I was always 4) _____ to conform to others' criteria of beauty. I would think, "Well, if they say I'm beautiful, then I am. But if they don't, then I'm not." Even today, I can't believe how 5) _____ my thoughts were.

I want to correct this narrow idea that our beauty comes from the notions and approval of other people. When we allow others to determine what is beautiful, we fail to express and accept our individuality, our unique physical and personal 6) _____. I think we should ask ourselves the question "What is beautiful to me?" and construct our own 7) _____ of beauty that are more comprehensive and more meaningful.

As time goes on, I have gradually expanded my definitions of beauty, without limiting them to what lies on the outside. I have started to realize that physical beauty won't last forever because we humans are all 8) _____ and will grow old inevitably. I have met many strong and courageous women, for example, a friend who 9) _____ breast cancer and a cousin who works hard to provide for her child. I have also met many women who are devoted to their careers. Their confidence radiates from their 10) _____ to their professional pursuits. These women are examples of beautiful actions and thoughts. They embrace being themselves.

Expressions in use

6 Fill in the blanks with the expressions given below. Change the form where necessary. Each expression can be used only once.

approve of be accountable to be addicted to
be exempt from enquire about seek out
stumble through wear out

1 In his response to the job offer from the company, he _____ healthcare benefits available to full-time employees to make a final decision.
2 They got lost while hiking in the mountain, spending many hours _____ the dense forest before finding their way back to the trail.
3 Wherever you go for college and whatever major you pursue, you should actively _____ new opportunities and experiences to enrich your learning.
4 As part of an ecosystem that contains numerous living species, we human beings _____ not only ourselves but also other species that share the same planet.
5 Raised in a family where being frugal was a virtue, we never got rid of anything we had until it completely _____.
6 According to the law, art museums are considered non-profit organizations and can _____ some taxes if they meet certain criteria.
7 Parents all _____ and support the school's measures to lower academic pressure on kids and encourage their participation in outdoor activities.
8 Some people today _____ their mobile phones, even to the point that they become restless if they are not with their devices.

Structure analysis and writing

Structure analysis

Using parallelism in essay writing

Parallelism, or parallel structure, is the use of identical or similar structures to list several items to establish a balance between ideas, or to emphasize certain facts or ideas. It can happen at a word, phrase, clause, sentence, or even paragraph level. The related forms are often joined by coordinating conjunctions (并列连词) such as *and*, *or*, or *but*.

Parallelism provides structure, order, and balance in your writing. It is especially useful in argumentative essays as it can add clarity and force to your ideas, persuade your readers, and hold their attention.

In Text A, the author employs various types of parallel structure when explaining her ideas and expanding her discussion. The following examples demonstrate her use of this technique.

Words

- *Human relationships bruise, collide, and comfort, teaching me maturity and passion.* (Para. 6)
- *We're ordinary, real, and imperfect people.* (Para. 7)

Phrases

- *I underscore that no face creams, dietary fads, protein supplements, vitamin capsules, or meditation regiments are going to make people's lives, bodies, or mental state much better.* (Para. 5)
- *Together we work hard, stumbling through life, trying to be our best selves, knitting together families and friendships, and striving to illuminate the world with our personal ethics and aspirations.* (Para. 7)

Clauses

- *From each event, we learn, we stretch, we sometimes fracture, we process the emotional outcome, and we move on.* (Para. 8)

Sentences

- *We struggle to be less self-indulgent, more compassionate and understanding. We try to resist the lure of novelty fads and the manipulations of advertising. We survive through social phenomena that we don't agree with ...* (Para. 8)

Structured writing

Read the sample essay and see how to use parallelism in essay writing.

Topic
A positive attitude matters

Introduction
A positive attitude is essential to success and happiness because it brings greater confidence, better health, and more pleasant relationships.

Body
- A positive attitude strengthens your confidence.
- A positive attitude fosters your physical and emotional health.
- A positive attitude facilitates your interpersonal relationships.

Conclusion
A positive attitude is the fuel that sustains your confidence, keeps you healthy, and enhances your interpersonal relationships.

We all have difficult days, stressful periods, and low times once in a while. Life is not always sunshine and roses, and sometimes it's hard to spot the silver lining in tough situations. That's where a positive mindset comes in. A positive attitude is essential to success and happiness because it brings three benefits: greater confidence, better health, and more pleasant relationships.

First, a positive attitude strengthens your confidence. This means you will be more optimistic, stay hopeful in difficult situations, and have the perseverance to overcome the challenges in life. Those with a positive attitude don't give up easily; therefore, they are more likely to achieve success. For example, Henry Ford, founder of the Ford Motor Company, went bankrupt before fulfilling his dream. But he stayed confident without losing heart. His positive outlook led him to his ultimate success in the automobile industry.

Second, a positive attitude fosters your physical and emotional health. Some medical studies show that being positive is an important factor that keeps people healthy. Physically, it can strengthen your body, boost your immune system, and reduce your risk of a heart attack. Mentally, it makes you more alert, less stressed, and better at avoiding depression. What do all these mean? A positive mindset makes you live longer and better!

Lastly, a positive attitude facilitates your interpersonal relationships. Who doesn't like talking to people who always have a smile on their face? Who doesn't enjoy working with people who always put a positive spin on things they come across? A positive attitude makes your presence enjoyable, which helps you socialize on different levels and develop better relationships with others.

In conclusion, a positive attitude is the fuel that sustains your confidence, keeps you healthy, and enhances your interpersonal relationships. It is the key to success and happiness. Next time you're feeling down or frustrated, just remember that looking on the bright side can help you survive the dark times.

7 Write an essay of no less than 150 words on one of the following topics. One topic has an outline that you can follow.

Topic

Physical beauty and happiness

Introduction

Physical beauty can't bring true happiness.

Body

- Physical beauty doesn't make one truly attractive.
- Physical beauty doesn't make one truly satisfied with life.

Conclusion

Physical beauty doesn't automatically make you appealing and contented.

More topics

- What makes a person truly happy?
- Do you agree with the quote "Outer beauty is a gift. Inner beauty is an accomplishment", and why?

Section B

Reading skills

Identifying the topic sentence

A topic sentence states the main idea of a paragraph. Knowing how to identify the topic sentence is an important skill that helps you understand the main point in a paragraph.

To determine whether a sentence is a topic sentence or not, one important factor to consider is its position. A topic sentence is most typically the first sentence of a paragraph. In other words, it appears in the very beginning. Given this, you should read the first sentence of a paragraph carefully. Continue to read if you think the first sentence does not show the main idea. The next possible position is the middle of the paragraph, especially the second or the third sentence. It is also possible for a topic sentence to come at the very end of a paragraph, functioning as a summary or a conclusion.

Another factor to consider is the type of idea or information given in the sentence. The topic sentence is a general statement that can cover all other information in the paragraph. For instance, if a sentence is about several things and looks at the big picture, it is very likely the topic sentence. In contrast, sentences that provide specific details, e.g. reasons, examples, statistics, or facts, are supporting sentences.

Read the following paragraphs of Text A and see how to identify the topic sentences in them.

Example 1

The only way I know to develop my soul is through feelings. Witnessing natural phenomena – the star-lit galaxy, a centuries-old redwood, the symphony of birds' songs in spring – stretches it, making me feel humble and majestic, all at the same time. Human relationships bruise, collide, and comfort, teaching me maturity and passion. Love urges my soul to blossom and glow, and affection elicits feelings of eternity, so I learn to accept others as they are. (Para. 6)

Example 2

In other words, true beauty is not about looks. It's about choices. As we move through life and grow through each of its checkpoints, we should seek out and build the kinds of experiences that reveal and purify our inner beauty. We must look at our own lives and decisions from a more valuable perspective. (Para. 11)

Example 3

We come from numerous backgrounds and don't always approve of each other's decisions, but we care for each other the best we can. We struggle to be less self-indulgent, more

compassionate and understanding. We try to resist the lure of novelty fads and the manipulations of advertising. We survive through social phenomena that we don't agree with, through interwoven natural and unnatural disasters that take our loved ones and possessions, and through fads and fancies that are often unhealthy. From each event, we learn, we stretch, we sometimes fracture, we process the emotional outcome, and we move on. These life events are the soul's workout, and though we may groan and complain, we can feel the growth eventually. (Para. 8)

In Example 1, the topic sentence is the first sentence. It states a general idea that the only way to develop the soul is through feelings. The sentences that follow it give specific examples that explain and illustrate this idea. In Example 2, the topic sentence is the second sentence, i.e. "It's about choices." The first sentence functions as a transition from the previous paragraph. The topic sentence in Example 3 appears at the end, serving as a summary and a conclusion of the points made in the paragraph.

If you can successfully identify topic sentences, you don't have to read entire paragraphs to get their main points, and hence you can improve your reading speed and comprehension.

1 Read the following paragraphs from Text B and underline the topic sentence of each paragraph.

1 Peering into the world of little flowers adds a new dimension to my experience. It is like the stuff of dreams. Imagine that you are shrunk to the size of a beetle and start to walk through a small patch of flowers. That is how it feels like doing macro photography among these delicate and beautiful life forms. Such a sight to behold! Hopefully, this perspective will inspire you to experience and see the world for yourself. Some of the most wonderful things out there in nature and in life are free for you to explore anyway. (Para. 2)

2 A friend once asked me, "Why do you always seem to make a place more scenic than it really is in your photographs?" She said that whenever she went to any of those places, they were always dull and dreary and just didn't seem as nice. What she said made me ponder about what beauty really means. I used to think that the world was bare, gloomy, and monotonous. There was a time when I was always living in my head and living in a world so industrious that I did not stop and really look around me. I would pass by the most beautiful sunset or lily without even taking a glance. Beauty was all about success and material stuff in my eyes. I would talk about how beautiful this car or that house was, and I would miss what the world was showing me in front of my eyes; I was so preoccupied with material things that I couldn't see what was truly beautiful. (Para. 3)

3 Understanding this essence of beauty will allow us to see the world in new ways. The flowers that we pass by every day will suddenly jump out at us, beckoning us to just stop, notice, and realize how beautiful our world is. If we can really see, we will notice that wherever we go, we will always see something beautiful and interesting. (Para. 8)

Text B

The exploration of beauty

1 I am lucky to be able to live in a place that has no **scarcity** of different flowers and plants. The truth is that I never used to appreciate flowers and that it was only after I started to do photography that I started to notice the small things, like the fragrance that comes from them. I didn't know that flowers could smell so **alluring**. I must have been blind.

2 Peering into the world of little flowers adds a new dimension to my experience. It is like the stuff of dreams. Imagine that you are shrunk to the size of a **beetle** and start to walk through a small patch of flowers. That is how it feels like doing **macro** photography among these delicate and beautiful life forms. Such a sight to **behold**! Hopefully, this perspective will inspire you to experience and see the world for yourself. Some of the most wonderful things out there in nature and in life are free for you to explore anyway.

3 A friend once asked me, "Why do you always seem to make a place more **scenic** than it really is in your photographs?" She said that whenever she went to any of those places, they were always dull and **dreary** and just didn't seem as nice. What she said made me ponder about what beauty really means. I used to think that the world was **bare**, **gloomy**, and **monotonous**. There was a time when I was always living in my head and living in a world so **industrious** that I did not stop and really look around me. I would pass by the most

beautiful sunset or **lily** without even taking a glance. Beauty was all about success and material stuff in my eyes. I would talk about how beautiful this car or that house was, and I would miss what the world was showing me in front of my eyes; I was so **preoccupied** with material things that I couldn't see what was truly beautiful.

4 The fact is what we think of as reality could be an illusion. We form our concept of beauty through the filters of our accumulated experiences and preferences. We might not even see the same colors; your **perception** of red might be different from mine. How many of us can really see things the way they really are? Most of the time, the mind **distorts** reality because it has a tendency to **generalize**. There are advantages and disadvantages to these workings of the mind, but let's not discuss the disadvantages for now and focus on the advantages we have. The main advantage is that we have a choice in every moment. We have a choice to focus on the beautiful or the ugly.

5 Who we are is what our state of being is. The challenge is to be conscious enough to be positive so that we are happy and joyful all the time and the world will reflect back to us all the **existent** joyous and beautiful things in our lives. The **converse** is also true. If we are depressed and **weary**, we may automatically focus on the depressing and ugly things in life. It doesn't just stop there. Our thoughts have a cumulative effect: All the negative thoughts will attract more and more of the same, and we will end up so far down the road that it will be very difficult to get back.

6 Let's take **gratitude**, one of the most powerful emotions in life, as an example. If we are grateful for being alive, we will start to see the **splendor** of life in all other living things such as trees, flowers, animals, and other fellow humans; we will be grateful for just being here on earth and **soaking** up all the beautiful sights our world has to offer. That is one of the greatest treasures of life – to be able to witness the **intricacy** of creation.

7 **Admittedly**, we might not be able to be in a **meditative** state all the time due to the **distractions** of our thoughts, but we can

start the process of awareness by filtering our minds through understanding. The light of understanding will **dispel** the darkness of **judgmental** thoughts and allow us to see things as they really are. This understanding will make all the sights in the world more **vibrant**, more **picturesque**, and full of **vitality**; even the darkest and gloomiest scene will become the most beautiful contrast one can see and appreciate.

8 Understanding this **essence** of beauty will allow us to see the world in new ways. The flowers that we pass by every day will suddenly jump out at us, **beckoning** us to just stop, notice, and realize how beautiful our world is. If we can really see, we will notice that wherever we go, we will always see something beautiful and interesting.

9 How does one understand the miracle of a flower? If we are aware of the intelligence of the source of creation flowing around us, we will start to notice the miracle, the miracle of seeing the potential of a whole forest in a single seed, the miracle of seeing a seed **sprouting** and blossoming with all the aid and support in its life energy from the universe. If we have a conscious mind, we will see that we are well taken care of – taken care of by all the support of the intelligence that sustains all life. If we are not able to **identify** the results of this creative power from the source of life, then I am afraid that there is nothing more to see.

10 We are all here on a journey of exploration, with the world being our playground. In the end, this journey is not about the things we own because we cannot own a thing forever; it is about the way and experience of beauty exploration.

(*981 words*)

New words

▲ **scarcity** /ˈskeəsəti/ *n.* [sing., U] a situation in which there is not enough of sth. 不足；短缺；稀少

allure /əˈljʊə/
vt. tempt with sth. desirable; attract 诱惑；吸引
n. [sing., U] a mysterious, interesting, or desirable quality 诱惑；魅力；吸引力

alluring /əˈljʊərɪŋ/ *a.* attractive in an exciting way 诱人的；迷人的；吸引人的

beetle /ˈbiːtl/ *n.* [C] 甲（壳）虫

macro /ˈmækrəʊ/ *a.* large or considered in a general way 大的；宏观的

behold /bɪˈhəʊld/ *vt.* (*literary*) see or look at sb. or sth. 见到；看；注视

▲ **scenic** /ˈsiːnɪk/ *a.* providing beautiful views of nature 风景优美的

dreary /ˈdrɪəri/ *a.* dull and making you feel sad or bored 沉闷的；单调乏味的；令人沮丧的

▲ **bare** /beə/ *a.*
1 empty, not covered by anything, or not having any decorations 空的；无覆盖物的；无装饰的
2 not covered by clothes 赤裸的；裸露的

▲ **gloomy** /ˈgluːmi/ *a.*
1 dark, esp. in a way that makes you feel sad 阴暗的；幽暗的
2 making you feel that things will not improve 令人沮丧的；令人扫兴的；无望的

monotonous /məˈnɒtənəs/ *a.* boring because of always being the same 单调的；乏味的

▲ **industrious** /ɪnˈdʌstriəs/ *a.* always working very hard 勤劳的；勤奋的

▲ **lily** /ˈlɪli/ *n.* [C] 百合（花）

preoccupied /priːˈɒkjəpaɪd/ *a.* thinking about sth. so much that you do not pay attention to other things 全神贯注的；入神的

▲ **perception** /pəˈsepʃən/ *n.*
1 [U] the way that you notice things with your senses of sight, hearing, etc. 感觉；感知方式；察觉
2 [C, U] a particular way of understanding or thinking about sth. 理解；看法；认识

distort /dɪˈstɔːt/ *vt.*
1 change sth. such as information so that it is no longer true or accurate 歪曲；曲解
2 change the way that sth. looks, sounds, or behaves so that it becomes strange or unclear 使变形；使扭曲；使失真

▲ **generalize** /ˈdʒenərəlaɪz/
vi. form a general principle or opinion after considering only a small number of facts or examples 概括；归纳；总结
vt. say that an idea, result, etc. is related to a larger group 推广；普及；将…类推到

▲ **existent** /ɪgˈzɪstənt/ *a.* (*fml.*) existing now 现存的；现有的

▲ **converse** /ˈkɒnvɜːs/
n. (*fml.*) (**the ~**) the opposite of a statement or situation 相反；反面的说法或情形
a. (*fml.*) opposite 相反的；逆的

weary /ˈwɪəri/ *a.*
1 very tired or bored, esp. because you have been doing sth. for a long time (尤指因长期做某事而）筋疲力尽的，非常疲劳的，厌倦的
2 (*esp. literary*) very tiring 令人疲倦的

▲ **gratitude** /ˈgrætɪtjuːd/ *n.* [U] the feeling that you want to thank sb. because of sth. kind that they have done 感激（之情）；谢意

▲ **splendor** /ˈsplendə/ *n.*
1 [U] impressive beauty, esp. of a large building or large place 华丽；壮观；辉煌
2 (**~s**) [pl.] the beautiful and impressive features of sth. 壮丽景色；恢宏气势

▲ **soak** /səʊk/ *v.*

1 put sth. into a liquid and leave it there for a period of time 浸；泡

2 make sth. very wet, or become very wet （使）湿透；浸湿

intricacy /ˈɪntrɪkəsi/ *n.*

1 [U] the state of containing a large number of parts or details 错综复杂；盘根错节

2 [pl.] **(the intricacies of sth.)** the complicated parts or details of sth. 错综复杂的细节

▲ **admittedly** /ədˈmɪtɪdli/ *ad.* used when you are admitting that sth. is true 诚然；不可否认地

meditative /ˈmedətətɪv/ *a.*

1 thinking deeply and seriously about sth. 深思的；沉思的

2 relating to the practice of emptying your mind of thoughts and feelings, in order to relax completely or for religious reasons 冥想的；默想的

▲ **distraction** /dɪˈstrækʃən/ *n.*

1 [C, U] sth. that prevents you from concentrating on sth. else 分散注意力的事物；使人分心的事物

2 [C] an activity that you do for pleasure 消遣；娱乐

dispel /dɪˈspel/ *vt.* get rid of unpleasant feelings or false beliefs 驱散；消除；打消

judgmental /dʒʌdʒˈmentl/ *a.* (*BrE.* **judgemental**) criticizing people very quickly – used to show disapproval 动辄批评人的，爱品头论足的（含贬义）

vibrant /ˈvaɪbrənt/ *a.*

1 full of activity or energy in a way that is exciting and attractive 令人兴奋的；充满活力的

2 bright and colorful （颜色）明亮的、鲜艳的

▲ **picturesque** /ˌpɪktʃəˈresk/ *a.*

1 (esp. of a place) pretty and attractive because it is old and interesting（尤指某地因古老别致而）美丽如画的

2 (of language) unusual and interesting （语言）独特的，生动的，绘声绘色的

▲ **vitality** /vaɪˈtæləti/ *n.* [U]

1 the quality of being exciting or successful 活力；生机

2 energy or eagerness to do things 精力；干劲

▲ **essence** /ˈesəns/ *n.* [sing.] the most basic and important quality of sth. 本质；实质；要素

beckon /ˈbekən/ *v.*

1 make a signal to sb. with your hand to show that you want them to come toward you or to follow you （招手）示意；召唤

2 appear so attractive that you want to use or have it 吸引；引诱

sprout /spraʊt/

v. (of vegetables, seeds, or plants) start to grow, producing shoots, buds, or leaves （蔬菜、种子、植物）发芽，抽芽，开始长出（叶子）

vi. (*also* ~ **up**) appear suddenly in large numbers 突然大量出现；大量冒出

▲ **identify** /aɪˈdentɪfaɪ/ *vt.*

1 recognize sth. or discover exactly what it is, what its nature or origin is, etc. 确定；发现

2 recognize and correctly name sb. or sth. 认出，识别（某人或某物）

Phrases and expressions

ponder about think carefully about sth. for a long time 仔细思考；沉思；斟酌

be preoccupied with think a lot about sth. so that you hardly notice other things 全神贯注于…；对…入神

soak sth. up enjoy the effects or experience of sth. as much as possible 尽情享受；全身心融入；感受

filter sth. through remove unwanted substances from sth. by passing it through a special substance or piece of equipment
用…过滤某物；通过…过滤某物

jump out at sb. be noticed immediately
跃入某人眼帘；使某人一眼就看得出来；使某人一下子注意到

beckon (to) sb. to do sth. make a signal to sb. with your hand to show that you want them to do sth. 示意某人做某事

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

2 Choose the best answer to each of the following questions.

1 What is the author's purpose of mentioning photography in Para. 1?
- A To illustrate the abundance of beautiful scenes in nature.
- B To explain a special technique of taking photos of flowers.
- C To describe a change in his perspective on small things in life.
- D To show the link between awareness and understanding of beauty.

2 Why didn't the author notice the wonderful things around him before?
- A Because he paid too much attention to material things.
- B Because life was truly dull and dreary when he was younger.
- C Because a friend's negative attitude influenced him a lot.
- D Because he focused too much on scenic places in nature.

3 Which of the following is the author likely to disagree with according to Para. 4?
- A Our experiences have great influence on our concept of beauty.
- B Human beings may perceive colors differently from each other.
- C Most of the time our mind can perceive things the way they really are.
- D Our habit of generalizing can lead to incorrect ideas about the world.

4 Based on the text, what will happen if we focus on the negative things in life?
- A Our negative state of mind will lead to even more negative thoughts.
- B Our negative mentality will help us recognize the importance of joy.
- C We will be able to view the depressing things in life more objectively.
- D We will find it difficult to resist the attraction of beautiful things in life.

5 What does the author intend to convey by using gratitude as an example?
- A It is essential for people to witness the beautiful sights in the world.
- B It is impractical for people to understand all powerful emotions in life.
- C It is uncommon for people to notice the splendor of life in small things.
- D It is important for people to consciously develop a positive state of mind.

6 Which of the following can be inferred from Paras. 7-9?
- A It is a creative process to discover the essence of beauty.
- B It is a conscious process to develop the mindset of understanding.
- C It is unrealistic for most people to truly understand the miracle of nature.
- D It is important for people to notice the contrast between beauty and ugliness.

7 According to the author, what is most important on our journey through life?
- A The beauty we create and the things we own in the long term.
- B The miracles we witness and the support we receive from others.
- C The way we explore beauty and the experiences we have in the process.
- D The creative power we attain and the support we give to people around us.

8 What is the purpose of the text?
- A To tell an interesting life story.
- B To explain an abstract art concept.
- C To describe a method of art creation.
- D To argue for a particular perspective on life.

Critical thinking

3 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 The author mentions that doing photography changes the way he explores and appreciates beauty. Is there anything that has a similar influence on you, and what is it?
2 What do you usually do to explore the beauty of nature? Is there anything you plan to do more often, and what is it?
3 What are some of the things you are grateful for, and how do they contribute to the beauty and happiness in your life?
4 Have you ever made a conscious choice to focus on the bright side of things? How did it benefit you?
5 What do you think college students can do to explore and contribute to the beauty of our society?

Collocation

More language exercises

Topics related to beauty can trigger lots of interesting and heated discussions. For example, what defines personal beauty? Is it purely physical? Do people view ***physical perfection*** (B4U2A) differently? What constitutes ***true beauty*** (B4U2A)? How can one explore beauty in the world consciously, and why is it important to do so? The list can go on and on. We all have our own answers to these questions. But most of us probably agree that ***inner beauty*** (B4U2A) is more important than the physical attractiveness attained through expensive cosmetics, stylish clothes, or even ***extraordinary measures*** (B4U2A) such as plastic surgery. It is the beauty of the soul, rather than the beauty of the face, that makes a person ***glow radiantly*** (B4U2A). Who doesn't want to have a friend that shares ***personal aspirations*** (B4U2A) with them and inspires them with ***valuable perspectives*** (B4U2A) on life? Who doesn't want to marry a person that is ***emotionally accessible*** (B4U2A) and embodies ***authentic elements*** (B4U2A) of moral character and good personality?

In addition to personal attributes, other beautiful things in the world also help create a life of happiness. We should actively seek out and explore them in our everyday life: the ***beautiful sights*** (B4U2B) of autumn leaves, the ***creative power*** (B4U2B) of nature that makes a small seed sprout and grow into a giant tree, the ***powerful emotions*** (B4U2B) that connect us with fellow human beings ... The more we do so, the more aware of the beauty surrounding us we become. Our experiences and perceptions have a ***cumulative effect*** (B4U2B) on how we view the world. If we focus on beautiful things, we will see more brightness and joy in life; if we direct our attention to dark and ***gloomy scenes*** (B4U2B), we will have more ***negative thoughts*** (B4U2B). Thus, we should be conscious of beautiful things in life so that we will develop a positive mind and have a happy life.

4 Is beauty purely physical? Let's read different opinions about true beauty posted on the online campus community forum. Complete the short passages with appropriate collocations from the texts. Each word can be used only once.

Post A

beautiful elements inner
measures physical

Beauty is both physical and spiritual. One who has a gorgeous face but lacks the *authentic* 1) _____ of a good character is not truly beautiful. In contrast, a person with a plain appearance can have the most beautiful soul with their 2) _____ *beauty*. There are many ordinary but beautiful people in our life: those who are dedicated to their jobs, who kindly help a stranger, who sincerely care for their community ... Their acts are the most 3) _____ *sights* in the world. Some people today focus too much on their appearance and try to achieve the same degree of 4) _____ *perfection* as shown in the media through *extraordinary* 5) _____. However, mere outer beauty does not guarantee happiness. What we should value and appreciate is the beauty of the soul – the true beauty of a human being.

— *Joyce*

Post B

aspirations beauty emotionally
powerful radiantly

Like many people, I believe beauty comes from inside a person, not from appearance. Women can be very pretty, and men can be handsome, but *true* 6) _____ is not just how you look. More importantly, it's who you are. Good looks will fade with age. What stays and makes you *glow* 7) _____ is what is within you: *personal* 8) _____ and dreams, good character traits like kindness and honesty, and 9) _____ *emotions* such as love and compassion. I love the woman who's now my fiancée not because she has a slim and youthful body, but because she is kind, understanding, and 10) _____ *accessible*. The better I know her, the more beautiful she is to me.

— *David*

Post C

creative cumulative gloomy
negative valuable

To me, what makes a person beautiful is inner beauty, and the most important elements of inner beauty are intelligence and confidence. People who are intelligent can overcome challenges in life with their 11) _____ *power*. They enrich the lives of those around them with their 12) _____ *perspectives* and sharp insights. People who are confident are not easily affected by 13) _____ *thoughts*. They don't focus on the dark and 14) _____ *scenes* in the world. This positive thinking has a(n) 15) _____ *effect* and contributes to other traits such as optimism. People often say, "Outer beauty pleases the eye. Inner beauty captivates the heart." As I grow older, I understand its true meaning better.

— *John*

Stories of China

A beautiful heart that has made a difference

Ma Jun was once a promising college teacher in Xi'an, the capital of western China's Shaanxi Province, but she quit the city in 2010 to teach at Mata School, a village school in the province's mountainous north. The school was set up by her father in 1992 for children whose parents had sought work in cities.

Ma was born and raised in Mata Village, Zizhou County. Without Mata School, she would have needed to walk a long way to attend the nearest school. Even today, there is still only a limited bus service from Mata village to downtown Zizhou.

When she was young, Ma dreamed of becoming an athlete and competing in the Olympics. When she was in middle school, she made it to the Shaanxi provincial women's wrestling team. But she had to give up that dream after suffering a serious injury to her left knee during training.

In 2005 she graduated from Xi'an Physical Education University and became a teacher at a different college. Five years later, she chose to start a new life at her hometown school, where her father was still working as the school principal. Not surprisingly, her courage to quit her secure job in the city and go back to a small village impressed many people.

Now Ma is a teacher and "mother" to several hundred pupils at Mata School, taking care of the youngest children, teaching physical education classes, and playing a key role

in designing its teaching strategies and curriculum.

Ma's return has made a great difference to the school, especially in terms of its curriculum. The school day was previously all about study in the classroom, but Ma added exercise, art, and scientific experiments. Optional classes in *yangge* (a local dance), martial arts, and modern dance were also introduced, and various contests, including singing and calligraphy (书法) competitions, started to be held.

Ma has also taken Mata pupils to perform at local television stations and in national art festivals, where their performance of *yangge* won much applause. Mata pupils also went to Beijing to compete with children from other cities in a children's reality show.

Thanks to Ma's efforts, Mata School has developed into a boarding school (寄宿学校) with a much larger number of teachers and pupils. When asked if she had any regrets, Ma said, "I'm doing it with my heart. I'm happy, and that's enough."

Exercises

Translation

Translate the following paragraph into English.

水墨画（ink wash painting）是中国传统艺术形式之一，是中国国画（traditional Chinese painting）的代表。它大约始于唐代，兴盛（prosper）于宋代和元代。在其一千多年的历史中，水墨画经历了不断的发展、提高和完善。水墨画的主要创作工具和材料有毛笔、宣纸（rice paper）和墨，作品的艺术特点也与此紧密相关。水墨画在中国绘画史上具有很高的地位，甚至被认为是衡量东方绘画艺术水平的标准。

Unit project

Discovering and enhancing your inner beauty

As we have read in Text A, what makes a person truly beautiful is inner beauty, and attaining the highest degree of beauty is a process of growth. An important part of this process is to examine, understand, and improve ourselves. In this unit project, you will work in groups to talk about your inner beauty and your ideas of how to enhance it.

Step 1 **Think about your answers to the following questions and write down the key points.**

- What elements of inner beauty do you think you already have? Give one or two examples to illustrate your answer.
- What elements of inner beauty do you need to develop or enhance, and what do you plan to do to achieve them?

Step 2 **Work in groups of four or five, and talk about your inner beauty and your ideas of how to enhance it. Use the following table to take notes during the discussion.**

Group members (names)	Inner beauty elements you already have	Example(s)	Inner beauty elements to be enhanced	Plan for enhancement

Step 3 **Vote for the best plan in your group and work together to make it more complete.**

Step 4 **Give a presentation in class on the plan your group has prepared.**

Unit 3

Business success in the new age

Business is not just doing deals; business is having great products, doing great engineering, and providing tremendous service to customers. Finally, business is a cobweb of human relationships.

— Ross Perot
(*American businessman*)

Preview

Science, technology, and globalization are prevalent themes in the modern age, and hence business success today oftentimes depends on **constant technological innovation** and **effective cross-cultural communication**. Innovation sparks the birth of more competitive products and more efficient services, and successful communication with partners and customers in other cultures is essential for a business to prosper in the international market.

What do you consider to be important factors for business success in the new age? As a member of China's young generation, how do you plan to bring your innovative ideas to fruition? What educational and other preparations do you need if you plan to start your own business in the future? As our country becomes more integrated into the global economy, what are good ways for you to develop adequate intercultural awareness and enhance your cross-cultural skills?

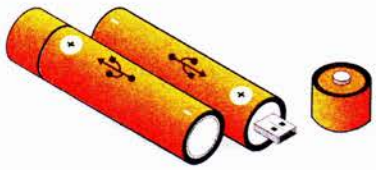
Section A

Pre-reading activities

1 Look at the pictures below and answer the following questions.

A

B



C

D

1 What are the products in the pictures? Match each of them with a product name below.

_____ (1) Bladeless electric fan
_____ (2) USB rechargeable battery
_____ (3) Drainer pot
_____ (4) Tie hanger

2 Do the products above appear innovative to you? What problem(s) in our everyday life does each of them intend to solve?

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions. Use the table to note down your answers. The first one has been given to you as an example.

What problems do you have in your day-to-day life due to the imperfect design of some products you are using? Do you have any innovative ideas to solve them?

No.	Problems	Innovative solutions
1	No space in the chair to leave a bag while I am sitting on it	We can shape the chair's backrest a little differently so that it has a strong bag hanger.
2		
3		
4		

Text A

CHINA'S NEW WAVE OF YOUNG INNOVATORS

1 It is a chilly December afternoon in Shanghai. Some 30 people are huddling together in the **interior** of a former office **block**, listening **attentively** to a presentation on how to build a small, **spider**-like insect robot. The interactive workshop is hosted by XinCheJian, China's first **makerspace**, a community-run initiative where inventors, technicians, and ordinary people meet to experiment with everything from **drones** to 3D printing.

2 As the presentation draws to a close, those in attendance – mainly young people in their 20s or 30s – talk enthusiastically about the latest inventions. A significant number of those **crammed** in this **venue** are engineering or **electronics** students, here to put their learning into practice and **showcase** their skills. Others are mere hobbyists with a passion for robotics, or **aspiring** technology professionals.

3 The origins of the maker movement can be traced back to Germany, where in 1995 a group of young programmers pooled together and began sharing a workshop space. The first decade of the new century saw the **emergence** of the movement in China too, and now it has gained ground. Entrepreneurs, and also hobbyists, have increasingly used open-source design, 3D printing, and **crowdfunding** to create hybrid art works and manufacture technology products independently. It's no longer just about "Made in China" in terms of manufacturing. On the contrary, China is becoming an essential enabler in the global maker movement on the level of invention.

4 The technological **paradigm** of the maker movement stresses the role of technology, and more widely, of innovation. Chinese officials have been supporting the growth of the movement since as far back as 2011, when the authorities in Shanghai announced a plan to launch 100 "innovation houses" in the city, offering each a considerable amount of funding. That same year, the **Administrative** Committee of Zhongguancun Science Park in Beijing announced plans to provide funding to further develop the capital's own makerspace community. A year later, the Shanghai Maker **Carnival** drew **analogous sponsorship** from the government as well.

5 Literally meaning "new workshop", XinCheJian was established in 2010. What started as a handful of people in a one-room office has now expanded to hundreds of active makers. They are working on a diverse range of projects, from a pocket-sized anti-theft device that sets off an alarm when a theft occurs, to a suspended garden that uses artificial light and soilless farming. DIY (Do-it-yourself) culture is being remade here and attracting more and more ordinary people. As a result, grassroots innovation is picking up fast – and in a unique way.

6 Founded in 2008 at the **intersection** of industrial manufacturing and makerspace culture in China, the Shenzhen-based Seeed Studio, an open-source **hardware facilitation** company, helps makers source, design, produce, and **commercialize** their ideas with creativity and diligence. Encouraging people to propose and sell their projects on-site, the studio **staff** is busy with making quick **prototypes** and manufacturing small orders.

7 "Let's say you are a maker with a limited budget to get your project into production," says Eric Pan, founder of the studio. "Seeed gives you the tools – from open-source hardware like electronic components to crowdfunding services – to bring your concept to life. It's a bottom-up approach to creativity. You no longer need to be an engineer to realize your invention and sell it on the market. We do that for you, right here in Shenzhen."

8 With its abundance of skilled labor, suppliers and service providers, Shenzhen, the bustling southern city, has become one of the centers of the Chinese maker culture. Started as a two-person company, Seeed now boasts a staff of several hundred. Having worked for numerous makers and diversified its customer base, it has become one of the world's biggest providers of technology for small-scale innovators.

9 But the Chinese maker movement is not merely a drive to make commercial products for the global market. The **momentum** of makerspaces is redefining the way people think about their work. They are hives of innovation and real-world communities where members can do what they love, seek **consultation**, take risks, and play.

10 In Beijing, Hackathons have become popular events among local makers and students. These 24- to 48-hour events see computer programmers, graphic designers, **interface** designers, and project managers come together to collaborate on software and businesses.

11 Reflecting on the growth of the movement, Justin Wang, founder of Beijing Makerspace, speaks of the importance of the makerspace community with **clarity**, "The main reason why I started Beijing Makerspace was to give people with a common interest a platform to experiment together and turn technology into something accessible to anyone, like music."

12 "There's a lot of educational and financial potential in what we're doing," says Wang. "One of our makers might develop the next big thing in the tech field. **Hence** some industry giants are **keen** to get involved. Meanwhile, the government has been expanding its support for the growth of the movement."

13 But might such top-down support **override** any decisions made by makerspaces or **clash** with the grassroots essence of the maker movement? To the founders of the makerspaces, this isn't the case. The government's involvement allows them to get a budget **allocation**, work on their own projects, and host fairs and initiatives – all are essential if they want to bring the DIY culture forward.

14 Widely hailed as an **ingenious** approach to fostering an **ecosystem** for open-source innovation, makerspaces well represent a business model that puts purpose before **earnings** and that promotes a trustworthy environment **conducive** to knowledge-sharing and co-creation. This model, in conjunction with the support of the Chinese government, will **navigate** innovation, spark creativity, help individuals, and **invigorate** the local economies and the Chinese economy as a whole.

(*938 words*)

Culture notes

Shanghai Maker Carnival: an annual gathering of do-it-yourself enthusiasts in Shanghai. First started in 2012, it is an event where different companies, organizations, and individuals come together to showcase projects, host workshops, exchange ideas, or simply mingle with like-minded people.

Hackathon: a social coding event that brings computer programmers and other interested people together to improve upon or create new software programs. The word is a combination of the words *hacker*, which means a person who knows a lot about computers, and *marathon*, an event marked by endurance. Hackathon is also known as a *hack day* or *hackfest*.

New words

▲ **interior** /ɪnˈtɪəriə/

n. [C, usu. sing.] the inner part or inside of sth. 内部；里面

a. (*only before noun*) inside or indoors 内部的；里面的；室内的

▲ **block** /blɒk/ *n.* [C]

1 a large building with a lot of different levels 大楼；大厦

2 an area of buildings in a town or city with streets on all four sides （四面临街的）街段，街区

▲ **attentive** /əˈtentɪv/ *a.*

1 listening to or watching sth. or sb. carefully 注意听的；专注的；专心的

2 making sure sb. has everything they need 周到的；体贴的

attentively /əˈtentɪvli/ *ad.*

1 with attention 专注地；专心地

2 with careful consideration 周到地；体贴地

spider /ˈspaɪdə/ *n.* [C] 蜘蛛

makerspace /ˈmeɪkəˌspeɪs/ *n.* [C] a place where people can come together to create or invent things, either using traditional crafts or technology 创客空间

drone /drəʊn/ *n.*

1 [C] an aircraft that does not have a pilot, but is operated by radio 无人机

2 [sing.] a continuous low dull sound 嗡嗡声

cram /kræm/

vt. put people or things into a space that is too small 把…塞入

vi. (of people) go into a place or vehicle so it is then full （人）挤进，挤满

venue /ˈvenjuː/ *n.* [C] a place where an organized meeting, concert, etc. takes place 举办地点；举行场所；会场

▲ **electronics** /ɪˌlekˈtrɒnɪks/ *n.* [U]

1 the science and technology that uses or produces electronic equipment 电子学；电子工业

2 electronic equipment or equipment with electronic parts 电子设备；电子仪器

showcase /ˈʃəʊkeɪs/

vt. present sb.'s abilities or the good qualities of sth. in an attractive way 展示；使亮相

n. [C] an event or situation that is designed to show the good qualities of a person, organization, product, etc. 显示优点的事件；亮相的场合

aspire /əˈspaɪə/ *vi.* desire and work toward achieving sth. important 追求；渴望；有志于

aspiring /əˈspaɪərɪŋ/ *a.* (*only before noun*) hoping to be successful in a particular job, activity, or way of life 有抱负的；有志向的

▲ **emergence** /ɪˈmɜːdʒəns/ *n.* [U]

1 (~ **of**) the process of appearing or becoming recognized 出现；被认可

2 (~ **from**) the process of stopping being involved in a difficult situation or period of time 摆脱（困境）

crowdfunding /ˈkraʊdˌfʌndɪŋ/ *n.* [U] the practice of funding a project or an activity by raising many small amounts of money from a large number of people, usu. using the Internet 众筹

paradigm /ˈpærədaɪm/ *n.* [C]

1 a model or example that shows how sth. works or is produced （展示工作原理或制作方法的）模型，例子

2 (*fml.*) a very clear or typical example of sth. 示例；范例；样式

▲ **administrative** /ədˈmɪnəstrətɪv/ *a.* relating to the work of managing a company or organization 行政的；管理的

carnival /ˈkɑːnəvəl/ *n.*

1 [C, U] a public event at which people play music, wear special clothes, and dance in the streets 狂欢（节）；嘉年华

2 [C] (*AmE*) a noisy outdoor event at which you can ride on special machines and play games for prizes 游乐场；户外游艺会

analogous /əˈnæləgəs/ *a.* (*fml.*) similar to another

situation or thing so that a comparison can be made 相似的；类似的

▲ **sponsorship** /ˈspɒnsəʃɪp/ *n.*

1 [pl., U] financial support for an activity or event（对活动或赛事的）赞助，资助

2 [U] the act of sponsoring sb. or sth., or of being sponsored 资助；倡议

intersection /ˌɪntəˈsekʃən/ *n.*

1 [C, U] the point where two things come together and have an effect on each other 交汇点；交叉

2 [C] a place where roads, lines, etc. cross each other, esp. where two roads meet（尤指两条道路的）交叉口，十字路口；（线的）交叉点

▲ **hardware** /ˈhɑːdweə/ *n.* [U]

1 computer machinery and equipment, as opposed to the programs that make computers work（计算机）硬件

2 equipment and tools for your home and garden（家用和园艺用的）金属器件；五金制品

▲ **facilitation** /fəˌsɪlɪˈteɪʃən/ *n.* [U, sing.] (*fml.*) the process or fact of making sth. possible or easier 促进；简易化

▲ **commercialize** /kəˈmɜːʃəlaɪz/ *vt.*

1 sell sth. completely new to the public for the first time 使商品化（指首次公开发售）

2 (*usu. passive*) be more concerned with making money from sth. than about its quality – used to show disapproval 使商业化，使成为赚钱手段（含贬义）

▲ **staff** /stɑːf/ *n.* [sing., U] the people who work for a particular company, organization, or institution 全体职员；员工

prototype /ˈprəʊtətaɪp/ *n.* [C]

1 the first form that a new design of a car, machine, etc. has, or a model of it used to test the design before it is produced（新型汽车、机器等的）原型，雏形

2 sb. or sth. that is one of the first and most typical examples of a group or situation 典型；样板

momentum /məʊˈmentəm/ *n.* [U]

1 the ability to keep increasing, developing, or being more successful 动力；势头

2 the force that makes a moving object keep moving（使运动物体继续运动的）冲力，推力，动力

▲ **consultation** /ˌkɒnsəlˈteɪʃən/ *n.*

1 [U] the process of getting advice from a professional person 专家咨询

2 [C, U] a discussion in which people who are affected by or involved in sth. can give their opinions 商量；磋商

interface /ˈɪntəfeɪs/ *n.* [C] the way in which you see the information from a computer program on a screen, or how you type information into the program 界面（指计算机屏幕布局）

▲ **clarity** /ˈklærəti/ *n.* [U]

1 the ability to be easily understood 清晰；明晰

2 the ability to think clearly or understand things clearly 清晰的思维（或理解、记忆）能力

▲ **hence** /hens/ *ad.* (*fml.*) for this reason 因此；由此；所以

▲ **keen** /kiːn/ *a.*

1 wanting to do sth. or wanting sth. to happen very much; eager 热衷的；渴望的；热切的

2 (**be ~ on sb. / sth.**) like sb. or sth. 喜欢

override /ˌəʊvəˈraɪd/ *vt.*

1 use your power or authority to change sb. else's decision（以权力或权威）否决；改变（别人的决定）

2 be much more important than sth. else 比…更重要；凌驾

▲ **clash** /klæʃ/

vi. (of two opinions, statements, or qualities) be very different from each other（两种意见、声明或品质）有分歧，不相容，相抵触

n. [C] an argument between two people or groups because they have different beliefs or opinions 争论；交锋

allocation /ˌæləˈkeɪʃən/ *n.*

1 [C] an amount or share of sth. that is given to sb. or used for a particular purpose 配给物；配给量，份额

2 [U] the process of deciding to give an amount or share of sth. to sb. 分配；分派；划拨

ingenious /ɪnˈdʒiːniəs/ *a.*

1 (of a plan, idea, or object) skillfully made or planned and involving new ideas and methods （计划、主意或物体）精巧的，巧妙的

2 (of a person) very good at inventing things or at thinking of new ideas （人）善于创造发明的，足智多谋的，心灵手巧的

ecosystem /ˈiːkəʊˌsɪstɪm/ *n.* [C] all the animals and plants in a particular area, and the way in which they are related to each other and to their environment 生态系统

▲ **earnings** /ˈɜːnɪŋz/ *n.* [pl.]

1 the profit that a company or country makes （公司或国家的）利润，收益

2 the money that you receive for the work that you do 薪水；工资

conducive /kənˈdjuːsɪv/ *a.* (*fml.*) providing the right conditions for sth. good to happen or exist 有利的；有助的；有益的

navigate /ˈnævɪgeɪt/ *v.*

1 find which way you need to go when you are traveling from one place to another （为…）导航，指引方向

2 understand or deal with sth. complicated 理解，应付（困难复杂的情况）

invigorate /ɪnˈvɪgəreɪt/ *vt.*

1 make sth. stronger or more effective 使更强健；激励

2 give sb. more energy 使精力充沛；使振作精神

Phrases and expressions

draw to a close / an end end; finish 终止；结束

put sth. into practice start to use sth. and see if it is effective 把…付诸实施

trace sth. (back) to sth. find the origins of sth. or where sth. came from 追溯；追查

gain ground make steady progress and become more popular, more successful, etc. 稳步发展；变得更受欢迎（更成功）

in terms of sth. used for saying which aspects of sth. you are considering or including 从…方面来说；根据…来解释

on the contrary in opposition to what has been stated or what is expected 正相反；恰恰相反

a handful of a very small number of people or things 几个；少数

pick up become better, stronger, etc.; improve 好转；改善；增强

bring sth. to life make sth. more real or exciting 赋予…生命；使…鲜活起来

reflect on think carefully about sth., or say sth. that you have been thinking about 仔细思考；表达（意见）

hail sth. / sb. as describe sth. or sb. as being very good 把…称赞为；把…誉为

be conducive to sth. provide conditions that make it easy for sb. to work, etc. 有助于…；有益于…

as a whole considering all the parts of sth. as one unit 总体上；整个看来

Proper names

XinCheJian 新车间（中国第一个创客空间）

the Administrative Committee of Zhongguancun Science Park 中关村科技园区管理委员会（简称中关村管委会，在北京）

Shanghai Maker Carnival 上海创客嘉年华

Seeed Studio 深圳矽递科技股份有限公司

Hackathon 编程马拉松（又译为黑客松）

Beijing Makerspace 北京创客空间

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

1 Answer the following questions.

1 What is the purpose of the first two paragraphs of the text?
2 Why are makerspaces attractive to inventors, technicians, and ordinary people?
3 When did the maker movement begin to emerge in China? Why has it developed quickly in China since then?
4 How does Seeed Studio work with makers according to Paras. 6-7?
5 What characteristics does the Chinese maker movement have?
6 Why are some Chinese industry giants keen to get involved in the maker movement?
7 How has the Chinese government's support benefited the makers?
8 Being regarded as an approach to developing an ecosystem for innovation, what do makerspaces represent in China?

Critical thinking

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 In your understanding, what can be the benefits of makerspaces to those who participate in them?
2 Do you consider yourself innovative, and how? Do you believe that some people are more innovative than others, and why?
3 What platforms can a university provide for its students to experiment with new ideas?
4 How does innovation as a company's business strategy benefit both the company itself and our society as a whole?
5 Our world continues to need new inventions to improve people's lives. What inventions do you think are much-needed today?

Language focus

Words in use

3 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

allocation analogous clarity
clash emergence keen momentum
navigate showcase venue

1 During the discussion, the professor was mostly listening and only occasionally gave a few remarks to bring _____ to the issue being discussed.
2 Today many governments around the world are _____ to invest in technology to tackle social and environmental problems.
3 Situated in the heart of the town, the hotel is an ideal _____ for business meetings, weddings, and other large group events.
4 For small businesses, online videos are a great way to _____ their products or services to new and existing customers.
5 The _____ and rapid growth of e-commerce has reshaped the way business is conducted, making online shopping an integral part of our life.
6 The new kindergarten will get a generous _____ of funds to improve its outdoor facilities.
7 His job involves deciding on matters with different objectives that often _____ with each other, e.g., company profits vs. investor returns.
8 The structures of the wings of a bird and a butterfly are _____ because they are basically similar in shape and function.
9 Despite challenges, the Chinese economy continues to enjoy strong _____ and remains a crucial contributor to world economic growth.
10 As the company's first CFO for many years, Bob has played a leading role in _____ the company through a significant growth period.

Word building

-ity

与某些形容词结合构成名词，表示形容词所描述对象的状态或情况。

minor		minority
sincere		sincerity
stable		stability
absurd	>	**absurdity**
neutral		**neutrality**
severe		**severity**
valid		**validity**

-ous

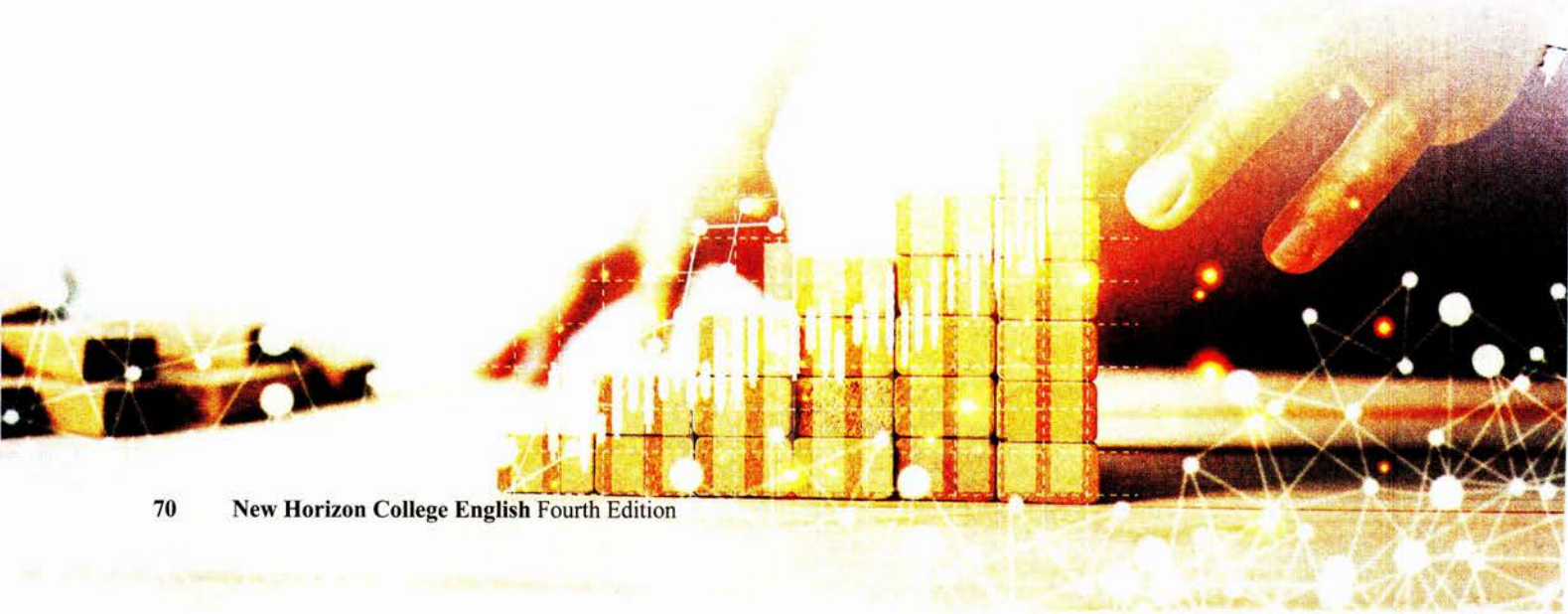
与某些动词和名词结合构成形容词，表示某人或某物具有某种特质。其拼写有多种变形，最常见的有 -eous、-ious 和 -uous。

advantage		advantageous
ambition		ambitious
continue		continuous
fame	>	famous
miracle		**miraculous**
ruin		**ruinous**
volume		**voluminous**

4 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

absurdity　miraculous　neutrality
ruinous　severity　validity　voluminous

1 It has been well-documented that excessive exposure to toxic air pollutants can have _____ effects on people's health.
2 Given the _____ of the climate crisis and the urgency of addressing it, it is imperative that the world cut its greenhouse gas emissions to a much lower level.
3 As the snow got heavier and heavier, he realized the _____ of driving a long distance in such bad weather in the evening just to buy a pair of shoes.
4 China's economic development has been _____ in the past decades, with an average annual GDP growth rate unparalleled by other countries.
5 In writing an argumentative essay, it is important to support your point of view with adequate details to ensure the _____ of your argument.
6 This data file is _____ and downloading it may take excessive time if your Internet speed is slow.
7 To help resolve the conflict between his two best friends, he tried to maintain _____ and not favor either side with undue comments.



Banked cloze

5 Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

A	accomplishments	**F**	deducible	**K**	navigates
B	aspires	**G**	diversify	**L**	positive
C	attached	**H**	harbor	**M**	priority
D	clarity	**I**	ingenious	**N**	severity
E	compliments	**J**	motivated	**O**	strike

Welcome to our special edition "Building Better Businesses". As is well recognized, the business world is changing. For the new generation of entrepreneurs, setting up a Silicon Valley social media venture isn't their dream. Instead, their 1) _____ is clear: building a company that has a purpose at its heart. These founders speak with 2) _____ that they want their companies to have a social or environmental impact as well as to make money. They want to play a role in their communities, 3) _____ a balance between work and private life, and invest for the long term rather than for quick profits.

At the same time, older people are becoming more active in entrepreneurship, too, as they find they still 4) _____ the dream of setting up their own business and now have the confidence to take the risk. With people living longer and starting to seek more 5) _____ in later life, this trend will surely continue to grow in the future. Plus, it is noted that older founders are more 6) _____ to succeed in business than their younger counterparts (相对应者) because they believe they have more experience and wisdom.

Our special edition intends to help you build a better business, whether you are an ambitious individual who 7) _____ to launch an independent company and strives to make a(n) 8) _____ impact on the world, or whether you are already a business owner and are looking for inspiration to 9) _____ your services. Whatever your story, we hope you will find all the 10) _____ ideas, helpful tips, instructions, and insights you need in this guide. So, why not begin your exploration with us now?

Expressions in use

6 Fill in the blanks with the expressions given below. Change the form where necessary. Each expression can be used only once.

be conducive to　bring … to life
draw to a close　gain ground　hail … as
put … into practice　reflect on
trace … back to

1 Over the last decade, the trend toward working from home has slowly _____ across the country.
2 Many students have _____ the experience of participating in the summer camp _____ life-changing and the best time they've ever had.
3 These workshops provide students with opportunities to experiment with different techniques and _____ what they have learned _____ in a supportive environment.
4 The artist restored the painting and _____ it _____, revealing the fine colors of the rainbow, which were lost beneath layers of dirt.
5 When students are exposed to environments that _____ learning, the chances of achieving their educational goals increase.
6 We should be open to new ways of thinking, _____ what we do, and strive to improve ourselves on the basis of our experience.
7 Several hours later, the budget meeting _____ and the board members filed out of the room.
8 Some research suggests that the history of the Mid-Autumn Festival can _____ more than 3,000 years ago.

Structure analysis and writing

Structure analysis

Using supporting details in an expository essay

In B4U1, you have learned how to write an expository essay, with the focus on the features, types, and structure of an expository essay. In this unit, you will learn more about expository writing, but with the focus on supporting details.

The term *supporting details* can be defined as additional information that explains, defines, or proves an idea. They are details that make it easier for the reader to understand an idea or a claim in an essay.

There are different types of supporting details. They usually include:

- examples
- narrative details
- descriptive details
- statistics
- quotations

When you write an essay, no matter whether it's narrative, expository, or argumentative, you may find that you are using a combination of these different types of supporting details. Take Text A of this unit, for example. It is an expository piece of writing in which the author uses several different types of supporting details to build the reader's knowledge about the development of the maker movement in China.

Example 1

The technological paradigm of the maker movement stresses the role of technology, and more widely, of innovation. Chinese officials have been supporting the growth of the movement since as far back as 2011, when the authorities in Shanghai announced a plan to launch 100 "innovation houses" in the city, offering each a considerable amount of funding. That same year, the Administrative Committee of Zhongguancun Science Park in Beijing announced plans to provide funding to further develop the capital's own makerspace community. A year later, the Shanghai Maker Carnival drew analogous sponsorship from the government as well. (Para. 4)

In this paragraph, examples and narrative details are used to explain how Chinese authorities have been supporting the growth of the maker movement in China. The author gives three examples about the support provided by the government authorities in Shanghai and Beijing. These examples are presented in chronological order.

Example 2

"Let's say you are a maker with a limited budget to get your project into production," says Eric Pan, founder of the studio. "Seeed gives you the tools – from open-source hardware like electronic components to crowdfunding services – to bring your concept to life. It's a bottom-up approach to creativity. You no longer need to be an engineer to realize your invention and sell it on the market. We do that for you, right here in Shenzhen." (Para. 7)

In this paragraph, the author directly quotes the remarks of Eric Pan, founder of Seeed Studio, to help the reader understand how Seeed Studio helps makers turn their project ideas into physical products.

Example 3

With its abundance of skilled labor, suppliers and service providers, Shenzhen, the bustling southern city, has become one of the centers of the Chinese maker culture. Started as a two-person company, Seeed now boasts a staff of several hundred. Having worked for numerous makers and diversified its customer base, it has become one of the world's biggest providers of technology for small-scale innovators. (Para. 8)

In this paragraph, the author makes use of some statistics, such as *started as a two-person company*, *now boasts a staff of several hundred*, *worked for numerous makers*, and *has become one of the world's biggest providers of* ..., to illustrate the fast development of the maker culture in China.

Structured writing

Read the sample essay and see how to use different types of supporting details.

Topic
Qingdao International Beer Festival

Introduction
A brief description of what the Qingdao International Beer Festival is like

Body
- General information about the event
- Countries where participating beer brands are from
- Food that people can enjoy at the event
- Entertainment and beer-drinking activities at the event

Conclusion
Significance of the event

Music, food, tourists, massive beer tents, beer tasting, drinking contests, trade exhibitions, and performances – what a spectacular carnival scene! Yes, it's the Qingdao International Beer Festival, a grand and exciting summer event with an exotic flavor held annually in Qingdao, Shandong Province of China.

First held in 1991, the beer festival now has developed into one of the largest of its kind in Asia. Rated as one of China's most popular tourist events, it is held every summer and attracts millions of attendees each year.

While the crowd at the event is primarily Chinese, the beer comes from all over the world. Besides the obvious Chinese Tsingtao, there are brands from Germany, Japan, the Netherlands, Denmark, Singapore, the U.S., and so on. With more than 1,000 types of beer available, the attendees can choose whatever flavor to taste.

In addition to all that beer, there is plenty of food at the festival. Food stands, shops, and restaurants are everywhere. Attendees can eat their fill with snack food like fish balls, stinky tofu, grilled meat and squid, as well as staple food like dumplings, noodles, and fried rice.

The highlights of the festival also include a large variety of entertainment events. Music of all types is played, from pop songs to classics. At night, the scene becomes even livelier, with gala performances, colorful fountains, and laser shows arousing the amazement of the audience, and with crowds in every beer tent toasting one another with giant glasses. Just as one local attendee put it, "Without beer, we don't have life in Qingdao. To us, this event is more important than the Chinese New Year."

With beer as a medium, the Qingdao International Beer Festival integrates tourism, cultural exchanges, economy, and trade into one comprehensive event. It has helped people get to know Qingdao better and has promoted friendship between the local people and those from other places. Also, it has brought and will continue to bring great economic and cultural benefits to the city.

7 Write an expository essay of no less than 150 words on one of the following topics. One topic has an outline that you can follow.

Topic

Organic food

Introduction

Organic food is believed by many to be safer and healthier than conventional food and better for the environment as well.

Body

- Organic food is safer than conventional food.
- Organic food is healthier than conventional food.
- Organic food is better for the environment.

Conclusion

Though the price of organic food is often higher, many people believe that its benefits fully compensate for this disadvantage.

More topics

- The Dragon Boat Festival / Duanwu Festival
- Various clubs at universities

Section B

Reading skills

Finding out word meanings

When we come across an unfamiliar word in reading, we do not always have to pause and consult a dictionary. We can often use various context clues to figure out the meaning of the new word.

Context clues refer to information in the context that can help us understand unfamiliar words. Common context clues include synonyms, antonyms, definitions or explanations, examples, and word formation.

1 **Synonyms:** A synonym is a word that has the same or nearly the same meaning as another word.

Others are mere hobbyists with a passion for robotics, or aspiring technology professionals. (Para. 2, Text A)

The word *aspiring* occurs in a phrase that is connected with the preceding phrase by a conjunction *or*. This gives us a hint that the meaning of *aspiring* may be more or less similar to *with a passion*. Hence, we can infer that it may mean "hoping to be successful" or "desiring to achieve sth.".

2 **Antonyms:** An antonym is a word that means the opposite of another word.

Are these reports truly accurate or do they exaggerate the situation?

The conjunction *or* connects two possibilities. Since one is that the reports are *accurate*, we can safely predict that *exaggerate* means roughly the opposite of *be accurate*.

3 **Definitions or explanations:** A definition or explanation is a statement or phrase that gives the meaning of an unfamiliar word.

The monsoon is the season in Southern Asia when there is a lot of very heavy rain.

The part after *monsoon* gives a clear definition that explains what the monsoon is.

The interactive workshop is hosted by XinCheJian, China's first makerspace, a community-run initiative where inventors, technicians, and ordinary people meet to experiment with everything from drones to 3D printing. (Para. 1, Text A)

In this example, an explanation of the new term *makerspace* is given in the phrase that comes after the word, i.e. *a community-run initiative where inventors, technicians, and ordinary people meet to experiment with everything ...*

4 **Examples:** Examples provide more details that can help us infer the meaning of a new word.

Celestial bodies, including the sun, moon, and stars, have fascinated man through centuries.

Based on the examples given in the sentence, i.e. *the sun*, *moon*, *and stars*, we can infer that celestial bodies are objects in the sky.

5 **Word formation:** Word formation refers to how root words, prefixes, and suffixes are combined to form new words. If you know the meanings of a root word and the common prefixes and suffixes, you are very likely to figure out the meaning of an unfamiliar word in a sentence.

Founded in 2008 at the intersection of industrial manufacturing and makerspace culture in China, the Shenzhen-based Seeed Studio, an open-source hardware facilitation company, helps makers source, design, produce, and commercialize their ideas with creativity and diligence. (Para. 6, Text A)

The suffix *-ize* is often added to adjectives or nouns to form verbs meaning "to become or make sth. become ...", so we can infer that *commercialize* means "to make sth. commercial" or "to make money from sth.".

To summarize, when we encounter a new word, we can figure out its meaning by using various clues in the context. Because a large proportion of our vocabulary is gained through reading, it is important for us to recognize and make full use of context clues to find out word meanings.

1 Read the following sentences from Text B and try to figure out the meaning of each underlined word.

1 Kevin was put in charge of finalizing a merger with a company in the United Arab Emirates (UAE). (Para. 3)
A complete the arrangements for sth.
B collect important facts about sth.
C improve the flexibility of sth.
D evaluate the finance of sth.

2 He was treated with extraordinary hospitality: an elaborate hotel, blue ribbon foods, elegant convertibles with drivers to tour the city, a parade of entertainment, and beautiful gifts to commemorate the visit. (Para. 5)
A blue-colored B essential
C affordable D high-quality

3 His progress toward closing the deal was exactly where it was when he left the U.S.: nil. (Para. 6)
A something B nothing
C a big amount D a small amount

4 The above case is a classic example of how friction between different cultural expectations causes delay that, if not handled appropriately, will bring the deal to an abrupt end and leave both sides reeling. (Para. 7)
A comparison B relationship
C similarity D disagreement

5 They are much harder to understand than the glossary of terms in any culture's language phrase book. (Para. 14)
A a set of learning principles
B a set of practice guidelines
C a list of words and their meanings
D a list of books and their writers

Text B

Culture makes the business world go round

1 Edward Hall, a leader in the field of intercultural studies, famously said: "The single greatest barrier to business success is the one **erected** by culture." Can cultural differences have as big an impact on international businesses as financial planning and visionary leadership? The surprising answer is: Yes!

2 A good example is the role of relationships in business dealings. While relationships play only a minor role in the business cultures of Western European and North American countries, they play a significant role in many Asian and African countries. In these cultures, fostering solid and trustworthy personal connections **underlies** the way for business to go more smoothly.

3 Let's take the example of Kevin Johnston, a senior vice-president of a U.S. company **specializing** in hospitality management. Kevin was put in charge of **finalizing** a merger with a company in the United Arab Emirates (UAE). Virtually all of the **complicated** negotiations had been completed. What remained was a three-day trip to the UAE for face-to-face meetings between the partners to sign the paperwork and close the deal.

4 Kevin was determined that nothing would **detain** him from succeeding. He sent out a **memorandum** across his company, enthusiastically informing all the staff about the planned merger with the UAE partner. Having **compiled** all the necessary documents and **graphs**, with every figure and **decimal** in place, and having prepared a thorough **exposition certifying** the quality of his company, he packed his briefcase and headed for the UAE.

5 Kevin arrived in the UAE, excited to seal the deal. He was treated with extraordinary hospitality: an elaborate hotel, **blue ribbon** foods, elegant **convertibles** with drivers to tour the city, a **parade** of entertainment, and beautiful gifts to commemorate the visit. He tried repeatedly to bring out his files, open the conversation and get down to business. But, surprisingly, for the three days he spent in the UAE, none of his Emirate colleagues seemed ready to hear his financial **briefing**. Each time Kevin tried to speak about the deal, his **prospective** partners seemed to "**kidnap**" the conversation, **diverting** it to other topics. They would inquire about his health, family, or views on education and other important issues.

6 Upon leaving the UAE, Kevin felt **exasperated** and defeated. He hadn't got an opportunity to receive the thorough "**interrogation**" of the materials for which he had so carefully prepared. His progress toward closing the deal was exactly where it was when he left the U.S.: **nil**.

7 The above case is a classic example of how **friction** between different cultural expectations causes delay that, if not handled **appropriately**, will bring the deal to an abrupt end and leave both sides **reeling**. The substantial loss of revenue can never be **refunded** and can leave a struggling company falling without a **parachute**.

8 Kevin made the mistake of assuming that the "certifications" involved in sealing the deal were in his briefcase. He charged into the meetings like a **bull**. For many cultures, a person's certifications are established not only by their accomplishments, education, and abilities, but also more importantly by their personal connections. In this case, the UAE partners wanted to know if Kevin was a good man, a family man, and a trustworthy man. This type of **rating** establishes a trusting relationship for them. Had Kevin patiently taken the time to establish relationships, he would likely have been asked to share his carefully prepared documents and have closed the deal.

9 Sociologists agree that another key aspect influencing global business is the concept of face. Cross-cultural differences in the way we save face impact our perceptions of trust and respect, which in turn impact our relationships and group **cohesion**.

10 Take the example of Ann, a U.S. manager who took a reactionary approach to cultural differences. Ann thought being a **nominee** for the leadership position with a sales team based in Singapore was a **climax** of her career. All members of the team except Ann herself were from various Asian countries, and Ann tried to establish a working relationship with each of them. After a few weeks of working on team **unification** and **solidarity**, presenting guidelines, and offering sales advice, she carefully compartmentalized goals for each member of the sales team.

11 Later, when the team **convened** face to face for their first quarterly review meeting, Ann, after praising one team member, boldly criticized and questioned another, trying to **extract** the exact reason why he was lagging so far behind on his goals. The meeting immediately lost its **groove**. The entire group became solemn and, for the rest of the meeting, remained polite but largely **mute**.

12 Clearly, Ann was not familiar with the concept of saving face in other cultures. In U.S. culture, saving face exists – but only minimally, and instead **tactful** but **straightforward** language is highly valued. U.S. managers routinely speak freely about someone else's accomplishments or failures in open, public settings, such as during meetings. This is different in many Asian cultures. Singling out an individual due to praise or criticism, a daily habit amongst American managers, may cause Asians to become uncomfortable or deeply embarrassed.

13 Ann needs to consider more culturally appropriate ways to support and motivate her team. Providing feedback, especially negative feedback, in more private settings will be helpful. Most of all, she should work on giving more **courteous** and supportive praise and encouragement, which will help her team move toward the unification and cohesion that high functioning teams need in order to be successful.

14 Around the world, deeper structures such as relationship building and face saving are embedded in the values, beliefs, and behavior of a culture. They are much harder to understand than the **glossary** of terms in any culture's language phrase book. The advice is: Always ask for clarification and seek new insights. For business success, it is essential to learn to **mediate** these deeper cultural differences. Though it may be a little complicated to **incorporate** them into your way of thinking and communicating, it is well worth the effort!

(*996 words*)

Culture notes

Edward Hall: a famous American scholar in anthropology and intercultural communication. He is considered one of the founding fathers of intercultural communication as an academic area of study.

the United Arab Emirates: sometimes called the Emirates or the UAE. It is a Western Asian country located along the eastern coast of the Arabian Peninsula. It consists of seven emirates, with Abu Dhabi (阿布扎比) being its capital.

New words

erect /ɪˈrekt/ *vt.* (*fml.*)
1 create or establish sth. 创立；设立
2 build sth. 建造；建立

underlie /ˌʌndəˈlaɪ/ *vt.* (*fml.*) be the real or basic cause of or reason for sth. 构成…的基础；是…的起因

▲ **specialize** /ˈspeʃəlaɪz/ *vi.* spend most of your time studying one particular subject or doing one type of business 专门研究；专攻；专门从事

▲ **finalize** /ˈfaɪnəlaɪz/ *vt.* make the final decisions or arrangements concerning sth. 最后决定；最后定下；确定

▲ **complicated** /ˈkɒmplɪkeɪtɪd/ *a.*
1 difficult to deal with or understand, because many parts or details are involved 复杂的；难懂的；难处理的
2 made up of many different but connected parts 结构复杂的

detain /dɪˈteɪn/ *vt.*
1 (*fml.*) stop sb. from leaving somewhere or doing sth. 耽搁；阻留
2 keep sb. in a police station or prison and not allow them to leave 拘留；扣押；羁押

▲ **memorandum** /ˌmeməˈrændəm/ *n.* [C] (*pl.* **memoranda** *or* **memorandums**)
1 (*fml.*) a short official note to another person in the same company or organization （公司或机构内部传递的）公务便条，备忘录
2 a short legal document that contains the important details of an agreement 协议备忘录

compile /kəmˈpaɪl/ *vt.*
1 make sth. such as a list or book by bringing together information from many different places 编写；编纂；汇编
2 put a set of instructions into a computer in a form that it can understand and use 编译（计算机语言）

▲ **graph** /grɑːf/ *n.* [C] a drawing that uses lines or curves to show the relationship between numbers or measurements that change 图表

decimal /ˈdesəməl/
n. [C] 小数
a. based on the number 10 十进位的

exposition /ˌekspəˈzɪʃən/ *n.*
1 [C, U] (*fml.*) a clear and detailed explanation, or the activity of giving such an explanation 解释；阐述；说明
2 [C] a public event or show of industrial products or technology （工业品或技术的）博览会，展览会

certify /ˈsɜːtɪfaɪ/ *vt.*
1 state that sth. is correct or true, esp. after some kind of test （尤指经过某种检验）证明，证实，核证
2 give an official paper to sb. which states that they have completed a course of training for a profession 给（某人）颁发合格证书

▲ **ribbon** /ˈrɪbən/ *n.*
1 [C] (*AmE*) a small piece of colored cloth given to sb. who has won a prize in a competition （授予竞赛获奖者的）绶带
2 [C, U] a long narrow piece of colored cloth or paper, usu. used as a decoration or to tie sth. 彩纸带；丝带；绸带

blue ribbon *a.* (*only before noun*)
1 of the highest quality and considered the best 一流的；最棒的
2 (of a candidate) winning first prize in a competition （选手）获冠军的，得第一名的

▲ **convertible** /kənˈvɜːtəbəl/
n. [C] a car with a roof that can be folded back and removed completely 折篷轿车
a. able to be changed from one form, use, or system into another 可转变的；可转化的；可转换的

▲ **parade** /pəˈreɪd/ *n.* [C]
1 a line or a series of people or things 一排，一系列（人或物）
2 a public celebration in which a large group

of people move through an area, often with decorated vehicles and music bands（庆祝）游行

▲ **briefing** /ˈbriːfɪŋ/ *n.*

1 [C, U] information or instructions given to sb. just before they do sth. 情况简介；简明指示

2 [C] a meeting or document in which people receive information or instructions 情况介绍会；简报

▲ **prospective** /prəˈspektɪv/ *a.* (*only before noun*)

1 likely to do a particular thing or achieve a particular position 可能的；潜在的；有希望的

2 likely or expected to happen 可能发生的；预期的

kidnap /ˈkɪdnæp/ *vt.* take sb. somewhere illegally by force, often in order to get money for returning them 绑架；劫持

divert /daɪˈvɜːt/ *vt.*

1 make sth. move or travel in a different direction 使转向；使改变方向

2 use sth. for a purpose that is different from its original or main purpose 改变，转变（某物的用途）

exasperated /ɪgˈzɑːspəreɪtɪd/ *a.* very annoyed and upset 恼怒的；极厌烦的

interrogation /ɪnˌterəˈgeɪʃən/ *n.* [C, U] the process of asking sb. a lot of questions in order to get information, usu. in an angry or threatening way 讯问；审问；盘问

nil /nɪl/ *n.* [U]

1 nothing; zero 无；零

2 (*BrE*) the number zero, used in sports results（体育比赛比分中的）零

friction /ˈfrɪkʃən/ *n.*

1 [C, U] disagreement, angry feelings, or unfriendliness between people（人们之间的）不和，分歧，摩擦

2 [U] the fact that one thing rubs against another 摩擦

▲ **appropriate** /əˈprəʊpriət/ *a.* suitable or right for a particular time, situation, or purpose 恰当的；合适的

appropriately /əˈprəʊpriətli/ *ad.* 恰当地；合适地

reel /riːl/ *vi.*

1 be confused or shocked by a situation 迷惑；震惊

2 (~ **in**) bring a fish toward you by winding the fishing rod 收线；卷线

refund

vt. /riˈfʌnd/ give sb. their money back, esp. because they are not satisfied with the goods or services they have paid for 退还（钱款）

n. /ˈriːfʌnd/ [C] an amount of money you get back if you are not satisfied with the goods or services that you have paid for 退款

parachute /ˈpærəʃuːt/ *n.* [C] 降落伞

▲ **bull** /bʊl/ *n.* [C]

1 an adult male animal of the cattle family 公牛

2 sb. who buys shares because they expect prices to rise 多头（股市看涨的人）

▲ **rating** /ˈreɪtɪŋ/ *n.* [C] a level on a scale that shows how good, important, popular, etc. sb. or sth. is 等级；级别；程度

▲ **cohesion** /kəʊˈhiːʒən/ *n.* [U] a situation in which people or things combine well to form a unit 团结；凝聚（力）；黏合

nominee /ˌnɒməˈniː/ *n.* [C] sb. who has been officially suggested for a position or prize 被提名者

▲ **climax** /ˈklaɪmæks/ *n.* [C, usu. sing.] the most exciting or important part of a story, event, or situation, usu. near the end（故事、事件或形势的）高潮，顶点

unification /ˌjuːnɪfɪˈkeɪʃən/ *n.* [U] the process of uniting groups or countries, or the fact that they have been united 统一；联合

solidarity /ˌsɒlɪˈdærəti/ *n.* [U] the support that people in a group give each other because they have the same opinions or aims 团结；一致

convene /kənˈviːn/ *v.* arrange a formal meeting, or gather for a meeting 召集（会议）；集合开会

extract /ɪkˈstrækt/ *vt.*

1 make sb. give you information, money, etc.

that they do not want to give 套出（信息）；索得（钱财）

2 (*fml.*) remove sth. from a particular space, esp. with difficulty （尤指费劲地）取出，拔出

groove /gruːv/ *n.* [C]

1 a fixed routine 常规；老套；规定的做法

2 a thin line cut into a hard surface 沟；凹槽

mute /mjuːt/ *a.*

1 not speaking, or not willing to speak 缄默的；无声的；不愿说话的

2 not able to speak 不会说话的；哑的

tactful /ˈtæktfəl/ *a.* careful in speaking or behaving so as not to upset other people （说话或行为）圆滑的，老练的，乖巧的

▲ **straightforward** /ˌstreɪtˈfɔːwəd/ *a.*

1 honest about your feelings or opinions and not hiding anything 诚实的；坦率的；老实的

2 simple and easy to understand 简单的；易懂的

courteous /ˈkɜːtiəs/ *a.* polite and showing respect for other people, esp. in a formal way 谦逊的；有礼貌的

glossary /ˈglɒsəri/ *n.* [U] a list of special words and explanations of their meanings, often at the end of a book （书末的）词汇表

mediate /ˈmiːdieɪt/

v. try to end a disagreement between two people or groups 调停；调解；斡旋

vt. (*fml.*) change the influence or the effect of sth., esp. to make the effect less bad 影响…的发生；减轻…的影响

incorporate /ɪnˈkɔːpəreɪt/ *vt.* add or include sth. as a part of sth. else 纳入；并入；包含

Phrases and expressions

specialize in focus all or most of your study, business, etc. on a particular subject or activity 专门研究；专攻；专门从事

close a deal successfully agree to a business deal 做成生意

seal a deal make an agreement more formal or definite 达成协议

divert ... to sth.

1 make sth. move or travel in a different direction 使…转向…

2 cause sth. to be used for a different purpose 将…的用途改变为…

charge into / around / down, etc.
rush somewhere quickly and carelessly 冲进；猛冲；冲向

take a(n) ... approach to sth. / doing sth.
take a particular way of thinking about or dealing with sth. 对…采用…的方式或态度

single sb. / sth. out choose one person or thing from a group for special attention 挑出，选出（一人或一物）

incorporate sth. into / in sth. add or include sth. as a part of sth. else, e.g. as a part of an arrangement or a document 将…纳入…；将…并入…

Proper names

Edward Hall 爱德华·霍尔（1914—2009，美国学者、著名人类学家和跨文化研究专家）

Kevin Johnston 凯文·约翰斯顿（人名）

the United Arab Emirates (UAE) 阿拉伯联合酋长国（亚洲国家，简称“阿联酋”）

Singapore 新加坡（东南亚国家）

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

2 Choose the best answer to each of the following questions.

1 According to the text, where is relationship building important for business success?
- A In European countries.
- B In the United States.
- C In South America.
- D In Asian countries.

2 How did Kevin feel before he left for the United Arab Emirates?
- A Confident.
- B Contented.
- C Uneasy.
- D Unsure.

3 What was the result of Kevin's trip to the UAE?
- A It was a success because he was warmly welcomed.
- B It was a disaster because his documents were incomplete.
- C It was a failure because he didn't close the deal.
- D It was a miracle because he solved some important issues.

4 What accounted for the result of Kevin's trip?
- A His UAE partners did not agree with his opinions on education.
- B His UAE partners were not satisfied with his financial report.
- C He refused to accept any gift and never tried to talk about real business.
- D He knew little about the importance of relationship building in the UAE.

5 How did Ann handle cultural differences when she led the sales team in Singapore?
- A With little consideration of the importance of saving face in Asia.
- B With great passion for promoting Asian cultural values in the team.
- C By meeting the team members regularly to learn about Asian culture.
- D By giving the team members freedom to do things in their own way.

6 What can be inferred from the example of Ann?
- A Ann was keen to learn about Asian culture.
- B Ann did not set up clear goals for her team.
- C Asian managers generally avoid criticizing a person in public.
- D American managers mostly like to give negative feedback in private conversations.

7 Which of the following is not given as a suggestion for Ann to lead her Asian team better?
- A Criticize her team members in a more private setting.
- B Motivate her team members in culturally appropriate ways.
- C Respect the concept of saving face in the team members' culture.
- D Discuss her team members' failures honestly in a public setting.

8 Which of the following best describes the organization of the text?
- A Stating a problem and comparing several solutions.
- B Stating an opinion and supporting it with examples.
- C Quoting a famous scholar and arguing against his view.
- D Discussing a social phenomenon and exploring its reasons.

Critical thinking

3 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 If you were Kevin Johnston, what would you do to make your trip to the UAE a success?

2 Apart from what has been discussed in the text, what other cultural factors can affect the success of international business dealings?

3 From a cross-cultural perspective, what is essential for a foreign business to succeed in China?

4 If you work in an international company, what will you do to ensure effective communication?

5 If you set up a business in a foreign country, how would you make yourself competent at conducting business in that culture?

Collocation

More language exercises

While different types of businesses might have their ways of achieving success, there are some qualities that today's thriving businesses have in common. First and foremost, successful companies encourage their employees to innovate, to think outside the box, or to take an ***ingenious approach*** (B4U3A) to solving problems. They foster a healthy environment that ***sparks creativity*** (B4U3A) and creates opportunities for collaboration. They support and inspire different ideas, making their teams ***hives of innovation*** (B4U3A). They have a transparent process for good ideas to move forward, with executive leaders being willing to ***take risks*** (B4U3A) despite such challenges as ***limited budgets*** (B4U3A) and time constraints.

Second, successful modern businesses know how to manage ***cross-cultural differences*** (B4U3B) and cater for a diverse customer base. To keep pace with the trend of globalization, many companies expand to overseas markets or set up branches in foreign countries. Whether they will prosper in this effort depends on whether they can overcome various cultural challenges, for example, how to build a ***trusting relationship*** (B4U3B) with local partners, how to ensure customers' habits and needs are ***highly valued*** (B4U3B), how to strike a balance between using ***straightforward language*** (B4U3B) to get the message through and taking an indirect route to be polite, and how to behave appropriately when you are received with ***extraordinary hospitality*** (B4U5B) that you are not used to. In other words, to be successful in a foreign market, a company needs to understand the ***cultural expectations*** (B4U3B) of its partners, employees, and customers in that particular foreign culture. It also needs to be competent in communicating with people and organizations in ***culturally appropriate*** (B4U3B) ways. If one day you set up a business, are you prepared to create a supportive environment for innovation and serve culturally diverse customers? What can you do to promote creativity and embrace a global market?

4 The marketing director of a successful multinational company was interviewed by a magazine journalist about cultural differences in the business setting. Choose appropriate words to complete the collocations from the texts. Change the form where necessary.

approach cross-cultural culturally expectation extraordinary highly
hive limited relationship spark straightforward take

Q: What is your general strategy for business success in an international market?

A: My general strategy is preparation. Many people say that an important factor for business success is the courage to 1) _____ *risks*. For instance, you should be determined to work toward your goal even if you have a(n) 2) _____ *budget* or face tough competition. However, this is not the case if you want to succeed in a foreign market. Instead, you need to be fully prepared so as to be competent in handling the 3) _____ *differences* you may encounter. To do this, you must be willing to learn and develop a good understanding of the 4) *cultural* _____ you are supposed to meet.

Q: Do you remember the first time you worked in a foreign country?

A: Yes, absolutely. My first job overseas was working as a marketing manager in Tokyo. I did some research about Japanese culture and took some classes to study the Japanese language and customs before I went there. Despite this, it took me a long time to learn how to work with my Japanese colleagues and business partners in 5) _____ *appropriate* ways to build cohesion and 6) _____ *creativity* in my team as well as establish productive relationships.

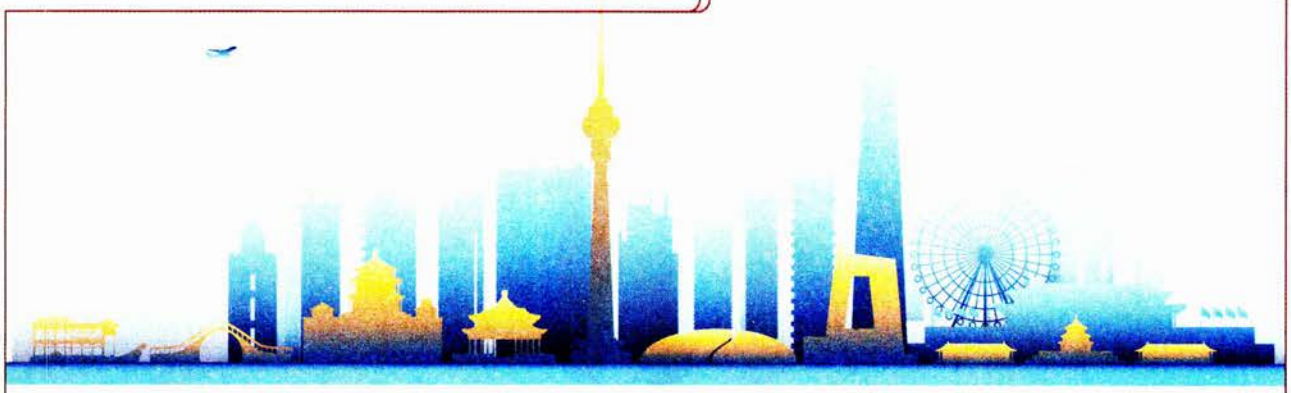
Q: Can you give some specific examples of the challenges you had when working there?

A: Sure. One of the challenges I had was getting accustomed to the Japanese communication style. At the first few team meetings, I mentioned the names of some staff members who hadn't accomplished the set goals and criticized them directly. When I did this, the room became dead silent. Later on I learned from a culture expert that using 7) _____ *language* to publicly call out a team member's mistakes is not a proper approach in Japan, because the social norm of face saving, i.e. to avoid damaging one's reputation or causing embarrassment, is 8) _____ *valued* in Japanese culture. Another challenge for me lay in how to establish personal connections and build *trusting* 9) _____ in the Japanese way. You also have to be skilled at picking up clues from subtle facial expressions and tones of voice to know what others are thinking.

Q: You also worked in China for many years. What was your experience there like?

A: What impressed me most in China was the 10) _____ *hospitality* I received no matter which city I went to. At the dinner table, my Chinese friends and colleagues always offered me a lot of food. Chinese people are also very modest. Several Chinese companies that I collaborated with had excellent technologies. With smart and creative employees, they were true 11) _____ *of innovation*. They embraced challenges and came up with *ingenious* 12) _____ to solving problems. But my Chinese colleagues always said they needed to work harder. I learned many things from my stay in China, and to be modest was one of them.

Stories of China



THE RISE OF MODERN ENTREPRENEURSHIP IN CHINA

Over the past few decades, entrepreneurship in China has grown at an extraordinary rate. It is bringing forth significant changes not only to China but also to the world.

The first wave of reform and opening up spurred the earliest generation of modern entrepreneurs in the 1980s. Most of these entrepreneurs had little or no access to knowledge of modern business management. They were pioneers who were remarkably bold to start their own businesses. Then, in the early 1990s, a number of government officials, inspired by the policies at that time, left their government roles and ventured into business. Many of them were quite successful in their entrepreneurial pursuits and some eventually became industry leaders.

Internet entrepreneurs started to emerge in the mid-to-late 1990s. Contemporary giants like Tencent were formed during those years or shortly thereafter. The bursting of the first Internet bubble at the turn of the century took out a fair number of Chinese Internet companies, but soon, the growth of the Internet industry resumed and gained momentum. The number of entrepreneurs grew again in China throughout the 2000s. Apart from those in the Internet and mobile technology sectors, many entrepreneurs also started appearing in other industries: energy, healthcare, financial services, consumer and

retail, among others, where businesses were increasingly integrated into the rapid growth of science and technology.

Today in China, we see numerous young people who were born in the 1990s and 2000s with entrepreneurial aspirations. They come not only from metropolises (大都市) like Beijing, Shanghai, and Guangzhou, but also from second-tier or even smaller cities. Though a fair number of them may not succeed, or at least not on their first attempt, these young people are not afraid of failure. For them, "trial and error" is an inevitable part of the entrepreneurial process. The outcome, whether positive or not, adds to their experience and helps open up more opportunities for them in the future.

We are living in an era where entrepreneurs are getting younger, and business development is becoming faster. This new generation of China's entrepreneurs illustrates vitality, creativity, and increased productivity that are the core driving forces fueling China's next stage of development.

Exercises

Translation

Translate the following paragraph into English.

随着社会和经济的飞速发展，中国在国际舞台上发挥着越来越大的作用。在此背景下，我们必须坚守中华文化立场，加快构建中国话语和中国叙事体系（China's discourse and narrative systems），讲好中国故事、传播好中国声音，展现可信、可爱、可敬的中国形象。加强国际传播能力建设，全面提升国际传播效能，形成同我国综合国力和国际地位相匹配（be commensurate with）的国际话语权。深化文明交流互鉴，推动中华文化更好走向世界。

Unit project

Sharing an innovative product idea

Innovation as a key factor for business success underlies the discovery of solutions to problems in our everyday life. Our life today is more convenient than ever thanks to modern technology, but we still feel that certain new products or services are needed and that some existing ones can be improved. What are some of the situations in daily life where you think things are not convenient or good enough? What ideas have been put forward to solve these problems? In this unit project, you will work in small groups to search for an innovative solution to a practical problem in daily life.

Step 1 **Form small groups of four or five. Brainstorm some problems that people have in their daily life. Choose one you want to focus on to talk about as a group.**

Step 2 **Browse the Internet about the problem you have chosen and collect information such as details of the problem and ideas of how to solve it. You should also think about the pros and cons of each idea and develop one idea of your own.**

Step 3 **Work as a group and share the information you have gathered. Discuss and formulate one innovative idea of your group and design a product / service / business, etc. based on the idea.**

Step 4 **Work together to write an outline for your group presentation. You may include the questions below:**

- What problem in people's daily life will you talk about?
- What ideas have been put forward to solve it, and what are the pros and cons of each idea?
- What innovative idea has your group come up with? How will it solve the problem?
- What product / service / business, etc. has your group designed based on the idea?

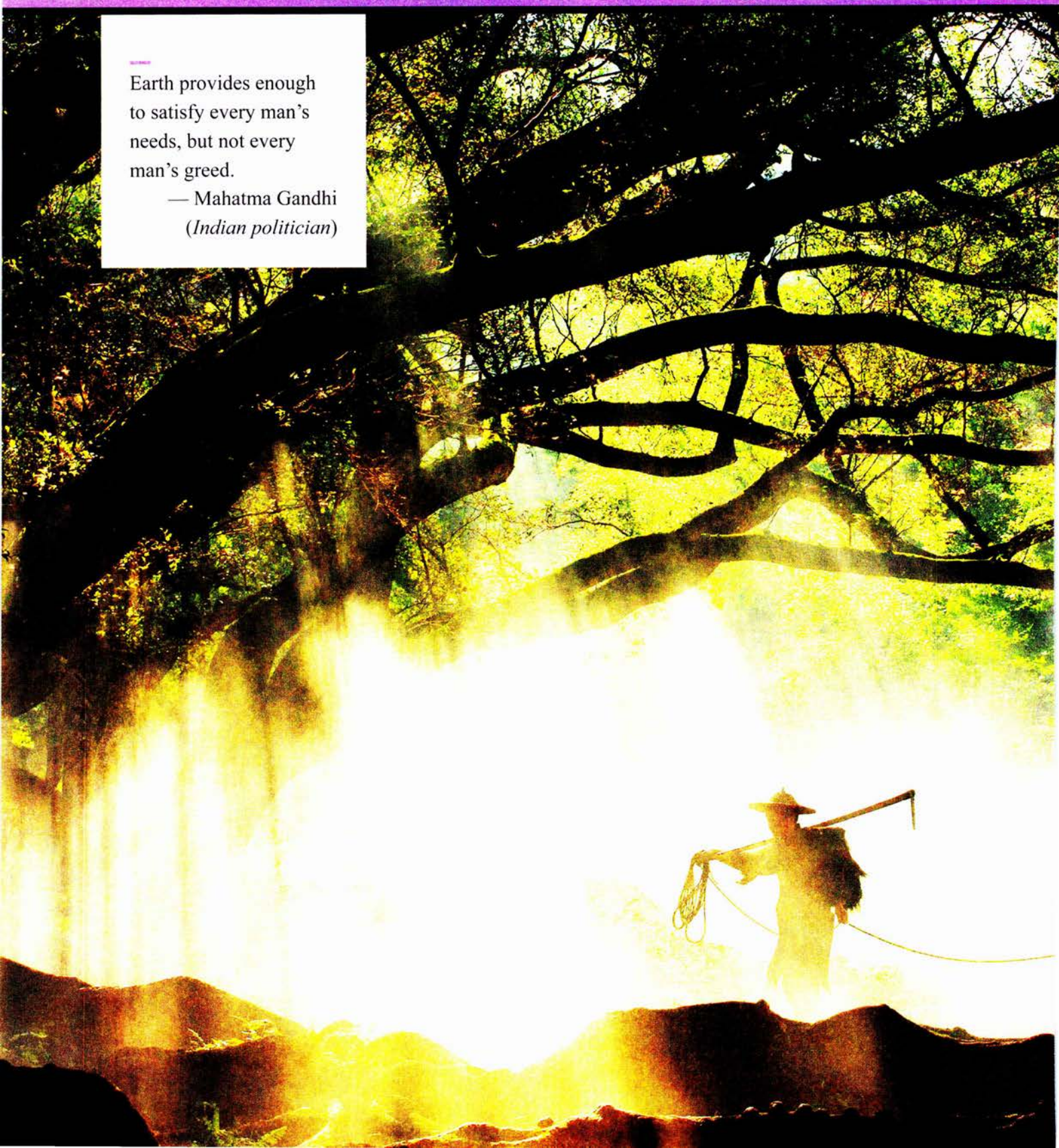
Step 5 **Present your idea in class, and vote for the most innovative one.**

Unit

4 Man and nature

Earth provides enough to satisfy every man's needs, but not every man's greed.

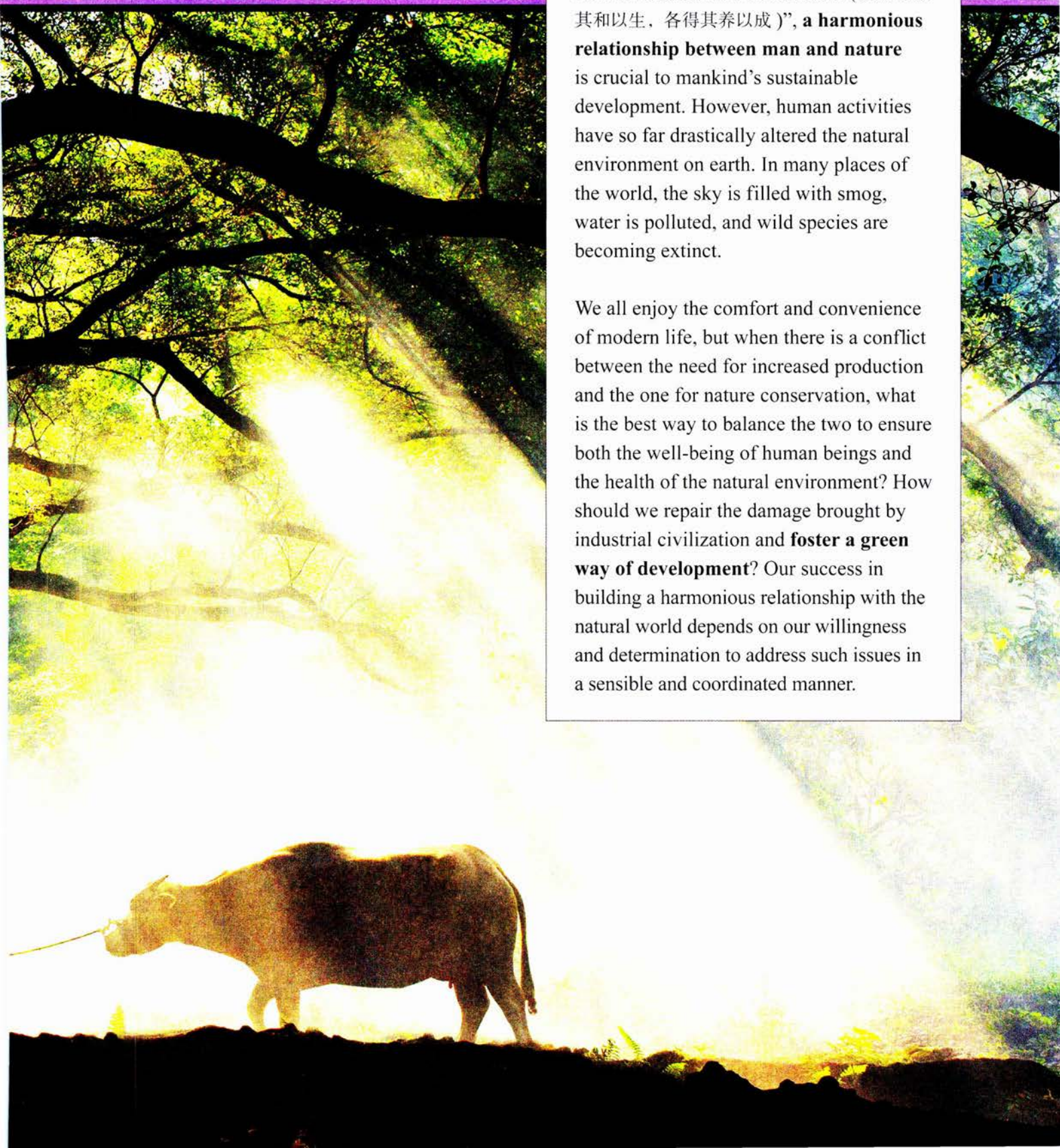
— Mahatma Gandhi
(*Indian politician*)



Preview

As the Chinese saying goes, "All beings flourish when they live in harmony and receive nourishment from nature (万物各得其和以生，各得其养以成)", **a harmonious relationship between man and nature** is crucial to mankind's sustainable development. However, human activities have so far drastically altered the natural environment on earth. In many places of the world, the sky is filled with smog, water is polluted, and wild species are becoming extinct.

We all enjoy the comfort and convenience of modern life, but when there is a conflict between the need for increased production and the one for nature conservation, what is the best way to balance the two to ensure both the well-being of human beings and the health of the natural environment? How should we repair the damage brought by industrial civilization and **foster a green way of development**? Our success in building a harmonious relationship with the natural world depends on our willingness and determination to address such issues in a sensible and coordinated manner.



Section A

Pre-reading activities

1 Look at the pictures and answer the following questions.

A

B

C

D

E

F

1 What environmental problem does each of the pictures intend to show? Match the problems with the pictures.

_____ (1) Species extinction
_____ (2) Garbage pollution
_____ (3) Deforestation
_____ (4) Water pollution
_____ (5) Air pollution
_____ (6) Global warming

2 What other environmental problems can you think of in addition to the ones shown in the pictures?

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 What can be the causes of each of the environmental problems listed above?
2 To solve environmental problems, what can governments and individuals do respectively?

Text A

1 Each year the 5th of June is celebrated as World Environment Day to promote environmental awareness and encourage nature conservation. Established following the UN Conference on the Human Environment in Stockholm in 1972 and led by the UN Environment Programme (UNEP), World Environment Day has now become the largest global platform for environmental outreach. Millions of people worldwide participate in the Day through conferences, campaigns, and various other activities every year, resolving to reduce pollution, improve **biodiversity**, tackle climate change, and restore the planet earth.

2 The earth is a unique **oasis** of life. It is home to the human race and an uncountable number of other life forms, including plants, animals, and **microorganisms**. Such biodiversity is more than beauty and wonder. It also **underpins** the **ecological** system that humanity is dependent upon.

3 However, the future of life on our planet – and thus our own – is in **jeopardy** due to human-driven ecological change. Humanity has **overreached** in its pursuit of **affluence** and used the earth's resources **ruthlessly**. Research shows that we have altered more than 75 percent of the world's ice-free land. Over half of the planet's **habitable** surface is now used to produce food. The ocean has fared no better, with a huge number of the world's fish stocks having been overfished.

4 Making matters worse, fossil fuel carbon **emissions** from industry and agriculture have increased significantly since the 1970s. These emissions cause not only air pollution and **ozone depletion** but also the greenhouse effect and global warming. With the global temperature rising, we can no longer ignore the **threat** of climate change. If greenhouse gas emissions are not reduced as early as possible, it will be impossible to limit global warming to 2°C above pre-industrial levels, as foreseen in the 2015 Paris climate agreement.

5 Excessive exploitation of natural resources and greenhouse gas emissions pose a grave threat to the earth's essential **ecology**. With the **degradation** of ecosystems, the quality of life for humans will decline. The natural assets they provide – clean air, clear water, and **fertile** land – will inevitably diminish. Humans will not be the only species to suffer. As ecosystems **falter**, other species large and small will come increasingly under strain, and will need to adapt or **perish**. It will take millions of years for the earth to recover its **breadth** and depth of biodiversity.

6 Whatever the consequences, it has to be recognized that if we humans continue to produce, **consume**, and power our lives the way we do now, land, oceans, and the atmosphere, which are all our environmental necessities, will **collapse**. For the sake of the survival and health of all species on earth, including our human race, we need to act with no delay. Protecting the environment is not a luxury but fundamental to us all. The task is **monumental** and everyone has to play a part.

7 People have started to protect the environment in small steps, but there is a **dire** need to take giant leaps. Every nation in the world needs to **economize** on energy and cut down on carbon emissions. Investment in new technologies and green innovation must be expanded. More **stringent** laws and rules must be **formulated** to **deter** actions that are harmful to the environment, and to ensure businesses and individuals comply with required standards.

8 Meanwhile, the measures we have long taken should be strengthened. We should establish more parks and nature reserves to protect wildlife and their **habitats**, and limit hunting and fishing to prevent the **extinction** of more species. This is both for protecting the **integrity** of the earth's biological system and for ensuring that all creatures on earth have plentiful and **varied** resources. Take humanity, for example. Evidence has revealed that even if the extinction of one species bears no direct links to the welfare of humanity, it can impact the survival of some other species that we depend on.

9 We should also encourage more recycling, which is crucial for human society to achieve sustainability. Recycling is one of the three Rs (reduce, reuse, and recycle), which seeks to minimize waste **disposal** costs, reduce environmental and climate impacts, and realize zero waste. As the urgency to **conserve** our natural resources, save **landfill** space, and reduce harmful pollution increases, it is imperative to recycle to meet this need.

10 There is no denying that the need to preserve nature often conflicts with other needs. For some people, a wooded area may be a good place to put a farm. A **timber** company

may want to harvest the area's trees for construction materials. A business may want to build a factory or shopping mall on the land. All these needs are valid, but the benefits of development should be weighed against the harm to wild animals that may be forced to find new habitats, and against the depletion of natural resources that we human beings and all other life forms need to survive.

11 There are also people who argue that protecting the earth as planned by the current international agreements is too expensive or challenging. After all, we need to use the land and oceans to feed the ever-growing human population. But research already shows that the goals are attainable using existing technologies and with **timely** shifts in government policies, business practices, and individual behavior.

12 We have only one chance to get this right. Restoring the environment of the earth is an ambitious goal. But it is one that will secure a vibrant future for humanity and all other species on this planet. World Environment Day gives every person across the globe an opportunity to be **empowered** with environmental knowledge to energize protection actions. On this particular day, let us, as individuals or organizations, pledge to do whatever little we can to return ecological balance to the earth, so that every species on it can thrive and prosper.

(971 words)

Culture notes

World Environment Day: an international day established by the United Nations to raise awareness of and encourage action on pressing environmental issues. It has been celebrated annually on June 5 since 1973.

UN Conference on the Human Environment: also known as the Stockholm Conference. It was the UN's first major conference on international environmental issues. Held in Stockholm, Sweden, in June 1972, the conference marked a turning point in the development of international environmental politics.

UN Environment Programme (UNEP): an international organization within the UN system. Since it was established in 1972, UNEP has become the leading global environmental authority. Its mission is to provide leadership, deliver science, and develop solutions on a wide range of environmental issues.

the 2015 Paris climate agreement: officially referred to as the Paris Agreement. It is an international treaty on climate change adopted by 196 parties at the UN Climate Conference in Paris in December 2015. The long-term temperature goal set by the agreement is to limit global warming to well below 2°C, preferably to 1.5°C, compared to pre-industrial levels.

New words

biodiversity /ˌbaɪəʊdaɪˈvɜːsəti/ *n.* [U] the variety of plants and animals in a particular place 生物多样性

oasis /əʊˈeɪsɪs/ *n.* (*pl.* **oases**) [C]
1 a place with water and trees in a desert （沙漠中的）绿洲
2 a peaceful or pleasant place that is very different from everything around it （不同于周围环境的）宁静怡人的地方

▲ *organism* /ˈɔːgənɪzəm/ *n.* [C]
1 an animal, plant, human, or any other living thing 生物；有机体
2 a system made up of parts that are dependent on each other 有机组织（体系）

microorganism /ˌmaɪkrəʊˈɔːgənɪzəm/ *n.* [C] a very small living thing that you can see only with a microscope 微生物

underpin /ˌʌndəˈpɪn/ *vt.*
1 give strength or support to sth. and help it succeed 巩固；支持
2 put a solid piece of metal under sth. such as a wall in order to make it stronger 加固（墙体等的）基础

▲ *ecological* /ˌiːkəˈlɒdʒɪkəl/ *a.* (*usu. before noun*) relating to the environment and the way plants, animals, and humans live together and affect each other 生态的

jeopardy /ˈdʒepədi/ *n.* (**in ~**) in danger of being lost or harmed 在危险中（指遭受损失或受到伤害）

overreach /ˌəʊvəˈriːtʃ/ *v.* try to do more than your ability, authority, or money will allow 试图超越（能力、权力或财力范围）

▲ *affluence* /ˈæfluəns/ *n.* [U] the state of having a lot of money or a high standard of living 富裕；富足

ruthless /ˈruːθləs/ *a.* not thinking or worrying about any pain caused to others; hard and cruel 无情的；冷酷的；残忍的

ruthlessly /ˈruːθləsli/ *ad.* 无情地；冷酷地；残忍地

habitable /ˈhæbətəbəl/ *a.* good enough for people to live in 适宜居住的

▲ *emission* /ɪˈmɪʃən/ *n.*
1 [C, usu. pl.] a gas or other substance that is sent into the air 排放物；散发物
2 [U] the act of sending out light, heat, gas, etc. （光、热、气等的）散发，排放

▲ *ozone* /ˈəʊzəʊn/ *n.* [U] a kind of oxygen that exists high in the earth's atmosphere 臭氧

depletion /dɪˈpliːʃən/ *n.* [U] the act of reducing the amount of sth. 减少；削减

▲ *threat* /θret/ *n.*
1 [C, usu. sing] the possibility that sth. very bad will happen 坏事发生的可能
2 [C, U] a statement in which you tell sb. that you will cause them harm or trouble if they do not do what you want 威胁；恐吓

▲ *ecology* /ɪˈkɒlədʒi/ *n.* [sing, U] the way in which plants, animals, and people are related to each other and to their environment, or the scientific study of this 生态；生态学

degradation /ˌdegrəˈdeɪʃən/ *n.*
1 [U] the process by which sth. changes to a worse condition 退化；恶化
2 [C, U] an experience or situation that makes you feel ashamed and angry 耻辱；落魄；潦倒

▲ *fertile* /ˈfɜːtaɪl/ *a.*
1 (of land or soil) able to produce good crops or plants 肥沃的；富饶的
2 (of people, animals, or plants) able to produce babies, young animals, or new plants 能生育的；可繁殖的；能结果的

falter /ˈfɔːltə/
vi. become weaker and unable to continue in an effective way 变弱；衰退
v. speak in a voice that sounds weak and uncertain, and keeps stopping 结巴地说；支支吾吾地说

perish /'perɪʃ/ *vi.*

1 (*fml.*) die, esp. in a terrible or sudden way 死亡（尤指惨死或猝死）

2 (of material such as rubber or leather) decay and start to break into pieces（橡胶、皮革等）脆裂，老化

▲ **breadth** /bredθ/ *n.*

1 [U] the quality of including a lot of different things or ideas 广泛性；广度

2 [C, U] the distance from one side of sth. to the other; width 宽度；阔度

▲ **consume** /kən'sju:m/ *vt.*

1 use fuel, energy, or time 消耗；消费；花费

2 (*fml.*) eat or drink sth. 吃；喝

▲ **collapse** /kə'læps/ *vi.*

1 (of systems, ideas, or organizations) suddenly fail or become too weak to continue（系统、观念、组织）突然失败，垮掉，崩溃

2 (of buildings, walls, etc.) fall down suddenly, usu. because it is weak or damaged（建筑、围墙等）倒塌，坍塌

▲ **monumental** /ˌmɒnjə'mentl/ *a.*

1 (*only before noun*) extremely large, good, bad, impressive, etc. 极大（坏、好等）的

2 (*usu. before noun*) (of achievements, pieces of work, etc.) very important and usu. based on many years of work 丰碑式的；伟大且不朽的

dire /'daɪə/ *a.* extremely serious or terrible 极其严重的；极可怕的

economize /ɪ'kɒnəmaɪz/ *vi.* (~ **on**) use sth. such as money or fuel very carefully, so that you waste as little as possible 节约；节省；有效利用

stringent /'strɪndʒənt/ *a.* (of laws, rules, standards, etc.) very strict and must be obeyed（法律、规章、标准等）严格的，严厉的

▲ **formulate** /'fɔ:mjəleɪt/ *vt.*

1 develop sth. such as a plan or a set of rules, and decide all the details of how it will be done 规划；制定；准备

2 think carefully about what to say, and say it clearly 仔细思考并明确表达

deter /dɪ'tɜ:/ *vt.* stop sb. from doing sth. by making them realize it will be difficult or have bad results 威慑住；吓住；使却步

▲ **habitat** /'hæbətæt/ *n.* [C] the type of place that an animal normally lives in or a plant normally grows in（动物的）栖息地；（植物的）生长地

extinction /ɪk'stɪŋkʃən/ *n.* [U]

1 a situation in which a particular type of animal or plant stops existing 灭绝；绝种

2 a situation in which a type of person, custom, skill, etc. stops existing（某种类型的人、习俗、技能等的）绝迹，消亡

▲ **integrity** /ɪn'tegrəti/ *n.* [U]

1 (*fml.*) the state of being united as one complete thing 完整；完全

2 the quality of being honest and strong about what you believe to be right 耿直；正直诚实

varied /'veərid/ *a.* consisting of or including many different kinds of things or people, esp. in a way that seems interesting 各种各样的；形形色色的

▲ **disposal** /dɪ'spəʊzəl/ *n.* [U] the act of getting rid of sth., esp. by throwing it away 清除；处理；丢弃

conserve /kən'sɜ:v/ *vt.*

1 protect sth. and prevent it from changing or being damaged 保护；保存

2 use as little water, energy, etc. as possible so that it is not wasted 节约（水、能源等）

landfill /'lændfɪl/ *n.*

1 [C] a place where rubbish is buried 垃圾填埋场

2 [U] the process of getting rid of large amounts of rubbish by burying it 垃圾填埋

▲ **timber** /'tɪmbə/ *n.* [U] wood used for building houses or making furniture 木材；木料

▲ **timely** /'taɪmli/ *a.* done or happening at exactly the right time 及时的；适时的

empower /ɪmˈpaʊə/ *vt.*

1 give sb. more control over their own life or situation 使自主；使控制局面

2 (*fml.*) give a person or organization the legal authority to do sth. 授权（某人或某组织做某事）

Phrases and expressions

fare better / no better be successful / unsuccessful in a particular situation 更成功 / 同样不成功

pose a threat / danger / risk to ... create a difficult or dangerous situation for sth. / sb. 对…造成威胁 / 危险

under (a) strain under pressure 处在压力之下；有压力

with no delay / without delay without waiting any longer 毫不迟疑地；迅速地

play a part (in sth.) have an effect or influence on sth. （在…中）起作用，有影响

cut down on sth. reduce an amount of sth. 减少；降低

comply with obey a rule or law, or do what sb. asks you to do 遵守；服从

bear (no) links to / with sth. have (no) connection with sth. 与…有关联 / 没有关联

weigh sth. against sth. consider sth. carefully so that you can make a decision about it 把…与…进行权衡

Proper names

World Environment Day 世界环境日

UN Conference on the Human Environment 联合国人类环境会议（又称斯德哥尔摩人类环境会议）

Stockholm /ˈstɒkhəʊm/ 斯德哥尔摩（瑞典首都）

UN Environment Programme (UNEP) 联合国环境规划署（简称 UNEP）

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

1 Answer the following questions.

1 How do people usually celebrate World Environment Day every year?
2 What is the significance of biodiversity according to Para. 2?
3 What factors are posing a great threat to the earth's essential ecology? What does the threat specifically include?
4 What giant steps must be taken to protect the environment?
5 Why is the extinction of any single species on earth potentially dangerous to human beings?
6 Why is recycling crucial for human society to achieve sustainability?
7 What should we consider while satisfying our development needs?
8 According to the author, what makes it possible to achieve the goals of protecting the earth set by the current international agreements?

Critical thinking

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 What lessons do you think we should learn from the past when it comes to using natural resources on earth?
2 How do you understand the importance of protecting biodiversity on earth?
3 How should we balance the conflicts between economic development and environmental protection to ensure sustainable development?
4 What environmental issues do you care the most about, and why?
5 What activities have you ever participated in to help improve the environment? Share one or two of them.

Language focus

Words in use

3 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

affluence collapse consume
depletion disposal habitat integrity
monumental perish timely

1 During the restoration, there were many strict conservation guidelines to which we had to adhere in order to maintain the _____ of the building.
2 Research indicates that a nurse's _____ response to a call bell communicates respect and caring and hence contributes to patient satisfaction.
3 The air and rivers in this area are getting cleaner, and attempts to preserve animal species and their _____ have been mostly successful.
4 This project has _____ so much of her time and energy that she needs a rest after finishing it.
5 Due to rising _____ and the availability of a wider range of choices, consumption is now based more on what one wants, rather than what one needs.
6 Improper _____ of plastics into the oceans endangers the marine species and subsequently human lives.
7 The movement of trains along the line was badly affected after the signaling system _____ following a heavy rainstorm.
8 The _____ of natural resources is a global environmental issue that jeopardizes the livelihoods of billions of people on our planet.
9 Insects are important sources of food for other animals. Hundreds of species of birds would _____ if there were no insects to feed on.
10 Scientists in China have carried out advanced research on hydrology (水文学) and water resources of inland rivers, and have made _____ achievements in recent years.

Word building

与某些名词结合构成形容词。具体说明请参阅 Unit 3 Word building 部分。

ambiguity		ambiguous
danger		dangerous
disaster		disastrous
vigor		vigorous
adventure	>	**adventurous**
desire		**desirous**
harmony		**harmonious**
space		**spacious**
victory		**victorious**
virtue		**virtuous**

与某些形容词结合构成副词，表示某事按照形容词所描述的方式完成。

ready		readily
recent		recently
urgent		urgently
virtual	>	virtually
even		**evenly**
respective		**respectively**
whole		**wholly**

4 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

adventurous desirous evenly
harmonious respectively spacious
victorious virtuous wholly

1 Hundreds of enthusiastic fans welcomed the _____ team at the airport, and 20,000 more crammed into the downtown square for a city-wide celebration.
2 Ever since he was young, he has been passionate about exploring new experiences and living an exciting and _____ life.
3 When you stand, you need to _____ distribute your body weight between your legs so that you can keep better balance.
4 This is a large and _____ modern hotel offering high standards of accommodation and other services.
5 Alice and David who work in the two nearest offices to mine have been working in our company for 15 and 25 years _____.
6 I strongly believe that reading classic literature can cultivate _____ qualities like kindness, integrity, and modesty in readers.
7 We are _____ convinced that building a diverse and inclusive workforce will give a company access to a broader talent pool.
8 We all want a(n) _____ family life, where members get along well, respect each other, and communicate with each other a lot.
9 The reason why I'm leaving the present employer is that I am _____ of getting broader experience in the field of artificial intelligence and software development.

Banked cloze

5 Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

A conserve	**F** jeopardy	**K** notional
B converted	**G** imperative	**L** proportion
C corresponding	**H** innovative	**M** reserve
D devastating	**I** integrity	**N** tackled
E elimination	**J** monumental	**O** utilized

Farming invariably interferes with the habitats of plants and animals. However, this does not necessarily mean that agriculture will put biodiversity in 1) _____ and that the two can never come together. In fact, quite the opposite is true. Sustainable cultivation of agricultural land for food and animal feed enables us to 2) _____ biodiversity.

Compared with the massive population growth in the last few decades, the expansion of arable (可耕的) land over the same period has been small. And there are limits to further expansion. A large 3) _____ of the earth's surface like deserts is not suitable for crop cultivation, and other areas are 4) _____ by humans for roads and buildings. Some land that is rich in biodiversity needs to be protected and thus should not be 5) _____ into arable land. The tropical rain forests, for example, have the highest species diversity in the world, and changing this land for crop cultivation would be 6) _____ to the habitats and, indeed, the existence of the species in these places.

By 2050, global demand for food will have increased substantially. This is one of the 7) _____ challenges facing agriculture today: How do we balance the rising demand for food and the need to maintain biological 8) _____ and diversity, now and in the future?

Efficient and effective use of land will be 9) _____ to the increase of food production and preservation of natural animal and plant habitats. Achieving this will depend, to a large extent, on the use of modern and 10) _____ agricultural methods. If these methods are successfully developed, agriculture and biodiversity will be able to coexist in greater harmony.

Expressions in use

6 Fill in the blanks with the expressions given below. Change the form where necessary. Each expression can be used only once.

be in jeopardy bear no links to comply with
cut down on economize on fare no better
pose a threat to weigh ... against

1 If the goods do not _____ the contract specifications, the buyer can request several different kinds of compensation.
2 The company tried to release an improved milk chocolate bar using condensed milk rather than powdered milk, but it _____ than the previous products.
3 For the sake of health, we should _____ the intake of high-calorie and high-fat foods with poor nutritional value.
4 Wastewater and the increasing atmospheric CO_2 levels are two great environmental challenges that _____ human life.
5 The recent oil price rise was found to _____ the changes in supply and demand, but came as a result of uncertainty about the market.
6 Most experts agreed that the cost of conducting the experiment must _____ the potential benefit to society the research might provide.
7 In order to _____ natural resources and minimize waste disposal, it is necessary for everyone to get into the habit of recycling.
8 Many phishing emails (钓鱼电子邮件) try to deceive you with the threat that your account will _____ if it is not updated right away.

Structure analysis and writing

Structure analysis

Rebutting counter-arguments in argumentative essay writing

As you have learned in B3U1, an argumentative essay is one that gives examples or factual evidence to support a point of view. Its purpose is to persuade the reader to agree with the argument that is being made.

While justifying your opinion in an argumentative essay, in addition to using direct evidence, you may also need to consider some counter-arguments and effectively refute them. A counter-argument is referred to as "the other side's argument". It is an argument that goes against yours. Typically, counter-arguments need to be considered and rejected in an attempt to strengthen your own arguments.

When you try to think of a counter-argument, you can imagine a reader who doesn't share your opinion and who might resist your arguments by pointing out:

- a problem with your arguments, whereby a different conclusion could be drawn from the same facts;
- one or more disadvantages or drawbacks to what you propose;
- an alternative argument that seems to make more sense than yours.

When you rebut a counter-argument, you must do it in a reasonable and logical manner, so that your rebuttal can prove that the counter-argument is not well-grounded. For example, you may:

- show why the counter-argument is not true;
- partly acknowledge the validity of the counter-argument, but explain why it doesn't weigh as much as what you propose.

Rebutting counter-arguments in your essay makes the reader see that you have anticipated doubts they might have toward your opinion. It presents you as a writer who weighs alternatives before taking a stand, who considers other points of view instead of ignoring them, and who is more interested in discovering the truth than only scratching the surface of the issue.

Take Text A of this unit, for example. It is an argumentative essay in which the author tries to convince the reader of the vital necessity to protect the environment and restore the health of the earth. The central message the author wants to convey is that a sustainable and healthy earth will secure a vibrant future for humanity and all other

species on it. To argue for this point, the author explains the necessity and urgency to protect the environment in Paras. 2-9, including the importance of a biodiverse earth, problems the earth is facing, and measures to solve the problems. Following this, the author rebuts two counter-arguments in Paras. 10-11. Through rebutting the counter-arguments, the author aims to remove doubts about his own arguments.

Look at the graph below to better understand the structure of Text A.

Introduction
(Para. 1)

Necessity and urgency to protect the environment (Paras. 2-9)

The importance of a biodiverse earth (Para. 2)	Problems the earth is now faced with and their potential dangers (Paras. 3-5)	Measures that should be adopted to solve the problems (Paras. 6-9)

Rebuttal to two counter-arguments (Paras. 10-11)

Rebuttal to counter-argument 1: It is usually wrong to believe that preserving nature conflicts with the need for development. (Para. 10)	**Rebuttal to counter-argument 2:** It is wrong to believe that protecting the earth as planned by the current international agreements is almost impossible. (Para.11)

Conclusion
(Para. 12)

Structured writing

Read the sample essay and see how to write an argumentative essay that features the rebuttal of counter-arguments.

Topic
Are boarding schools really a good choice?

Introduction
Boarding schools are actually not as appealing as some parents believe.

Body
1 **Counter-argument 1:** Children can develop better habits if they are under teachers' supervision all the time in boarding schools.
Rebuttal 1: Children receive limited individual attention in boarding schools.
2 **Counter-argument 2:** Children can have more time to study in boarding schools.
Rebuttal 2: Children may just idle away their time.

Conclusion
It doesn't sound like a good choice to send children to boarding schools.

Parents have to face a common issue: choosing a school for their kids when they reach school age. While most parents would consider a day school, there are some who prefer to send their kids to a boarding school. They do so not because they have to, but because they strongly believe boarding schools are better. However, in my opinion, this may not be a good decision as boarding schools are not as appealing as these parents believe.

One reason why some parents consider boarding schools an ideal choice is that they think children can develop better living and study habits if they are supervised by teachers 24 hours a day during the weekdays. However, this may not be the case. Although teachers are usually well-trained and highly responsible, there are so many children in most boarding schools that the individual attention a child receives from teachers can be very limited.

Another reason why these parents prefer boarding schools is that they believe children will have more time and energy to spend on study and other activities. If children don't have to travel to school and then back home every day as those attending day schools do, it will save them a lot of time and energy. However, who can be sure that children will spend the time saved really on study or other meaningful things? They may just idle away their time.

All in all, in my opinion, boarding schools don't seem to be the best choice for parents. Children need their parents, especially in their early years at school, as parents play an important role in shaping their attitudes and interest in learning. I would very much hope that parents carefully consider all the options available and send their children to a boarding school only when they really have to.

7 Write an argumentative essay of no less than 150 words on one of the following topics. One topic has an outline that you can follow.

Topic

The value of national parks

Introduction

National parks are necessary because they can help protect the variety of species on earth and offer people a place where they can relax and explore nature.

Body

1 **Counter-argument 1:** Wild areas should be left entirely on their own, rather than being intervened by human action.
Rebuttal 1: The establishment of national parks aims to provide a safe home for native plants and animals.
2 **Counter-argument 2:** Human activities in national parks can be damaging to the natural environment.
Rebuttal 2: There are things we can do to mitigate the negative effects brought by human activities and to protect the natural environment of national parks.

Conclusion

We should establish national parks to protect native plants and animals, and provide people with spaces for exercise and for exploring nature.

More topics

- Should a high GPA (grade point average) be the most important goal that a college student pursues?
- Does competition bring out the best in people?

Section B

Reading skills: Reading between the lines

1 Read the following sentences from Text B and think about the meaning implied in them. Answer the questions that follow the sentences.

1 Some of you have impaired our ability to experience nature in the good way, as part of it. Even here we are conscious that somewhere beyond the marsh and its cranes, somewhere out in those hills there are radar towers and highway overpasses. You have not only contaminated the earth, the rocks, and the minerals, all of which you call "dead" but which are very much alive; you have even changed the animals, which are part of us, changed them into zoological mutations, so no one can recognize them. (Para. 3)

Question:

What can we learn about the author's attitude toward the changes human beings have made to nature?

2 There is power in an antelope, so you let it graze within your fences. But what power do you see in a goat or sheep, prey animals with no defenses? There was great power in a wolf, even in a fox. You have inverted nature and turned these animals into miniature lap dogs. (Para. 4)

Question:

What does the author intend to say by these sentences?

3 The feelings of rain and snow on your face, being numbed by an icy wind and warmed back up by a smoking fire, coming out of a hot sweat bath and plunging into a cold stream, these things are the spice of life, but you don't want them anymore. (Para. 10)

Question:

What advice does the author want to give in these sentences?

Text B

What nature is telling you

1 Let's sit down here, all of us, on the open **prairie**, where we can't see a highway or a fence, free from the **debris** of the city. Let's have no blankets to sit on, but let our bodies **converge** with the earth, the surrounding trees and **shrubs**. Let us have the vegetation for a mattress, experiencing its **texture**, its sharpness, and its softness. Let us become like stones, plants, and trees. Let us be animals, think and feel like animals.

2 This is my **plea**: Listen to the air. You can hear it, feel it, smell it, and taste it. We feel it between us, as a presence **presiding** over the day. It is a good way to start thinking about nature and talking about it. To go further, we must rather talk to it, talk to the rivers, to the lakes, and to the winds, as to our relatives.

3 Some of you have **impaired** our ability to experience nature in the good way, as part of it. Even here we are conscious that somewhere beyond the **marsh** and its **cranes**, somewhere out in those hills there are radar towers and highway overpasses. You have not only **contaminated** the earth, the rocks, and the minerals, all of which you call "dead" but which are very much alive; you have even changed the animals, which are part of us, changed them into zoological **mutations**, so no one can recognize them.

4 There is power in an **antelope**, so you let it **graze** within your fences. But what power do you see in a goat or sheep, **prey** animals with no defenses? There was great power in a wolf, even in a fox. You have **inverted** nature and turned these animals into **miniature** lap dogs.

5 You have also made some types of wild birds into chickens – **creatures** with wings so impaired that they cannot fly. There are farms where you breed chickens. These birds are kept in low cages, forced to be **hunched** over all the time. Having to spend all their lives stooped over makes unnatural birds.

6 That's where you've fooled yourselves. You have not only altered, **declawed**, and deformed your winged and four-legged cousins; you have done it **concurrently** to yourselves. You have plastic **surgery**, apply **synthetic** make-up, and take countless drugs. Your homes are filled with families disconnected from one another but tied to their own mobile devices and social groups.

7 "Watch the **crumbs**; don't eat crackers on the couch, you will **stain** the fabric. Watch the goldfish bowl. Don't **lean** your head against the wallpaper; your hair may be **greasy**. Don't spill **liquor** on that table, you'll **peel** off its delicate finish. You should have wiped your boots; the floor was just cleaned. Don't, don't, don't …" That is absurd! We weren't made to endure this type of "**repression**". You live in prisons which you have built for yourselves, calling them homes, offices, or factories.

8 Sometimes I think that even our pitiful small houses are better than your luxury **mansions**. **Strolling** a hundred feet to the outhouse on a clear wintry night, through mud or snow, that's one small link with nature. Or in the summer, in the back country, taking your time listening to the **humming** of the insects or the **flapping** of birds' wings, feeling the sun warming your bones through the nodding branches of trees. However, you don't even have that pleasure of coexistence with nature anymore.

9 You **subscribe** to the belief that everything must be **germ** free. No smells! Not even the good, natural man and woman **odors**. Eradicate the smell from under your armpits, or from your skin. **Rub** it out, and then spray some botanical odor on yourself, stuff you can spend a lot of money on, ten dollars an **ounce**, so you know this has to smell good. Why do you keep such a distance from your bodies' functions, **cavities** and smells that you've **alienated** yourselves from the natural world, of which you are an integral part?

10 I think you are so afraid and intolerant of the world around you. You **deplore** the natural world; you don't want to see, feel, smell, or hear it. You are **detached** from it. The feelings of rain and snow on your face, being **numbed** by an icy wind and warmed back up by a smoking fire, coming out of a hot sweat bath, and plunging into a cold stream, these things are the spice of life, but you don't want them anymore.

11 You're cage **dwellers**, residing in boxes which shut out the hot humidity of summer and the chill of winter, living inside a body that no longer has a **scent**. You're hearing the noise from the hi-fi instead of listening to the sounds of nature. You're watching actors on TV having a make-believe experience when you no longer experience anything for yourself. That's your way. It's no good.

(*818 words*)

New words

prairie /ˈpreəri/ *n.* [C] a large flat area in central North America covered with grass and farm land but without trees （北美中部的）大草原，大农场

debris /ˈdebriː/ *n.* [U]

1 rubbish or pieces of useless material that make a place untidy 垃圾；废物

2 the broken pieces that are left when sth. large has been destroyed, esp. by an explosion, fire, or accident （尤指爆炸、火灾或事故后留下的）废墟，瓦砾堆，残骸

converge /kənˈvɜːdʒ/ *vi.*

1 come from different directions to reach the same point 汇合；汇聚

2 (of ideas or aims) become the same or very similar （观点或目标）趋同

shrub /ʃrʌb/ *n.* [C] a low thick bush, esp. one that has been planted in a garden （尤指种在园子里的）灌木（丛）

texture /ˈtekstʃə/ *n.* [C, U] the way sth. feels when you touch it 手感；质感；质地

plea /pliː/ *n.* [C]

1 an urgent or emotional request for sth. 恳求；请求；央求

2 a statement that sb. makes in a court of law to say whether they are guilty or not （法庭上的）答辩，辩护，申诉

preside /prɪˈzaɪd/ *vi.* be in charge of an official meeting, ceremony, or other event 主持；主管；负责

impair /ɪmˈpeə/ *vt.* (*fml.*) make sth. less good or effective, esp. by causing damage that affects the way sth. works 削弱；损害

▲ *marsh* /mɑːʃ/ *n.* [C] an area of soft wet land 沼泽；湿地

▲ *crane* /kreɪn/ *n.* [C]

1 a large bird with long legs and a long neck that lives near water 鹳；鹤；鹭

2 a very tall machine used for lifting or moving heavy objects and building tall buildings 起重机；吊车

▲ *contaminate* /kənˈtæməneɪt/ *vt.*

1 make sth. dirty, polluted, or poisonous by adding chemicals or waste 污染；弄脏

2 affect sth. or sb. in a negative way 玷污；毒害

mutation /mjuːˈteɪʃən/ *n.* [C, U]

1 a change in the genetic structure of an animal or plant that makes it different from others of the same kind （动物或植物的）变异，突变

2 a change in a speech sound, esp. a vowel, because of the sound of the one next to it （尤指元音的）语音变化，音变

antelope /ˈæntələʊp/ *n.* [C] 羚羊

graze /greɪz/

vi. eat grass growing in a field 吃草

vt. put an animal in a place where it can eat grass 放牧；放…啃食牧草

prey /preɪ/ *n.* [U]

1 an animal that is hunted and eaten by another animal or by a person （被其他动物或人）捕食的动物；猎物

2 sb. that a criminal or dishonest person attacks, cheats, or harms （袭击、欺骗或伤害的）对象，受害者

invert /ɪnˈvɜːt/ *vt.* put sth. in the opposite position to the one it was in before, esp. by turning it upside down 使倒转；使反向；（尤指）使倒置

miniature /ˈmɪnətʃə/

a. (*only before noun*) much smaller than normal 很小的；微型的

n. 1 (**in ~**) exactly like sth. or sb. but much smaller 缩影的；微小模型的

2 [C] a very small painting, usu. of a person 微型画；微型肖像画

▲ *creature* /ˈkriːtʃə/ *n.* [C]

1 anything that is living, such as an animal, fish, or insect, but not a plant 非植物生物；动物

2 an imaginary animal or person, or one that is very strange and frightening 不可名状的动物；怪物

hunch /hʌntʃ/ *v.* sit or stand with your back and shoulders curved forwards（使）弓身坐着（或站着）

▲ **claw** /klɔ:/

n. [C] a sharp curved nail on an animal, bird, or some insects（动物、鸟或有些昆虫的）爪

v. tear or pull at sth., using claws or your fingers（用爪或手指）撕，抓

declaw /di:'klɔ:/ *v.* remove the claws from a cat or bird, etc. 剪去（猫、鸟等的）脚爪

concurrently /kən'kʌrəntli/ *ad.* (*fml.*) happening or done at the same time 同时发生（或完成）地

▲ **surgery** /'sɜ:dʒəri/ *n.* [C, U] medical treatment in which a surgeon cuts open your body to repair or remove sth. inside 外科手术

synthetic /sɪn'θetɪk/ *a.* produced by combining different artificial substances, rather than being naturally produced 合成的；人造的

crumb /krʌm/ *n.* [C] a very small piece of dry food, esp. bread or cake 食品屑（尤指面包屑或蛋糕屑）

▲ **stain** /steɪn/

v. accidentally make a mark on sth., esp. one that cannot be removed, or be marked in this way（意外地）（被）染污，（被）弄污

n [C] 1 a mark that is difficult to remove, esp. one made by a liquid such as blood, coffee, or ink（尤指液体形成的）污迹，污点

2 (**~ on sb.'s character / reputation, etc.**) sth. that damages the good opinion that people have about sb. 某人性格 / 名誉等方面的污点

▲ **lean** /li:n/

v. put sth. in a sloping position where it is supported, or be in that position（使）斜靠；斜靠在…

vi. move or bend your body in a particular direction 屈身；倾斜身体

greasy /'gri:si/ *a.*

1 producing a lot of natural oil 油性的

2 containing or cooked with too much oil or fat 多脂的；油腻的

▲ **liquor** /'lɪkə/ *n.* [U]

1 alcoholic drinks 酒精饮料

2 (*mainly AmE*) strong alcoholic drinks 烈性酒

peel /pi:l/

vt. 1 remove sth. from the surface of sth. else, esp. by taking one end or side and pulling it up 剥；撕；抽

2 remove the skin from a fruit or vegetable 削去或剥去（水果或蔬菜的）皮

vi. (of paper or paint) come off, usu. in small pieces（纸或油漆）脱落，剥落

repression /rɪ'preʃən/ *n.* [U] the use of force or violence to control people 镇压；压制

mansion /'mænʃən/ *n.* [C] a large house, esp. a beautiful one 大房子；大楼；（尤指）富丽堂皇的大厦

stroll /strəʊl/ *vi.* walk without hurrying, often for pleasure 散步；溜达；闲逛

hum /hʌm/

vi. make a low continuous sound 发出连续低沉的声音

v. make musical sounds with your lips closed 哼（曲子）

n. [sing.] a low continuous noise made by a machine or a lot of people talking 机器的嗡嗡声；（很多人）嗡嗡的说话声

flap /flæp/ *v.*

1 (of bird's wings) move quickly up and down（鸟翼）振动；（鸟）振（翅）

2 move noisily up and down or from side to side, esp. in the wind（尤指在风中）飘动，摆动

subscribe /səb'skraɪb/ *vi.* pay money, usu. once a year, to have copies of a newspaper or magazine sent to you, or to have some other service 订阅（报纸或杂志）；订购（服务）

▲ **germ** /dʒɜ:m/ *n.*

1 [C] a very small living thing that can make you ill 病菌；细菌

2 [sing.] the early stage of an idea, theory, feeling, etc. that may develop into sth. bigger and more important（观念、理论、感情等的）萌芽

▲ **odor** /ˈəʊdə/ *n.* [C] a smell, esp. one that is unpleasant 气味；（尤指）臭味

▲ **rub** /rʌb/

v. press and move your hands or an object over a surface（用手或物体）擦，摩擦

n. [C, usu. sing.] the action of rubbing part of the body 揉搓；按摩

▲ **ounce** /aʊns/ *n.* [C] a unit for measuring weight, equal to 1/16 of a pound or 28.35 grams 盎司，英两（重量单位，等于 1/16 磅，或 28.35 克）

cavity /ˈkævəti/ *n.* [C]

1 a space inside sb.'s body（身体的）腔

2 a hole in a tooth, caused by decay 龋齿的洞

alienate /ˈeɪliəneɪt/ *vt.*

1 make sb. feel that they do not belong to a place or group 使疏远；使不容于（某地或某群体）；使感到格格不入

2 make sb. dislike you, or not want to help or support you 使厌恶；使敌对

deplore /dɪˈplɔː/ *vt.* dislike sth. very much, often because you think it is immoral 谴责；强烈反对

detached /dɪˈtætʃt/ *a.*

1 not showing any emotional involvement or interest in a situation 认为与己无关的；毫不关心的；心不在焉的

2 (of a house or garage) not joined to another building（房子或车库）独立式的，分开的

numb /nʌm/

vt. make a part of your body lose its ability to feel 使麻木；使失去知觉

a. (of a part of your body) unable to feel anything 麻木的；失去知觉的

dweller /ˈdwelə/ *n.* [C] sb. who lives in a particular type of place 居住者；居民

▲ **scent** /sent/

n. [C] a particular smell, esp. a pleasant one 气味；（尤指）香味

vt. make sth. have a particular smell 使…充满某种气味

Phrases and expressions

converge with join together with 与…相融合

preside over sth. be in a position of power while important changes or events are happening 掌管；领导

disconnect sb. / sth. from make sb. no longer feel related to sb. else or a group, or make sth. separated from sth. else 使…脱离；使…不联系；使…分开

be tied to

1 be fastened to sth. by a piece of string or other long, thin material 同…系在一起

2 be restricted by a particular situation, job etc., so that you cannot do exactly what you want 被…束缚（或约束、限制）

peel (sth.) off remove or separate a thin covering or part from the outside or surface of sth. （使）剥落；（使）脱落

subscribe to sth. agree with an idea 同意，赞同（想法）

alienate sb. from sth. make sb. feel that they do not belong to a place or group 使某人与…疏远；使某人感到与…格格不入

be intolerant of be not willing to accept ways of thinking and behaving that are different from your own 不能容忍…

plunge into jump or dive into water 跳入，潜入（水中）

shut out prevent sth. or sb. from entering a place 不让…进入；挡住

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

2 Choose the best answer to each of the following questions.

1 What does "debris" in the first sentence of Para. 1 most probably refer to?
- A Waste produced by modern factories.
- B Waste created by modern households.
- C Modern things the author finds unpleasant.
- D Problems modern people find challenging.

2 What does the author intend to say in Para. 6?
- A Human beings can find natural ways to take care of themselves.
- B Human beings are using artificial things on themselves to fool others.
- C Human beings are foolish enough to make changes even to themselves.
- D Human beings should be careful not to change themselves too much.

3 According to the author, in modern homes, family members usually _____.
- A enjoy doing things together
- B respect each other's privacy
- C connect with each other through social apps
- D have little communication with each other

4 In Para. 7, the author gives many "don'ts" to indicate that _____.
- A people face a lot of restrictions even when at home
- B modern homes are filled with too much luxury stuff
- C family members are growing distant from each other
- D parents like to give orders to children for everything

5 To the author, walking a hundred feet through mud and snow to an outdoor toilet on a winter night _____.
- A brings pleasure to life as a way to connect with nature
- B causes people not to be afraid of winter cold any more
- C makes people dream of moving to more luxury houses
- D shows a kind of healthy lifestyle that modern people need

6 In Paras. 9-11, the author tries to make us learn that _____.
- A odors from artificial things are harmful to human health
- B the life of modern people is totally separated from nature
- C people have different understanding about the natural world
- D technology makes it easier for people to experience the real world

7 Which of the following best describes the author's tone?
- A Gentle and entertaining.
- B Soft and emotional.
- C Mocking and insightful.
- D Warm and reassuring.

8 What is the main purpose of the text?
- A To request humans to stop abusing animals.
- B To urge humans to respect and enjoy nature.
- C To show that nature is generous to humans.
- D To prove that humans are powerful creatures.

Critical thinking

3 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 Do you agree that modernization has isolated people from nature? Why or why not?

2 Do you think you can live in the wilderness for a week without using any modern conveniences? Why or why not?

3 Nowadays, some people are eager to go back to nature. Why do you think this happens?

4 How important is nature to you? Do you have a favorite natural spot? What is it like?

5 Besides traditional parks and zoos, what else can we do to bring more nature back to cities?

Collocation

More language exercises

The earth is one of the most beautiful planets of the solar system and is home to numerous species. However, today, the ***essential ecology*** (B4U4A) of the earth is suffering from many serious environmental problems, such as ***ozone depletion*** (B4U4A) and the ***greenhouse effect*** (B4U4A). Lacking the sense to be environmentally protective and responsible, humans have been making the environmental conditions worse day by day. Polluted air and water are posing a ***grave threat*** (B4U4A) to the ***ecological balance*** (B4U4A) of the earth and causing drastic ***ecological change*** (B4U4A). Polluted soil, massive soil erosion, and red tides around coastal areas are ***contaminating the earth*** (B4U4B). The fast-paced industrialization and the ever-increasing number of vehicles on streets have left behind long-term thermal consequences, such as the rise of ***global temperature*** (B4U4A), melting ice caps, and flooded coastlines. Extreme weather events in the form of both severe droughts and floods are other severe consequences caused by global warming and climate change.

Because of all these problems, ***environmental necessities*** (B4U4A) raise urgent demands on us. While more people have developed some ***environmental awareness*** (B4U4A) and are doing what they can to ***preserve nature*** (B4U4A), like conserving water and ***economizing on energy*** (B4U4A), there is still a ***dire need*** (B4U4A) to do more to ensure that the earth has a ***vibrant future*** (B4U4A). After all, the fate of human beings and that of the earth are inseparably bound.

4 The following is a letter from an ecologist who shows much concern for the current environmental conditions of our Mother Earth. Complete the letter with appropriate collocations from the texts.

To: Inhabitants of the earth

From: An ecologist

Dear inhabitants of the earth,

Our thoughtless exploitation of nature has already resulted in the effects that we see all around us. The 1) *eco*_____ *ch*_____ has finally hit us hard. Now as more and more studies are being carried out to understand the seriousness of various environmental issues, an increasing number of people are awakening to the fact that the protection of the environment and human survival are inseparably bound.

Global warming is caused by the increased intensity of the 2) *gr*_____ *ef*_____. As the percentage of greenhouse gases rises, the temperature of the

earth increases, which leads to climate change and is also responsible for the melting ice caps and rising sea levels. If the 3) *gl*_____ *tem*_____ keeps rising at the current rate, then the 4) *ess*_____ *ec*_____ of the entire planet can eventually be damaged.

Besides, non-renewable energy sources such as coal and petroleum are contributing to global warming, too. Not only does the excessive use of these energy sources lead to their depletion, but the pollution brought by burning them also 5) *con*_____ *the ear*_____. Meanwhile, the chemical substances released into the atmosphere cause 6) *oz*_____ *dep*_____, which in turn adds to global warming. Therefore, many countries are now 7) *econ*_____ *on en*_____ and searching for alternative energy sources such as solar and wind energy.

It is true that the world has progressed a lot, but people's 8) *env*_____ *aw*_____ does not seem to have developed as fast, and the amount of harmful waste is still increasing. Dealing with this issue has topped the list of 9) *env*_____ *nec*_____. Many industries which produce waste materials, such as lead, plastic, and other chemicals, do not process them properly to 10) *pre*_____ *na*_____; instead, they dump waste in land or water, which further results in the damage of soil and water.

All these environmental issues pose a 11) *gr*_____ *th*_____ to human beings and wildlife. So, I'm here to call for urgent action to save our Mother Earth and ensure a 12) *vi*_____ *fu*_____ for humanity and all other species.

Yours sincerely,
Go Green

Stories of China

A green finish line

In China's persistent efforts to fight against desertification (沙漠化), Wang Wenbiao, better known as the "Son of the Desert," is playing an exemplary role.

Wang is the chairman of the Elion Resources Group, a Chinese green enterprise. He lives in the Kubuqi Desert (库布齐沙漠) in Inner Mongolia Autonomous Region. The constant expansion of the desert used to force many people to migrate, while those who stayed faced poverty and hardship. When Wang was young, his dream was to leave the desert as well. However, for the past 30 years, as chairman of the Elion Resources Group, Wang has dedicated his life and work to the battle against desertification.

Wang was first motivated by entrepreneurship. In 1988, he gave up his stable job as a government clerk and ventured into business, managing a near-bankrupt salt company on the edge of the desert. Despite the rich salt reserves in the lake beside his factory, he constantly worried about the company's operations as the desert was swallowing the lake. Wang set up a special fund and assigned one-third of his staff to plant trees surrounding the lake. His plan worked, and the salt company managed to make a small profit.

However, since there was no road through the desert to the nearest train station, which was 67 km away, all the salt had to be transported via a 350 km route. High transport costs further squeezed the already thin profit margins, which made the salt company hard to sustain.

In 1999, thanks to government efforts to tame the desert, a 115 km highway through the middle of the desert opened to traffic. But unfortunately,

the highway was quickly swallowed up by sand. Wang realized that to do any business in the desert, he first needed to deal with the sand.

He renamed his company Elion, focused on curbing desertification, and developed a business model to generate both economic and ecological benefits. The game-changer in his business model was licorice (甘草) farming because licorice grows well in the desert and is one of the most widely used medicinal herbs in traditional Chinese medicine. Moreover, the plant works well in curbing desertification. The bacteria living in the plant's roots have an effect that increases soil fertility.

Elion encouraged local people to grow licorice, providing them with licorice seedlings (幼苗), training, and other support. When they harvested the roots, Wang's company bought them at a fair price. Through this business model, the desert changed. When viewed from afar, a green finish line now stretches across the desert. As a result, local residents also made money and became rich.

Elion's desert business now covers healthcare, environmental protection, clean energy, farming and livestock (牲畜), tourism, and animal feed processing. To acknowledge his great achievement in combatting desertification, UNEP honored Wang with the Champions of the Earth Award.

Exercises

Translation

Translate the following paragraph into English.

改革开放以来，中国政府采取了一系列改善生态环境、保护生物多样性的措施。许多重点生态工程得到推进或实施，一大批自然保护区（nature reserve）、生态示范区（ecological demonstration zone）和森林公园先后被设立。今后，我们还需要进一步提升生态系统的多样性、稳定性、持续性，牢固树立和践行绿水青山就是金山银山的理念，站在人与自然和谐共生的高度谋划发展。

Unit project

Writing a report on college students' awareness of environmental protection

It is widely recognized that our planet is now challenged by a host of environmental problems. Restoring the health of the earth is an imperative task. As individuals, one thing we can do is to improve our consciousness of environmental protection and do whatever we can to help accomplish the task.

In this unit project, you will work in small groups and write a report on Chinese college students' awareness of environmental protection. Suppose you are members of the Environmental Protection Club at your university. With the coming of World Environment Day, you are running a survey to find out how conscious your college mates are of protecting the environment.

Step 1 **Work in small groups of four or five and design a questionnaire on environmental protection. The following are some questions that can be included. Add more questions of your own.**

- Do you know which day is World Environment Day?
- Do you avoid littering in your daily life?
- Do you avoid using disposable meal boxes and chopsticks?
- Do you avoid disposing of used batteries carelessly?
- Do you avoid using plastic bags when doing grocery shopping?

…

Step 2 **Each of you interview three to five students on campus. Take down their answers to your questions.**

Step 3 **Gather together with your group and analyze the data you have collected. Form a conclusion about how conscious students at your university are of protecting the environment.**

Step 4 **Write a report based on your work as described above and explain your conclusion with clear supporting details. Present your report to the class.**

Unit 5

Passion guides life choices

Like all others, I live in the world to conquer life.

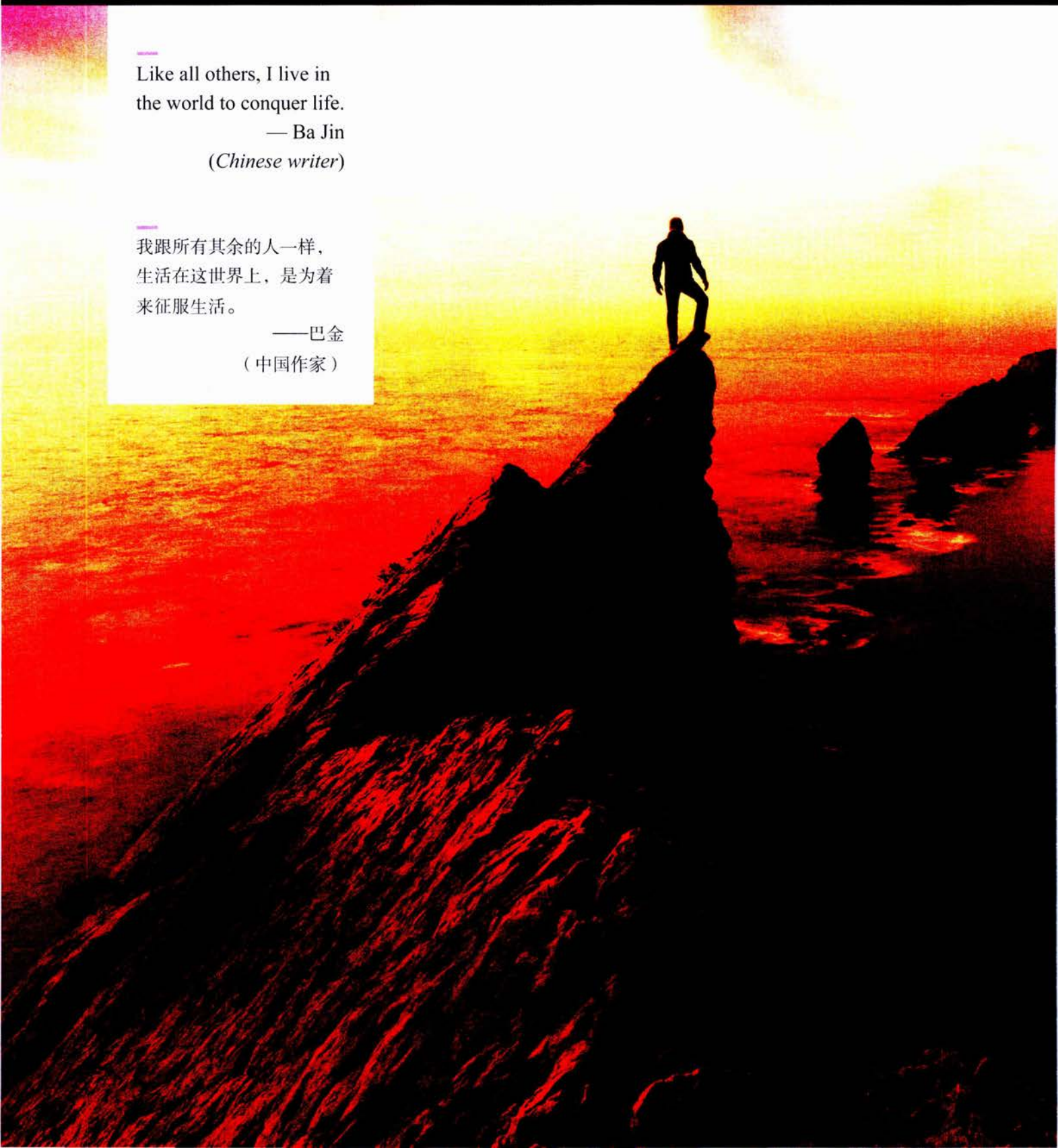
— Ba Jin

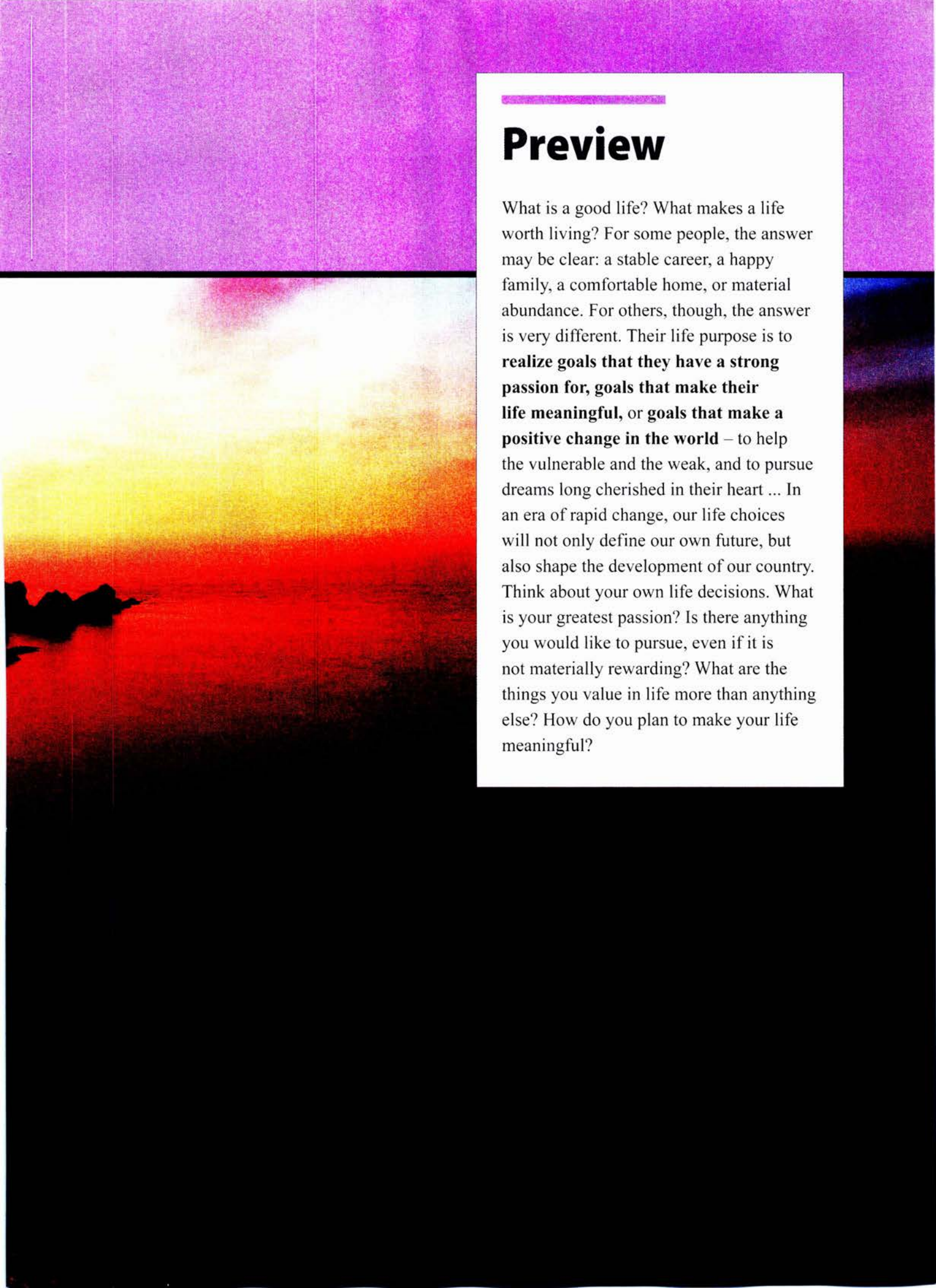
(*Chinese writer*)

我跟所有其余的人一样，生活在这世界上，是为着来征服生活。

——巴金

（中国作家）





Preview

What is a good life? What makes a life worth living? For some people, the answer may be clear: a stable career, a happy family, a comfortable home, or material abundance. For others, though, the answer is very different. Their life purpose is to **realize goals that they have a strong passion for, goals that make their life meaningful,** or **goals that make a positive change in the world** – to help the vulnerable and the weak, and to pursue dreams long cherished in their heart ... In an era of rapid change, our life choices will not only define our own future, but also shape the development of our country. Think about your own life decisions. What is your greatest passion? Is there anything you would like to pursue, even if it is not materially rewarding? What are the things you value in life more than anything else? How do you plan to make your life meaningful?

Section A

Pre-reading activities

1 Read the short passage below and answer the following questions.

I like to use the word *passion* interchangeably with words like *determination*, *conviction*, and *love*. Passion is a strong desire that can get you to do amazing things. An American scholar once said, "Passion will move men beyond themselves, beyond their shortcomings, beyond their failures."

Passion is an emotion to be acted upon. Without action, passion yields no worthwhile results. I like to skateboard, but I don't have the determination to push myself through broken bones and hospital visits. That's why I'm not as good as I could be. I don't have a passion for it.

If you know what you have a passion for, it is important to take action. You can have all the passion in the world for something, but if you never do anything about it, that passion is useless. You're the author of your life. We all have the ability to create whatever kind of life we want. The secret to living the dream is hidden in our passions and what we do because of them.

1 What does the quote in the first paragraph mean?
2 Why is it important to act upon your passion?

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 What is one thing you have a strong passion for?
2 How does passion make our life meaningful?

Text A

1 The death of an angel of animal rights activism does not rate with that of a drugged-out rock star. So when Henry Spira died of cancer in September 1998, his death passed without notice, apart from a brief **obituary** in a newspaper. Yet Henry Spira's life tells us something important, not only about the modern animal movement, but about the possibility of an individual making a difference in the world.

2 I first met Henry when he turned up at an adult education seminar I was giving at New York University. I offered a course on "Animal Liberation" that attracted about 20 students. One student was an unusual **specimen**, outside the regular aesthetic of an "animal person". His clothes were untidy, and his hair uncombed. His language was so **blunt** and earthy that at times I thought I was listening to a character from a **gangster** movie. Yet, I couldn't help feeling **intrigued** with his direct way of speaking and his solemn, **secular oath** to help animals in need.

3 I left New York soon after that, but one day I got a call from Henry. He talked with me about his work. I knew that for over a century, the animal rights movement had been putting out graphic brochures, **leaflets**, and audio materials, alerting people to the dreadful experiments on animals. But in all that time, the number of animals used in experiments had risen from a small batch of a few hundred to more than 30 million. No activist had managed to stop a single experiment or improve the

A meaningful life

lives of animals living in tiny, **constricted enclosures**. Henry changed that. One of his earliest campaigns permanently closed down a laboratory conducting experiments with toxic **vapor** on about 60 rabbits.

4 Following that success, Henry rapidly moved on to bigger targets. He laid **siege** to a large **cosmetics** company over its use of rabbits to test cosmetics for potential eye damage, and **exerted** enough pressure to persuade the company to put $750,000 into the search for alternatives. Having seen the **boycott** that company had narrowly averted and being afraid of **incurring** similar **wrath**, other major cosmetics corporations soon followed suit. Though it took 10 years for the research to achieve results, it was largely Henry's public and **judicious watchdog** efforts that brought so many cosmetics corporations to where they now truthfully state their products are not tested on animals.

5 From decades spent working on the side of the weak and **oppressed**, Henry became efficient at **masterminding** campaigns. His great victories didn't require wealth, legislators, or the help of big governments. He learned how to build public awareness campaigns, how to shape **malpractice lawsuits** to successfully **sue** large companies, and how to build committed groups of supporters for the cause.

6 We often assume that society has become too big and too bureaucratic for individuals to make a difference. How could one individual, however **humane** and passionate, possibly bring about change in the face of powerful global corporations, managerial indifference, and complicated **parliamentary** rules?

7 Henry's life was dedicated to the cause of preventing the suffering of innocent, helpless animals, especially those used in research. He didn't stand on the **sidelines** or try to get

revenge for the suffering he observed. Henry was practical. He acted. He appealed to the public and created publicity **kits** to help common people become activists.

8 On April 21, 1996, I sent Henry a fax telling him I was thinking about writing a book to **chronicle** his life and work. I asked whether I could stay with him for a few days in June to talk about it.

9 Henry called that evening. He said he'd really like me to write the book, but he wasn't sure he was still going to be around in late June. He explained that he'd been **diagnosed** with cancer, and asked whether I could come earlier.

10 I was in New York six days later. Henry had lost a lot of weight, and lacked the energy I used to see in him. His life **expectancy** was a matter of months. Death seemed to be **stalking** him.

11 The most remarkable thing about Henry, though, was the total absence of any sign of depression. Life had been good, he said, refusing to hear my **sympathy** and **condolences**. He said he'd done what he wanted to do and enjoyed it a lot. Why should he be depressed?

12 Henry's life did not terminate in the time his doctors predicted. For the next two years, he kept working, helping develop the material I needed for the book through interviews and **questionnaires**. When I began writing, I never thought Henry would see a completed draft, but he lived to see the book on sale in a New York bookstore. Then, within a week, wearing his favorite **striped** pajamas, he died.

13 One essential mark of living well is to be satisfied with one's accomplishments when taking a retrospective look at life, and to be able to accept death and face **infinity** calmly. Henry's life seemed to lack many of the things that most of us take for granted as essential to a good life. He never married, or had a long-term relationship. He had no children or **successors**. He never went to concerts, to the theater, or to fine restaurants. He didn't bring **antibiotics** to the needy or **vaccinate** the poor. He was never called a hero like the **caped crusaders** in our comic books. There is no fancy stone for him at the **cemetery** after his death. He just cared for the weakest creatures in his society. What gave Henry Spira's life depth and purpose? What did he – and others – find meaningful in the way he lived his life?

(950 words)

New words

obituary /əˈbɪtʃuəri/ *n.* [C] an article in a newspaper about the life of sb. who has just died （报纸上的）讣告，讣闻，讣文

▲ **specimen** /ˈspesɪmɪn/ *n.* [C]
1 a particular type of person – often used in a humorous way 某一类人（常为幽默用法）
2 a small amount or piece that is taken from sth., so that it can be tested or examined （用于测试或检验的）抽样，样品，标本

blunt /blʌnt/ *a.*
1 speaking in an honest way even if this upsets people（说话）率直的，直言不讳的，不客气的
2 not sharp or pointed 钝的；不锋利的；不尖的

▲ **gangster** /ˈgæŋstə/ *n.* [C] a member of an organized group of violent criminals 黑帮成员；犯罪团伙成员

intrigue /ɪnˈtriːg/ *vt.* make sb. very interested in knowing more about sth. because it seems strange or mysterious 激起兴趣；引起好奇心；迷住

intrigued /ɪnˈtriːgd/ *a.* very interested in sth. because it seems strange or mysterious 有极大兴趣的；深感好奇的；着迷的

secular /ˈsekjələ/ *a.* not religious, or not connected with religion 非宗教的；与宗教无关的；世俗的

oath /əʊθ/ *n.* [C] a formal promise, esp. one made in a court of law （尤指法庭上的）誓言，誓约，誓词

leaflet /ˈliːflɪt/ *n.* [C] a printed sheet of paper, usu. folded, that is provided free and gives information about sth. 散页印刷品；传单

constrict /kənˈstrɪkt/ *v.*
1 make sth. narrower or tighter, or become narrower or tighter（使）收缩；（使）压缩；压紧
2 limit what sb. is able or allowed to do 限制；约束

enclosure /ɪnˈkləʊʒə/ *n.* [C]
1 an area surrounded by a fence or wall 圈地；围场
2 (*fml.*) sth. that is put in an envelope along with a letter （信的）附件

▲ **vapor** /ˈveɪpə/ *n.* [C, U] (*BrE* **vapour**) a mass of very small drops of water or other liquids in the air 蒸汽；水汽

▲ **siege** /siːdʒ/ *n.* [C, U] a situation in which an army or the police surround a place and try to gain control of it or force sb. to come out of it （军队或警方对某地的）包围，围困，封锁

cosmetics /kɒzˈmetɪks/ *n.* [pl.] substances that you use on your face or body to look more attractive 化妆品；美容品

▲ **exert** /ɪgˈzɜːt/ *vt.*
1 use power, influence, authority, etc. in order to affect or achieve sth. 行使（权力）；施加（影响力）；运用（权威）
2 (**~ oneself**) work very hard and use a lot of physical or mental energy 竭力；努力

boycott /ˈbɔɪkɒt/
n. [C] an act of refusing to buy, use, or take part in sth. as a way of protesting 抵制行为
vt. refuse to buy sth., use sth., or take part in sth. as a way of protesting 抵制；排斥；拒绝参加

incur /ɪnˈkɜː/ *vt.*
1 experience sth. unpleasant as a result of sth. you have done 招致（不快之事）；遭受
2 lose money, owe money, or have to pay money as a result of doing sth. 引致（钱财损失、债务、费用开支）；蒙受；造成

wrath /rɒθ/ *n.* [U] (*fml.*) very great anger 愤怒；狂怒

judicious /dʒuːˈdɪʃəs/ *a.* (*fml.*) showing intelligence and good judgment 明智的；明断的；有见地的

watchdog /ˈwɒtʃdɒg/ *n.* [C]
1 a person or organization that works to stop people from doing illegal things in a particular area of business or society 监察人；监督人；监督机构

2 a dog used for guarding a house or piece of property 看门狗；看家狗

oppress /əˈpres/ *vt.* (*often passive*)
1 treat people who are less powerful in an unfair and cruel way 压迫；压制；镇压
2 make sb. feel worried, unhappy, or uncomfortable 使压抑；使烦恼

oppressed /əˈprest/ *a.*
1 suffering from unfair and cruel treatment by a more powerful person or government 受压迫的；受压制的
2 feeling very unhappy, worried, or uncomfortable 烦恼的；压抑的；忧郁的

mastermind /ˈmɑːstəmaɪnd/
vt. think of, plan, and organize a large, important, and complicated operation 策划；组织
n. [C] sb. who plans and organizes a complicated operation, esp. a crime（尤指犯罪活动的）出谋划策者，主谋

malpractice /mælˈpræktɪs/ *n.* [C, U] careless or criminal behavior by sb. with a professional or official job 玩忽职守；渎职；失职

lawsuit /ˈlɔːsuːt/ *n.* [C] a case that a court of law is asked to decide involving a disagreement between two people or organizations（非刑事案件的）诉讼

sue /sjuː/ *v.* make a legal claim against sb., usu. to get money from them because they have done sth. bad to you（通常为索赔而）起诉，控告

humane /hjuːˈmeɪn/ *a.* treating people or animals in a way that is not cruel and causes them as little suffering as possible 人道的；仁慈的

▲ parliamentary /ˌpɑːləˈmentəri/ *a.* relating to or governed by a parliament 议会的；国会的

sideline /ˈsaɪdlaɪn/ *n.* [C]
1 **(on the ~s)** the state of not taking part in an activity even though you want to or should do 旁观（某活动）；袖手旁观；置身事外
2 a job that you do in addition to your main job, in order to earn extra money 兼职；副业

revenge /rɪˈvendʒ/ *n.* [U]
1 sth. that you do in order to punish sb. who has harmed or offended you 复仇；报复
2 the defeat of sb. who has previously defeated you in a sport 雪耻（指在比赛中战胜曾经击败自己的对手）

▲ kit /kɪt/ *n.* [C] a set of tools or equipment for a particular purpose or activity 成套工具；成套设备

chronicle /ˈkrɒnɪkəl/
vt. make a record of events in the order in which they happened 将（某事件）载入编年史；记载
n. [C] a record of events that happened in the past, in the order in which they happened 编年史；年代记

▲ diagnose /ˈdaɪəgnəʊz/ *vt.* find out what illness sb. has, or what the cause of a fault is, after doing tests, examinations, etc. 诊断；判断

▲ expectancy /ɪkˈspektənsi/ *n.* [U] the feeling that sth. good or exciting is going to happen 期待；期望

stalk /stɔːk/ *vt.*
1 follow a person or animal quietly in order to catch and attack or kill them（为捉住并袭击或杀死某人或动物而）悄悄地跟踪，潜近
2 follow and watch sb. over a long period of time in a way that is very annoying or threatening（以令人讨厌或生畏的方式）跟踪，盯梢

▲ sympathy /ˈsɪmpəθi/ *n.* [pl., U]
1 a natural feeing of kindness and understanding that you have for sb. who is in a bad situation 同情；同情心
2 agreement with or support of a group, idea, plan, etc. 赞同；支持

condolence /kənˈdəʊləns/ *n.* [C, usu. pl., U] sympathy for sb. who has had sth. bad happen to them, esp. when sb. has died（尤指有人去世时所表示的）同情，吊唁

▲ **questionnaire** /ˌkwestʃəˈneə/ *n.* [C] a written set of questions which you give to a large number of people in order to collect information（用以收集资料的）调查问卷，调查表

▲ **stripe** /straɪp/ *n.* [C] a line of one color on a background of a different color 条纹；条带

striped /straɪpt/ *a.* having lines or bands of color 有（彩色）条纹的

▲ **infinity** /ɪnˈfɪnəti/ *n.*

1 [U] a space, time, or distance that continues without end or limits（空间、时间或距离的）无限，无穷
2 [sing.] a very large amount of sth., or a large number of things 无穷大；无限多

▲ **successor** /səkˈsesə/ *n.* [C] sb. who takes a job or position previously held by sb. else 继承人；继任者；接班人

antibiotic /ˌæntɪbaɪˈɒtɪk/ *n.* [C, usu. pl.] a drug that is used to kill bacteria and cure infections 抗生素；抗菌素

vaccinate /ˈvæksəneɪt/ *vt.* protect a person or animal from a disease by giving them a vaccine 给…接种疫苗；给…打预防针

cape /keɪp/ *n.* [C]

1 a loose piece of clothing without sleeves that hangs from your shoulders 披肩；披风；斗篷
2 a large area of land surrounded on three sides by water 海角；岬

crusader /kruːˈseɪdə/ *n.* [C] sb. who works hard for a long time to achieve sth. that they strongly believe is morally right 社会改革家

cemetery /ˈsemətri/ *n.* [C] an area of land where dead people are buried 墓地；公墓

Phrases and expressions

turn up

1 arrive at a place, esp. in a way that is unexpected（尤指意外地）到达，来到
2 be found, esp. by chance, after having been lost or searched for（意外地）被找到，被发现

put out produce information for people to read, watch, or hear 制作；发行；公告

alert sb. to sth. make sb. realize sth. important or dangerous 提醒（某人）注意；引起（某人）重视

lay siege to sth. / sb.

1 start to strongly attack, criticize, or threaten sth. or sb. 向…展开攻势
2 start an attack in which an army or the police surround a place and try to gain control of it or force sb. to come out of it 开始包围；围攻

follow suit do the same as sb. else has done 跟着做；仿效

in the face of in a situation where you have to deal with sth. unpleasant or difficult 面对

stand / stay / remain on the sidelines not take part in an activity even though you want to or should do 袖手旁观；置身事外

get revenge (on sb.) for sth. do sth. in order to punish sb. for sth. harmful or offensive they have done to you 因为…报复（某人）；因为…（向某人）复仇

appeal to make a request for sb. to give you help, money, or information, etc. 恳请某人做…；呼吁某人做…

Proper names

Henry Spira 亨利·斯皮拉（1927—1998，美国动物权利运动家）

New York University 纽约大学

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

1 Answer the following questions.

1 When did the author first meet Henry?
2 According to Para. 2, why did the author think that Henry was an unusual person?
3 According to Para. 3, what was one of Henry's earliest achievements in animal rights campaigns?
4 What changes did many cosmetics companies make because of Henry's efforts?
5 According to Para. 5, what did Henry become skilled at during his campaigns?
6 Why could Henry succeed in making a difference as an individual?
7 How did Henry react to the doctors' prediction that he might die in a few months?
8 According to the text, what is one essential mark of living well?

Critical thinking

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 Why do you think Henry Spira had a meaningful life?
2 When you choose a career, what will you consider to be most important, and why?
3 What do you think are the characteristics of a meaningful life?
4 How shall we handle failures and obstacles on our journey of pursuing passion or life goals?
5 Do you know of anyone who has done meaningful deeds at the cost of their own interests? What is their story?

Language focus

Words in use

3 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

chronicle constrict expectancy
incur intrigue malpractice stalk
sympathy successor vaccinate

1 The average life _____ in developing countries has risen rapidly due to improvements in nutrition, medicine, and public health.
2 Jonathan found himself lying on a bench in the park after waking up from a long dream in which a fierce animal _____ him in darkness.
3 Up until that time, I hadn't thought much about classical music; instead, what really _____ me were pop songs.
4 Some deadly diseases have been virtually eliminated thanks to the dedicated efforts to _____ the world's population.
5 Research shows that medical _____ can be effectively prevented when doctors abide by professional regulations strictly.
6 Consisting of three episodes, the documentary _____ China's dramatic economic and social development in the last century.
7 He is planning to retire as executive director of the organization in a few months, but he has agreed to stay on until a(n) _____ is appointed.
8 The clothing you wear to the gym shouldn't be too tight because you don't want to work out in something that _____ your movements.
9 The company decided to redesign the advertisement after realizing that it might _____ criticism from consumers.
10 After hearing about the family's difficulties, all the neighbors felt great _____ and offered to help in whatever way they could.

Word building

与某些动词结合构成名词，表示与动词有关的动作。也可与某些动词或名词结合构成新的名词，指生产或存放某物的场所。

bake		bakery
deliver		delivery
recover	>	recovery
forge		**forgery**
wine		**winery**

与某些名词结合构成形容词，描述与名词有关的特征。当名词是以 -er、-or、-ce、-y 或 -ent 结尾时常用 -ial。

finance		financial
manager		managerial
origin		original
resident		residential
institution	>	**institutional**
president		**presidential**
recreation		**recreational**
sacrifice		**sacrificial**
territory		**territorial**

4 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

forgery　institutional　presidential
recreational　territorial
sacrificial　winery

1 Individual investors were able to purchase additional shares of the company because the demand from _____ buyers like banks and investment funds was weaker than expected.
2 A team of experts in the museum will use special equipment to analyze the painting to determine whether it is the original or a(n) _____.
3 The Charter of the United Nations stipulates (规定) that its member states shall refrain from any action against the _____ integrity or political independence of any state.
4 This region is famous for its vineyards, so we always enjoy exploring local _____ and tasting a glass or two when we visit.
5 The Temple of Heaven, where royal rituals were held to worship heaven, is the most complete existing complex of imperial _____ buildings in China.
6 The results of the upcoming U.S. _____ election will determine who is to run the country for the next four years.
7 Regardless of one's age, participation in _____ sports can improve physical health, boost mental skills, and encourage social interaction.

Banked cloze

5 Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

A clipped	F enormous	K occur
B convictions	G immigrated	L offspring
C disruptive	H incur	M purchase
D domination	I inheritance	N reluctance
E donation	J innovative	O vaccinated

Jack MacDonald, a Seattle man, left a fortune worth $187.6 million to charity after living a frugal and humble life. The 1) _____ was the largest charitable gift in Washington State in 2013.

MacDonald struck people as a man without much money. He 2) _____ coupons to save money on groceries, wore sweaters with holes, and took a bus to attend alumni luncheons. He once bought so many cans of frozen juice at a bargain price that he had to 3) _____ a new freezer to hold them.

MacDonald left 40 percent of his fortune to Seattle Children's Research Institute to support a variety of 4) _____ research in childhood diseases, although he had no 5) _____ of his own. He was born in British Columbia, Canada, grew up in Seattle, and worked as a lawyer for three decades. He did not get married until he was in his 50s.

MacDonald made a huge fortune by investing in the stock market. After his parents died, he received a large family 6) _____. He never thought about buying any luxuries although he had 7) _____ wealth at his disposal. Material possessions weren't important to him.

MacDonald might have been eccentric in some ways, but he always acted on his 8) _____ to do good with his wealth. Over the years, he contributed to hundreds of causes and organizations. He also sent anonymous gifts to a small town in Canada where his grandparents lived after they 9) _____ there from Scotland.

In July 2013, MacDonald was hospitalized due to a serious head injury that would eventually lead to his death. In the two months before he died, he insisted on using inexpensive ordinary drugs so that his treatment wouldn't 10) _____ additional costs. He once said he would like to be remembered as a philanthropist (慈善家). With his generosity and selflessness, surely he has been.

Expressions in use

6 Fill in the blanks with the expressions given below. Change the form where necessary. Each expression can be used only once.

alert sb. to appeal to follow suit put out
lay siege to stand on the sidelines turn up

1 Compassionate and caring, he never _____ when the vulnerable groups needed help, and he made a difference!
2 The international meeting released a joint statement _____ all countries in the world to work together to tackle global issues like poverty and climate change.
3 We didn't expect that such a small art show would attract many visitors, so it was quite a surprise that more than a hundred people _____ in the gallery.
4 A common theme in science fiction films is that aliens _____ the earth and then their attempt is defeated by humans using less advanced technology.
5 China and some other countries have committed to net zero emissions of greenhouse gases by mid-century, and many more are _____.
6 With the improvement of smart safety features of modern cars, road accidents are expected to decrease as drivers can _____ potential dangers or bad traffic conditions.
7 To help residents prepare for the predicted snowstorm, the local weather bureau _____ early warnings and provided updates through various channels.

Structure analysis and writing

Structure analysis

Writing a personal narrative

A personal narrative is a story told in the first person, often using pronouns like *I* and *me*. It is not creative fiction, but a story based on real life. It can be about the author himself, about something he saw, or about someone he knows or heard second-hand. A personal narrative typically elaborates on an experience (e.g. a memorable journey or a significant accomplishment) that in some way impressed or changed the main character in the story. Like other narrative essays, a good personal narrative should include sensory details and descriptions. This helps the reader understand what the author saw, heard, and felt during the event.

Since the author tells the story from his own point of view, this type of essay usually contains both facts and opinions. The facts serve to provide details of the story. The opinions are used to comment on or evaluate the facts. Both are needed if the essay is to be effective and interesting.

Text A of this unit is a personal narrative which tells the story of a person whom the author knows. The main character, Henry Spira, was an animal rights activist who dedicated his life to reducing the suffering of animals. In writing the story, the author not only presents facts that show Henry's achievements, but also gives his own thoughts, opinions, and evaluations about Henry's life. Through this writing method, the author effectively depicts Henry as a person who led a simple but meaningful life.

Look at the following paragraphs from Text A.

Following that success, Henry rapidly moved on to bigger targets. He laid siege to a large cosmetics company over its use of rabbits to test cosmetics for potential eye damage, and exerted enough pressure to persuade the company to put $750,000 into the search for alternatives. Having seen the boycott that company had narrowly averted and being afraid of incurring similar wrath, other major cosmetics corporations soon followed suit ... (Para. 4) (Facts)

We often assume that society has become too big and too bureaucratic for individuals to make a difference. How could one individual, however humane and passionate, possibly bring about change in the face of powerful global corporations, managerial indifference and complicated parliamentary rules? (Para. 6) (Opinions)

These two paragraphs show how the author skillfully uses facts and opinions to make the story both vivid and thoughtful. Para. 4 contains mostly facts describing Henry's campaign against a large cosmetics company and its influence on other companies, and Para. 6 gives the author's comments on Henry's contributions to the animal rights movement.

Structured writing

Read the sample essay and see how facts and opinions are used in a personal narrative.

Topic
Giving to others

Introduction
- **Background**
- **Thesis:** I have always believed in giving to others.

Body
- Specific instances of selfless giving by people around me
- My donations to various charities

Conclusion
- Restatement of the importance of giving to others
- A call to action

Helping others through charitable donations is a virtue cherished in our society. Probably because I have been blessed to know many generous people in my life, I have always believed in giving to others.

As I was growing up, I saw many instances of selfless giving by people around me. In childhood, I saw my parents donate food and money to those in need and do volunteer work at hospitals and nursing homes. When I was 15, a friend of mine organized a blood drive in his community to help an 80-year-old lady to get life-saving surgery. My parents and this friend of mine were not rich or famous, but they were true heroes of their communities. They acted selflessly when someone needed help.

Influenced by these people around me, I began to look for ways to give to others when I reached adulthood, married, and started my own family. I found the best way to do so was to donate a small portion of my monthly salary toward selected charities. I don't always give to the same charity every year, but I do give to one or more annually. When natural disasters struck some places last year, I acted immediately to find organizations to donate money and clothing. This year, when I learned from the news that an elementary school needed books for its new library, I bought 50 children's books and mailed them to the school.

Giving is a personal thing, and I know there are just as many reasons for people not to give as there are reasons to give. But giving to charities is my way of helping others. I hope by sharing these stories, others will better understand how much their generosity means to a whole host of charities. We can't support every single charity by ourselves, but together we do make a difference!

7 Write a personal narrative of no less than 150 words on one of the following topics. One topic has an outline that you can follow.

Topic

The best class I've ever had

Introduction

- **Background:** There have been many classes that have left a lasting impression on me.
- **Thesis:** Out of all those, the best one was a vivid, interactive, and engaging biology class I attended in high school.

Body

- **Facts:** A description of how the class was taught
- **Opinions:** My opinions, thoughts, or comments about the class

Conclusion

This class combined all the elements of a good class: vividness, interaction, and participation.

More topics

- A meaningful thing I have done
- A person who has influenced me

Section B

Reading skills

Understanding figurative language

Figurative language produces images in the reader's mind. It presents descriptions and expresses ideas in vivid and imaginative ways by appealing to the senses. In B2U4, we have learned three types of figurative language: simile, metaphor, and personification. The texts in this unit also make use of figurative language. Look at the following examples taken from Text A.

- *The death of an angel of animal rights activism does not rate with that of a drugged-out rock star.* (Para. 1) (Metaphor)
- *His language was so blunt and earthy that at times I thought I was listening to a character from a gangster movie.* (Para. 2) (Metaphor)
- *Death seemed to be stalking him.* (Para. 10) (Personification)

Metaphor is used in the first two sentences. In the first example, Henry Spira is compared to *an angel* to suggest that he made great contributions to the animal rights movement. In the second example, the author compares Henry to a member of a violent mob, which vividly shows how blunt his language was. The third example employs personification, by which something non-human (i.e. *death*) is described as behaving like somebody who follows a person quietly in order to catch or kill them.

1 The following sentences are from Text B. Decide what type of figurative language is used in each sentence and explain how it is used.

1 Late one afternoon when I finally read the Book Review section, my blood began to boil. (Para.1)

_____

2 I felt like my heritage was a defendant at a tribunal, and I had no choice but to protect it and denounce such a partial observation. (Para. 2)

_____

3 Realistically, I approached writing like waxing a car, thoroughly and repeatedly. (Para. 5)

_____

4 Think about your feelings deep down in your bones. Measure the heat of the fire there, for that is the passion that will flow through every particle of your being. (Para. 13)

_____

Text B

A turning point in my life

1 I wasn't yet 30 years old and was working as a firefighter in New York City, in a firehouse completely **swamped** with calls. In the rare moments when we weren't busy, I would make calls on our cordless phone **handset** or rush to our office to read Captain Gray's subscription of a Sunday newspaper. Late one afternoon when I finally read the Book Review section, my blood began to boil. An article stated a **thesis** I took to be inaccurate and offensive: William Butler Yeats, the Nobel Prize-winning light of the Irish Literary Renaissance, had stripped off his Irishness and was now a universal poet. I grew **indignant** suddenly, and a deep-seated passion within me was **activated**.

2 There were few things I was more proud of than my Irish **heritage**. My ancestors were Irish farmers, fishermen and blue-collar workers, all of whom were **patrons** of literature. From the time my family came **ashore** on Ellis Island and faced the threat of being **deported**, we have fought discrimination against Irish **immigrants**. Ever since I first picked up a book of his poems, Yeats has been my favorite writer. He wrote his poetry in close **adherence** to his Irish sensibilities. His life was, in essence, a **tribute** to his homeland. To me, Yeats is both universal and Irish, and the very attributes that made him world-famous were also what

characterized him as Irish. So it was offensive to think Irishness, no matter if it was psychological, social, or literary, was something that could be erased. I felt like my heritage was a **defendant** at a **tribunal**, and I had no choice but to protect it and **denounce** such a partial observation.

3 Vibrating with **agitation**, I grabbed a piece of paper, one that had the logo of the Fire Department of the City of New York across the top. I began a letter, **trumpeting** my strong disagreement with the editor of the Sunday Book Review, describing Yeats as he was: a writer both truly universal and fundamentally Irish in all he did and wrote.

4 I don't know why I felt I had to defend the greatest poet of Ireland from being "**prosecuted**", or to **compose** a defense of Irish writing. I just knew that I had to write that letter in the same way that a musician has to play an instrument.

5 Until that point in my life, I hadn't written much of value – a few poems and short stories. But, like a beginning artist who longs to see his work come to life and become an **animated** film, I understood that the more one draws or writes, the better the end result will become. **Realistically**, I approached writing like **waxing** a car, thoroughly and repeatedly. So I wrote often to improve my writing skills. I **tentatively** sent material to various magazines and reviews, but no one had ever been willing to publish me.

6 So it was an unexpected delight when that Sunday newspaper published my **commentary**. I suppose the editor decided to publish it because he was first attracted by the official nature of my stationery, and then by the **refined** language of my letter. I'd like to think, though, that the editor silently agreed with me.

7 I received about 20 sympathetic and congratulatory letters from professors and **tacked** them up by the **superintendent's** desk. These letters **tickled** me, making my heart **flutter** with the thought that I was not only a published writer but an opinion maker. I was suddenly **dubbed** as someone whose views mattered.

8 Incidentally, I also received letters from a few most popular magazines asking for interviews. It was one of these magazines that **ignited** my career – the article titled "Fireman Smith" provided the **impetus** for a large publishing company to request a **manuscript** about my life.

9 I had always subscribed to the belief that the work of firefighters was a worthy subject for a book, but it had received incomprehensive **coverage** so far. I was **bewildered** at first, with little confidence in my ability to write a whole book. So, I began little by little, writing one **module** at a time. I soon had the basic **skeleton** and framework for my book. The book went on to sell two million copies and was translated into

12 languages. In the following years, I wrote three more best-sellers, and last year published an autobiography.

10 Being a writer had been far from my expectations; being **crowned** a best-selling author was almost unimaginable. How had it happened? I often found myself thinking about it, marveling at the **inconsistency** between my success and earlier failure. My thoughts always came back to the nucleus at the center of it all, that letter to the Sunday newspaper.

11 The clearest explanation is that I had found a subject I felt so strongly about that the writing was a natural consequence of that passion. I felt the same kind of passion when I began writing about firefighters and, later, a **serial** story about my mother. Whatever the subjects, they are always meaningful and timely because they represent the great values of human life – decency, honesty, and fairness – subjects that burn within me as I write.

12 Over the years, all five of my children have come to me every now and then with one dilemma or another. Should I go out for soccer or basketball? Should I take a job with this company or that one?

13 My answer is always the same: Think about your feelings deep down in your bones. Measure the heat of the fire there, for that is the passion that will flow through every **particle** of your being. Always find that passion. And, if you lose it, **retrieve** it and start again. Your education and your experience will guide you toward making the right decision, but your passion will always enable you to make a difference in whatever you do.

14 That's what I learned the day I stood up for Ireland's greatest poet.

(*996 words*)

Culture notes

William Butler Yeats: an Irish poet, dramatist, and prose writer. He is widely considered one of the leading figures of 20th-century literature.

Irish Literary Renaissance: a literary movement in the late 19th and early 20th centuries that was associated with a revival of interest in Ireland's ancient literary traditions.

Ellis Island: an island in New York Harbor. It was the main port of entry for European immigrants to the United States in the late 19th and early 20th centuries.

New words

swamp /swɒmp/ *vt.* (*usu. passive*)

1 **(be swamped with / by sth.)** suddenly give sb. a lot of work, problems, etc. to deal with 使陷入（大量工作）；使面临（大量问题）

2 **(be swamped with / by sth. / sb.)** go somewhere or surround sth. in large numbers, esp. in a short period of time 涌入；蜂拥

handset /ˈhændset/ *n.* [C] the part of a telephone that you hold near your ear and mouth 电话听筒

▲ **thesis** /ˈθiːsɪs/ *n.* [C]

1 (*fml.*) an idea, opinion, or theory that is used to explain sth. 论点；论题

2 a long piece of writing that is the final part of an advanced degree（学位）论文；毕业论文

indignant /ɪnˈdɪgnənt/ *a.* angry because of an unfair situation or sb.'s unfair behavior（因不公正而）愤怒的，愤慨的，愤愤不平的

activate /ˈæktɪveɪt/ *vt.* make a piece of equipment or process start working 使开始工作；激活

▲ **heritage** /ˈherətɪdʒ/ *n.* [sing., U] the art, buildings, traditions, beliefs, etc. that a country or society considers important to its history and culture 遗产

patron /ˈpeɪtrən/ *n.* [C]

1 sb. who supports the work of writers, artists, musicians, etc., esp. by giving them money（作家、艺术家、音乐家的）资助人，赞助者

2 (*fml.*) sb. who uses a particular restaurant, hotel, or other business（餐馆、酒店或其他生意的）主顾，顾客

▲ **ashore** /əˈʃɔː/ *ad.* on or toward the shore of a lake, river, sea, etc. 在岸上；向岸上

deport /dɪˈpɔːt/ *vt.* make sb. leave a country and return to the country they came from, esp. because they do not have a legal right to stay 把…驱逐出境；把…遣送出境

▲ **immigrant** /ˈɪmɪgrənt/ *n.* [C] sb. who comes to another country to live there permanently（外来）移民

adherence /ədˈhɪərəns/ *n.* [U] the act of behaving according to a particular rule, belief, principle, etc. 遵守；信守；信奉

tribute /ˈtrɪbjuːt/ *n.* [C, U]

1 sth. you do, say, or give to express your respect or admiration for sb.（表示敬意的）行为，颂辞，礼物

2 a payment of goods or money one ruler gives to a more powerful one 贡金；贡品；贡赋

▲ **defendant** /dɪˈfendənt/ *n.* [C] a person who has been accused of a crime and is on trial 被告

tribunal /traɪˈbjuːnl/ *n.* [C] a special law court organized to judge a particular case 特别法庭；审理委员会

denounce /dɪˈnaʊns/ *vt.*

1 criticize sb. or sth. severely in public 谴责；指责；斥责

2 tell an authority such as the police that a particular person is responsible for a crime 告发；控告；检举

agitation /ˌædʒɪˈteɪʃən/ *n.*

1 [U] a feeling of being worried or upset 焦虑不安；躁动

2 [C, U] public argument or action for political or social change 煽动；鼓动；鼓吹

trumpet /ˈtrʌmpɪt/

vt. announce sth. publicly in a way that is intended to make it seem very important 吹嘘；大肆宣扬

vi. (of a large animal, esp. an elephant) make a loud high sound（大型动物，尤指大象）吼叫

prosecute /ˈprɒsɪkjuːt/ *v.*

1 officially accuse sb. of a crime and ask a court of law to judge them 对…提起诉讼；起诉

2 try to prove as a lawyer in court that sb. is guilty of a crime（律师在法庭上）指控，公诉

▲ **compose** /kəmˈpəʊz/

v. produce a piece of music, or write a letter, poem, etc., thinking carefully about it 作（曲）；（仔细思考之后）写

vt. (*fml.*) combine together to form sth. 组成；构成

animated /ˈænɪmeɪtɪd/ *a.*

1 (of a film or program) consisting of a series of drawings that are shown quickly one after another so that they look as if they are moving （电影或节目）动画的

2 lively or active 活跃的；有活力的

▲ **realistic** /rɪəˈlɪstɪk/ *a.*

1 judging and dealing with situations in a practical way according to what is actually possible rather than what you would like to happen 现实的；实际的；实事求是的

2 (of an aim or hope) possible to achieve（目标、希望）能够实现的

realistically /rɪəˈlɪstɪkli/ *ad.* thinking about sth. in a practical way and according to what is actually possible 现实地；实际地

▲ **wax** /wæks/

vt. rub a layer of wax into a floor, surface, etc. to protect it or make it shine 给…打蜡

n. [U] a solid substance made of fat or oil and used to make candles, polish, etc. 蜡

tentative /ˈtentətɪv/ *a.*

1 not definite or certain, because you may want to change things 不确定的；试探性的；暂定的

2 not confident 不自信的；踌躇的；犹豫的

tentatively /ˈtentətɪvli/ *ad.* 试探性地；犹豫地

▲ **commentary** /ˈkɒməntəri/ *n.*

1 [C, U] sth. such as a book or article that explains or discusses a book, poem, idea, etc. 评注性著作；评论文

2 [C] a spoken description of an event, given while the event is happening, esp. on the television or radio （尤指在电视或电台上进行的）现场解说，实况报道

refined /rɪˈfaɪnd/ *a.*

1 polite, well-educated, or typical of a high social class 优雅的；有教养的

2 made pure by removing other substances 精炼的；精制的

tack /tæk/

vt. fix sth. somewhere with a small nail 把…钉住；钉上

n. [C] a small nail with a sharp point and a flat top 平头针；大头针

superintendent /ˌsuːpərɪnˈtendənt/ *n.* [C]

1 sb. who is officially in charge of a place, job, activity, etc. 负责人；主管

2 a senior police officer in the UK （英国的）警察长，警司

tickle /ˈtɪkəl/ *vt.*

1 amuse or please sb. 使开心；使高兴

2 move your fingers gently over sb.'s body in order to make them laugh 呵痒；搔痒逗笑

flutter /ˈflʌtə/

vi (of the heart, stomach, or pulse) suddenly move faster because you feel very excited or nervous （心脏、胃或脉搏因激动或紧张而）怦怦跳，颤抖，悸动

v. (of birds or insects) fly by moving their wings lightly up and down （鸟或昆虫）振翼，拍翅

dub /dʌb/ *vt.*

1 give sb. or sth. a particular name or description 把…称为…；给…起绰号

2 change the original spoken language of a film or a television program into another language 为（电影或电视节目）配音；译制

ignite /ɪgˈnaɪt/ *vt.*

1 start a fight, argument, or a particular feeling, etc. 引发，激起（争斗或辩论）；激发（某种感情）

2 (*fml.*) make sth. start to burn 使开始燃烧；点燃

impetus /ˈɪmpɪtəs/ *n.* [sing., U] a force that helps sth. to happen or develop more quickly 推动力；促进因素

manuscript /ˈmænjəskrɪpt/ *n.* [C]

1 a book or a piece of writing before it is printed （尚未付印的）原稿，底稿

2 a book or document written by hand before printing was invented 手稿；手写本

▲ **coverage** /ˈkʌvərɪdʒ/ *n.* [U]
1 the reporting of a subject or event on television or radio, or in newspapers 新闻报道
2 the extent to which a particular area or group of things is covered or affected 覆盖范围；覆盖程度

bewilder /bɪˈwɪldə/ *vt.* make sb. feel confused 使迷惑；使迷茫

bewildered /bɪˈwɪldəd/ *a.* totally confused 困惑的；不知所措的

module /ˈmɒdjuːl/ *n.* [C]
1 one of several separate parts that can be combined to form a larger object 组件；模块
2 one of the separate units of a course of study （课程的）单元，模块

▲ **skeleton** /ˈskelətən/ *n.* [C]
1 the basic parts of sth. such as a plan or organization without any details 轮廓；梗概；提要
2 the set of bones that supports a human or animal body 骨骼；骨架

▲ **crown** /kraʊn/ *vt.*
1 give sb. a title for winning a competition 授予…称号；为…封冠
2 make sb. a king or queen during a ceremony in which a symbol of power is put on their head 为…加冕；立…为君

▲ **consistency** /kənˈsɪstənsi/ *n.* [U] the quality of remaining the same in behavior, attitudes, or standards, etc. 连贯性；一致性

inconsistency /ˌɪnkənˈsɪstənsi/ *n.*
1 [C, U] a situation in which things do not match 不一致；前后矛盾
2 [U] a situation in which sb. does not always behave in the same way or sth. does not produce the same results （行为或反应）反复无常，变化不定

serial /ˈsɪəriəl/ *a.* (*only before noun*)
1 printed or broadcast in several separate parts 连载（或连播）的；以连续剧形式播出的
2 doing sth. or happening several times in the same way 连续的；一系列的

▲ **particle** /ˈpɑːtɪkəl/ *n.* [C]
1 a very small piece of matter that is part of an atom 粒子
2 a very small piece or amount of sth. 微粒；颗粒

retrieve /rɪˈtriːv/ *vt.*
1 (*fml.*) find sth. and bring it back 重新找回；收回；取回
2 find information that is stored in a computer in order to use it again 检索（存储于计算机中的信息）

Phrases and expressions

in adherence to sticking to 遵守；信守

in essence essentially; fundamentally 本质上；实质上

come to life become more real, exciting, or interesting 变得更加真实；变得更生动有趣

tack sth. up pin sth. such as a piece of paper on a wall or board, etc. 把（纸等）固定在（墙或板等上）

dub sb. / sth. as give sb. or sth. a name that describes them in some way 把…称为…；给…起…的绰号

feel strongly about sth. have a strong opinion about sth. 对…感受强烈；对…深有感触

Proper names

Gray 格雷（人名）

William Butler Yeats 威廉·巴特勒·叶芝（1865—1939，爱尔兰诗人）

Ellis Island 埃利斯岛（位于美国纽约市西南部）

Fire Department of the City of New York 纽约市消防局

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

2 Choose the best answer to each of the following questions.

1 According to the text, William Butler Yeats _____.

A never won the Nobel Prize although he was famous

B often felt proud of his ancestors' love of Irish literature

C contributed significantly to the Irish Literary Renaissance

D fought against discrimination against Irish immigrants

2 The author grew angry when he read the newspaper article about William Butler Yeats because he felt that _____.

A it put too much emphasis on the poet's Irish heritage

B it expressed some kind of prejudice against Irishness

C it denied the poet's great influence on world literature

D it questioned the poet's social and literary background

3 In his letter to the newspaper, the author _____.

A defended the Irish qualities of William Butler Yeats

B expressed his admiration and respect for musicians

C praised the literary tradition of the Book Review Section

D criticized the prejudice against Irish immigrants in the U.S.

4 In Para. 5, the author compares writing to waxing a car in order to illustrate that _____.

A writing is easy to learn for realistic artists

B writing is extremely difficult for beginners

C writing needs a great deal of physical effort

D writing requires lots of patience and practice

5 What does the author mean by "an opinion maker" in Para. 7?

A He knows how to write good stories based on his own life.

B He knows what opinion matters to the publishing company.

C He engages readers with sharp views about firemen's lives.

D He proposes ideas that attract great attention from people.

6 How did the author feel at first when he was asked to write a book about his life?

A He was sure that such a book would be very popular.

B He was disappointed that the topic seemed rather boring.

C He was not confident in his ability to write a complete book.

D He was not keen to write about his life as an ordinary fireman.

7 The author thinks the core reason for his success as a writer was that _____.

A he chose familiar subjects and wrote in a natural style

B he wrote with consistency and revised with great care

C he had patience in conceiving the general outline

D he felt strongly about the subjects of his writing

8 What is the author's purpose in writing this essay?

A To defend the importance of the work of firefighters.

B To illustrate the importance of passion in one's success.

C To show the importance of opportunities to one's career.

D To argue for the importance of protecting Irish traditions.

Critical thinking

3 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 If people haven't discovered their passion yet, how would you suggest they find it? Give two or three specific ideas.
2 What's a turning point in your life that you consider significant? Describe what happened and how it influenced your life.
3 What do you think are the most important factors for career success?
4 What goal do you want to achieve in the next five years? How do you plan to realize it?
5 Will you prefer to pursue what you are passionate about as a career or keep it as a hobby? Why?

Collocation

When we think about what career path to choose, it is important that we find and follow the ***deep-seated passion*** (B4U5B) within us. Passion is the fuel that drives us to work toward our goals against all odds. If we know what our true passion is, we are more likely to make the ***right decision*** (B4U5B).

Inspired by their life choices and passion, some people choose career paths that make our world a better place. They are animal rights advocates who strive to end ***dreadful experiments*** (B4U5A) on ***innocent animals*** (B4U5A) in research labs and to improve the welfare of farm animals living in ***constricted enclosures*** (B4U5A). They are environmental activists who help residents in small towns ***successfully sue*** (B4U5A) powerful ***global corporations*** (B4U5A) that polluted the local water and soil. They are members of ***committed groups*** (B4U5A) who help raise ***public awareness*** (B4U5A) of the serious problems facing the world, people who ***grow indignant*** (B4U5B) upon seeing things unjust and stand up to make things right, individuals who become ***opinion makers*** (B4U5B) that exert positive influence on those around them ... These ordinary people are our role models. They all have a passion for what they do. As American businessman David Sarnoff once said, "Nobody can be successful unless he first loves his work." If we are passionate about our choice, we will be determined about our actions, and then success is just a ***natural consequence*** (B4U5B).

4 The following is an excerpt from an article about Henry Spira, a famous animal rights activist. Complete the passage by choosing appropriate words provided in the box. Change the form where necessary.

committed deep-seated dreadful enclosure global
grow innocent natural opinion public right sue

Henry Spira was one of the most effective activists of the modern animal rights movement. He led the first successful campaign against animal testing, which caused a famous American museum to stop its 1) _____ *experiments* on cats conducted for about 20 years. He was instrumental in persuading some big 2) _____ *corporations* to end testing cosmetics on rabbits. He negotiated with major fast food companies, pressuring their meat suppliers to treat farm animals raised in *constricted* 3) _____ in adherence to humane standards.

Henry's success can be attributed to two factors, passion and action. He had a(n) 4) _____ *passion* for protecting the powerless and the vulnerable. He knew that cruel treatment of animals was morally wrong, and he wanted to do

something about it. He quit his job as a high school teacher and devoted himself full time to the animal rights movement. He followed the passion in his heart, and his later victories proved that he made the 5) _____ ***decision***.

Only when Henry reached his forties did he become interested in animal liberation. He read an article on animal rights written by an Australian philosopher. He was shocked to learn that a huge number of 6) _____ ***animals*** were killed in laboratory experiments every year. Later, he took a course on "Animal Liberation" at New York University. He 7) _____ ***indignant*** at the intense and widespread suffering of animals in research labs and on livestock farms.

Henry took practical and productive actions to wage effective campaigns. He conducted careful research and made concrete plans by assembling facts and creating convincing visual and print kits. He was skilled at building 8) _____ ***groups*** of activists with diverse expertise. He was a master at organizing powerful campaigns to raise 9) _____ ***awareness*** of cruel animal experiments and to ***successfully*** 10) _____ large organizations and companies. He was not only a(n) 11) _____ ***maker*** but also an architect of strategies. His tactics involved making small gradual steps rather than demanding instant dramatic changes. He negotiated with opponents and encouraged them to change by working with them whenever possible. His success came as a(n) 12) _____ ***consequence*** of his practical and effective techniques.

Stories of China

Passion and *dedication* have propelled China's space science to new heights

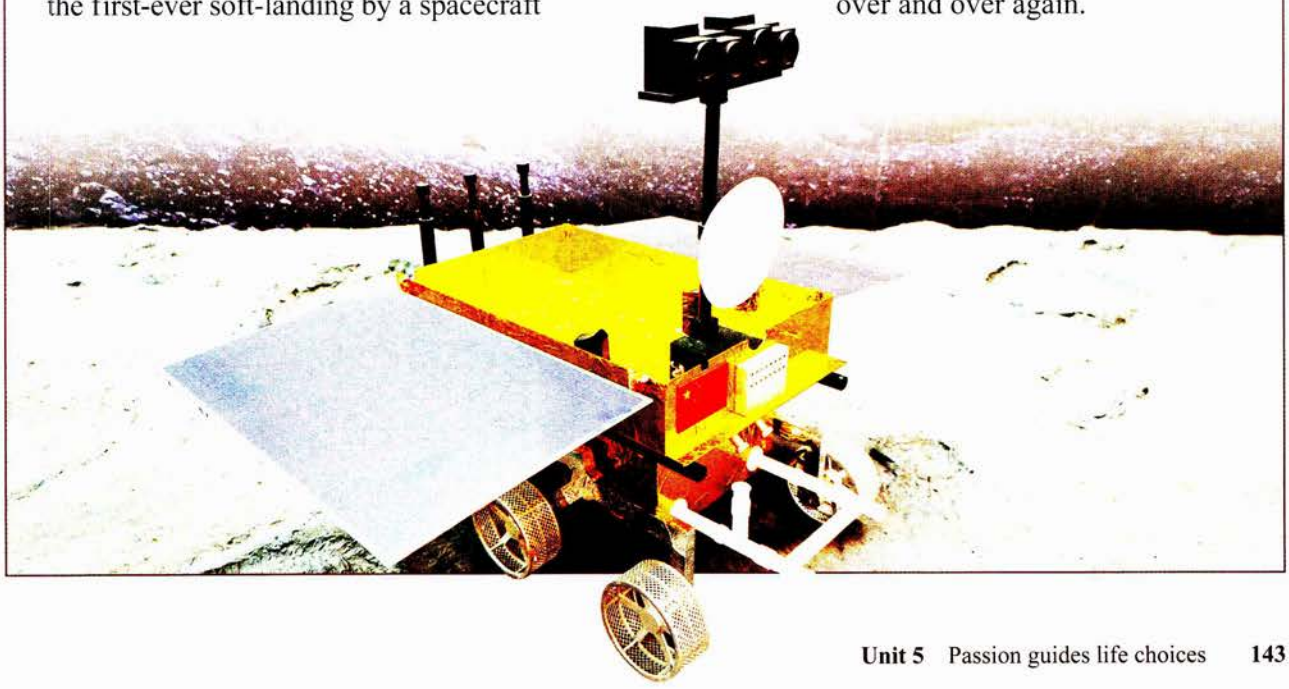
In aerospace engineer Wen Bo's cell phone, there are four photos of herself in the same pose and against the same backdrop (背景), but taken at four different junctures marking milestones in China's lunar probing program.

The first photo was taken in 2007, the year she started working at the China Academy of Space Technology (中国空间技术研究院) and also the year China launched *Chang'e-1*, its first lunar probe. The other three photos were respectively taken right after the launch of the country's second lunar probe in 2010, the third one in 2013, and the fourth one in 2018. "More than 10 years have flown by in the blink of an eye," she remarked while flipping through the photos.

China's fourth lunar probe, *Chang'e-4*, made the first-ever soft-landing by a spacecraft on the far side of the moon on January 3, 2019. While watching the lander (着陆器) touch down on the moon, many space scientists who had participated in the mission could not hold back their tears.

Zhang He, Executive Director of the *Chang'e-4* probe project, said, "I'm very proud. We have done things that have never been done, and have overcome many difficulties."

Usually, it takes three to four years to develop a lunar probe. Take *Chang'e-4*, for example. Models were designed first and then parts developed, manufactured, assembled, and tested. The lander consists of more than 200 devices and the rover (巡视器) of nearly 100, which were tested and revised over and over again.



The most distinctive feature of a spacecraft is that once launched, it is virtually irreparable (不能修复的), unlike a car that can be recalled if found to be defective or a plane that can be periodically maintained. Any negligence can throw years of hard work down the drain; thus aerospace engineers attach great importance to quality.

Sometimes work had to be done in very rough conditions. Some tests were conducted in northeast China where winter is very cold, and some in the northwest in the desolate Gobi desert. However, the scientists on the project had no complaints. They were always passionate about their work and totally devoted to it.

There is no doubt that Zhang and her colleagues have missed some important moments in their family life. Cheng Ming, an aerospace engineer, missed his son's birth because he was busy preparing for the launch of *Chang'e-3*. Nonetheless, his passion has never diminished. He proudly said to his son, "Your dad helped send a probe to the moon!"

It is this very sense of dedication and passion that has motivated Chinese aerospace engineers to make every effort to propel China's space science.

Exercises

Translation

Translate the following paragraph into English.

中国载人航天工程（manned space program）于1992年开始实施，迄今已取得了巨大成就。2003年，"神舟五号"载人飞船（manned spacecraft）成功发射，使中国成为世界上继俄罗斯和美国之后第三个有能力独自将人送上太空的国家。2005年至今，中国又完成了多次神舟飞船载人发射。此外，通过研发空间实验室和无人货运飞船（unmanned cargo spacecraft），不断推动空间站建设，中国具备了长期开展在轨科学实验和综合开发利用太空资源的能力。

Unit project

Talking about a person who has made a difference in your community

Text A of this unit tells the story of Henry Spira, who devoted his life to the cause of animal rights protection and helped to reduce the suffering of animals. In our daily life, we can find many people similar to Henry Spira, people who lead a meaningful life because they have made a difference in our society or our community.

In this unit project, you will talk about a person who has changed a community you belong to in a positive way. The community can be big or small, physical or virtual, for example, a school, a neighborhood, a city, or an online social group.

Step 1 **Choose a person you would like to talk about, and gather some information about that person.**

Step 2 **Form small groups of four or five and take turns to introduce the person you have chosen. You should include:**

- What does the person work on?
- What has he or she done?
- In what way has he or she made a difference in your community?

Step 3 **Vote in your group and select the person who has made the greatest difference in the community.**

Step 4 **Choose a member to give a presentation about that person in class.**

Unit

6 Energy and food crises

If you drain the pond to catch all the fish, you will certainly gain a lot today, but there will be no fish for the next year.

— *Master Lü's Spring and Autumn Annals*

竭泽而渔，岂不获得，而明年无鱼。

——《吕氏春秋》

Preview

Energy and food are of fundamental importance to economic development and people's lives. We depend on energy to power machines and the Internet, and we rely on food to survive and maintain health. However, there have been constant shortages of energy and food in the world. The future well-being of humanity depends upon reaching practical and cost-effective solutions to both energy and food issues. To contribute to this mission, China has been making ever greater efforts to conserve energy, improve energy efficiency, and develop renewable energy sources. Meanwhile, it is constantly pursuing advanced food production technologies and building its capacity to grow and store food. How should we continue our energy journey to realize green development and **achieve carbon neutrality** by 2060? What further food projects can be undertaken to **ensure the abundance of our food supply**? As individual citizens, what can we do to pursue a lifestyle that is green, low-carbon, circular, and sustainable?

Section A

Pre-reading activities

1 Questionnaire: How energy-conscious are you?

With constant warnings about climate change, many people are becoming aware that they should have a green lifestyle. What about you? Have you adopted an eco-friendly lifestyle, or are you just paying lip service to the idea? Complete the following questionnaire and find out how energy-conscious you are.

	Always	Sometimes	Never
1 Do you switch off the lights when you're the last one to leave a room?			
2 Do you use natural light instead of electric lights whenever possible?			
3 Do you use or encourage others to use energy-efficient light bulbs instead of the traditional ones?			
4 Do you try to use public transportation or car-pool with others when going to school or work?			
5 Do you encourage your parents or others to avoid driving a car when they can find convenient public transportation to their destinations?			
6 Do you try not to overheat your room in winter and overcool it in summer?			
7 Do you use the washing machine to run full loads of laundry instead of only small ones at a time?			
8 Do you use cold water to wash your clothes as often as you can and hang dry them?			

Add up your score:

- 2 points for each "Always" answer;
- 1 point for each "Sometimes" answer;
- 0 point for each "Never" answer.

What is your total score, and what does it indicate? Listen to the teacher and see how energy-conscious you are.

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 Why is it important for us to conserve energy in daily life?

2 Besides the energy-saving tips listed in the above questionnaire, what else do you think we can do to help conserve energy in our daily life?

Text A

The coming energy crisis

1 More than two hundred years ago, the world experienced an energy revolution that launched the Industrial Age. Ever since then, with the rapid increase in population density, the industrialized world's thirst for energy has more than **tripled**. **Petroleum** and natural gas are exploited as **versatile** and high-quality energy products. **Uranium** is also tapped to fuel nuclear reactors and provide atomic energy.

2 Cheap energy is the lifeblood of human society. But there is a dark side to the near **monopoly** of non-renewable fossil fuels like coal, oil, and natural gas, along with the controversial uranium, to supply our growing energy demand. The availability of these fuels is physically limited, and their use threatens our health and environment. Multiple international **treaties** have been proposed to limit the use of fossil fuels for this very reason. Fears of global warming aside, burning fossil fuels releases chemicals and **particulates** that can cause breathing problems, cancer as well as brain and **nerve** damage. Nuclear energy, once hailed as "too cheap to meter", hasn't been highly economically successful when all costs are factored in. Furthermore, public opinion **polls** show nuclear energy is too closely associated with disasters like the Chernobyl reactor meltdown and the Fukushima explosion, and with the danger that rebel **insurgents** could do damage with the toxic waste. Inexpensive and seemingly abundant non-renewable energy from dead plants and **extinct** animals fueled the 20th-century economy, but geologists, climatologists, environmentalists, and many others are warning that the honeymoon may soon be over.

3 At some indefinite time in the near future, the last drop of oil, **lump** of coal, or **wisp** of natural gas will be collected from the earth. The **eventual** depletion of fossil fuels that **hitherto** proved so reliable has left us with no choice but to prepare for a new age of energy **synthesis**. Most certainly, human demand for energy will not decrease or **plateau** but surge as the world population grows to nine billion before 2040. It is no surprise that world energy consumption is projected to show a **linear** increase of 50 percent in the future.

4 How will we meet the skyrocketing energy demand of the future? Until we perfect the technology of cold **fusion**, we'll have to focus on the development and increased production

of energy from renewable energy sources – sun, wind, water, and so on. While renewable energy sources are **promising**, an international **confederation** of scientists and engineers is working **feverishly** to overcome the various obstacles associated with these "new energy" technologies. The major challenge is to develop efficient and economically workable versions of these technologies.

5 Take solar energy, for example. It is a good option because there is an unlimited supply of **glittering** sunlight. Making it work on a large scale, however, is much easier said than done. It would be cost-**prohibitive** to take the **intricate gadgets** of solar energy from the fringe of "green" society to the mainstream for major world consumption. The solar **apparatus** itself is ready for many new business and consumer applications, but it is way too expensive to replace the old **combustion** machinery of gears and motors with new electronic technology of semiconductors and **transistors** on a global or even a national scale.

6 Wind power, which has been used effectively in some places for generations, is also rapidly growing in the energy market. The **principle** behind it is that wind converts **rotary** force into electricity by turning the **blades** of the turbine **clockwise** or counterclockwise around an **axis**. Unfortunately, wind power is very unreliable and its strength depends on local weather patterns, temperature, time of year, and location. In addition to this unreliability, wind power equipment is very expensive compared with other energy sources and won't become a **viable** alternative until we can **slash** the costs significantly. Also, a wind farm requires enormous land clearing to produce significant amounts of energy.

7 Hydroelectric power is another source of clean and renewable energy. It can be harnessed by controlling the natural **outflow** of water with different methods. The most popular is through dams, which, unfortunately, can have negative environmental impacts if not designed with careful forethought. Most of the hydroelectric dams in the world are historically recent, but all reservoirs need to be maintained on a regular basis. Otherwise, they can eventually fill up with mud and have to be cleared up through very expensive **excavation** to become useful again.

8 Biomass energy derived from plant and animal matter is still another renewable source being considered as a **standby** replacement for fossil fuels. Organic waste in the form of dead trees, leaves, animal **corpses** and food processing waste exists in abundance and can be used to produce energy. However, there is no way to **ventilate** the direct burning of biomass as fuel without **diffusing** carbon **dioxide** and other greenhouse gases into the atmosphere. These gases can pose a risk to the ozone **layer**, increasing the overall

exposure of human beings to harmful UV rays from the sun. Besides, it takes time and money to collect biomass and transport it in its raw form to a central point for processing into fuel, and the automation of such a process is too difficult. So, for the time being, biomass has too many costly drawbacks to be a workable alternative to fossil fuels.

9 Although renewable energies are not yet economically competitive with fossil fuels, their prices become more attractive when compared with the health and environmental costs associated with burning coal and oil. Perhaps the best solution to our growing energy challenges comes in a **bulletin** from the Union of Concerned Scientists (UCS): "Our society's future success cannot **hinge** on one single solution. The answer instead must come from a family of diverse energy technologies that share a unified purpose – they do not deplete our natural resources or destroy our environment." Despite the difficulties, it is important to remember that an energy crisis is approaching at a supersonic speed and will soon be upon us. In order to **inaugurate** a new era of energy, we must act quickly and work toward international collaboration to find the most effective solutions to our energy problem.

(*1,017 words*)

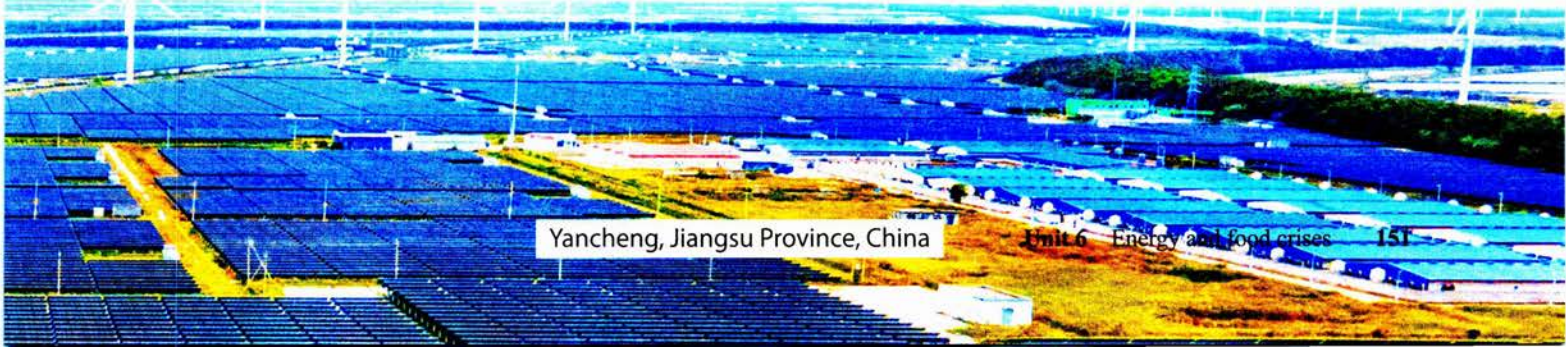
Culture notes

Industrial Age: a period of time in history that is characterized by industrialization. It began around 1760 in Great Britain, and is generally believed to have lasted for about two and a half centuries till the late 20th century, when the Information Age began. During the Industrial Age, new sources of energy such as steam, coal, and oil replaced wood and other solid biofuels and became popularly used for production and life.

Chernobyl reactor meltdown: also called the Chernobyl disaster. It is a catastrophic nuclear accident that occurred on April 26, 1986, at the Chernobyl Nuclear Power Plant in the Soviet Union. So far, it has been widely considered as the worst nuclear power plant accident in history.

Fukushima explosion: also called the Fukushima Daiichi nuclear disaster. It happened in Japan after the magnitude 9.0 Tohoku earthquake and subsequent tsunamis on March 11, 2011. The explosion caused a series of equipment failures, nuclear meltdowns, and releases of radioactive materials at the Fukushima Daiichi Nuclear Power Plant.

Union of Concerned Scientists (UCS): a non-profit science advocacy organization based in the U.S. It was founded in 1969 by scientists and students of the Massachusetts Institute of Technology located in Cambridge, Massachusetts.



Yancheng, Jiangsu Province, China

New words

▲ **triple** /ˈtrɪpəl/
v. increase by three times as much, or make sth. do this（使）成为三倍，增加两倍
a. involving three things of the same kind 有三个同类事物的；三重的

▲ **petroleum** /pəˈtrəʊliəm/ *n.* [U] 石油

versatile /ˈvɜːsətaɪl/ *a.*
1 having many different uses 有多种用途的；多功能的；万用的
2 (of a person) having many different skills 多才多艺的

uranium /jʊˈreɪniəm/ *n.* [U] a heavy white metal that is radioactive and is used to produce nuclear power and nuclear weapons. It is a chemical element: symbol U. 铀（一种放射性化学元素，符号为 U）

monopoly /məˈnɒpəli/ *n.*
1 [C, U] complete control over sth. by one organization or person（公司或个人的）垄断
2 [C] a company that has complete control of the product or service it provides because it is the only company that provides it 垄断公司

▲ **treaty** /ˈtriːti/ *n.* [C] a formal written agreement between two or more countries or governments（国家或政府间的）条约

particulates /pəˈtɪkjələts/ *n.* [pl.] extremely small particles of a substance or substances, esp. those that cause air pollution（尤指造成空气污染的）颗粒，微粒

▲ **nerve** /nɜːv/ *n.*
1 [C] a group of long, thin fibers that carry information or instructions between the brain and other parts of the body 神经
2 (**~s**) [pl.] a worried feeling that makes you afraid that you will not be able to do sth. well 精神紧张；焦虑不安；神经质

▲ **poll** /pəʊl/ *n.* [C] the process of finding out what people think about sth. by asking many people the same question, or the record of the result 民意调查；民意测验；民意调查的结果

insurgent /ɪnˈsɜːdʒənt/ *n.* [C, usu. pl.] (*fml.*) one of a group of people fighting against the government of their own country, or against authority 起义者；暴动者；叛乱者

extinct /ɪkˈstɪŋkt/ *a.* (of a type of animal, plant, language, etc.) not existing any more（动、植物或语言等）灭绝的，绝种的，消失的

▲ **lump** /lʌmp/ *n.* [C]
1 a small piece of sth. solid, without a particular shape（不定形的）块
2 a small hard swollen area that sticks out from sb.'s skin or grows in their body, usu. because of an illness（皮肤上或体内的）肿块

wisp /wɪsp/ *n.* [C] sth. that has a long, thin, delicate shape, e.g. a cloud, smoke, or hair（云、烟或头发等的）一缕，一小束

▲ **eventual** /ɪˈventʃuəl/ *a.* (*only before noun*) happening at the end of a long period of time or after a lot of other things have happened 最终的；最后的

hitherto /ˌhɪðəˈtuː/ *ad.* (*fml.*) until the present time 到目前为止；迄今

synthesis /ˈsɪnθɪsɪs/ *n.* (*pl.* **syntheses**)
1 [C, U] a combination of different things, or the process of combining things 综合物；综合体；综合
2 [U] the act of making a chemical or biological substance（化学或生物学物质的）合成

plateau /ˈplætəʊ/
vi. stop increasing or improving after a period of development（在一段时间的发展之后）趋于平稳，进入停滞期
n. [C] 1 a large flat area of land that is higher than the land around it 高原

2 a period of time when sth. stops increasing or improving（经过一段时间的发展之后的）稳定时期，停滞时期

▲ **linear** /ˈlɪniə/ *a.*
1 consisting of lines, or in the form of a straight line 线的；直线的
2 involving a series of connected events, ideas, etc., that move or progress from one stage to the next 涉及一连串直接相关的事物的；线性的

fusion /ˈfjuːʒən/ *n.*
1 [U] the process in which atoms combine to form nuclear energy 核聚变
2 [C, U] a process in which different styles, ideas, designs, etc. combine to form sth. new（风格、思想、设计等的）融合，结合

▲ **promising** /ˈprɒməsɪŋ/ *a.* showing signs of being successful or good in the future 大有希望的；很有前途的

confederation /kənˌfedəˈreɪʃən/ *n.* [C] a group of people or organizations that are united 同盟；联盟

▲ **feverish** /ˈfiːvərɪʃ/ *a.*
1 very excited or worried about sth. 狂热的；十分焦虑的
2 suffering from a fever 发烧的；发热的

feverishly /ˈfiːvərɪʃli/ *ad.* in a very excited or worried way 狂热地；十分焦虑地

glitter /ˈglɪtə/
vi. shine with a lot of small quick flashes of light 闪烁；闪耀
n. [U] brightness consisting of many flashing points of light 闪烁；闪耀

glittering /ˈglɪtərɪŋ/ *a.*
1 bright and shining with a lot of quick flashes of light 闪闪发光的
2 very successful 极为成功的；辉煌的

▲ **prohibitive** /prəˈhɪbətɪv/ *a.*
1 (of the cost of sth.) so high that many people cannot afford it（价格）高得负担不起的，贵得使人望而却步的
2 limiting sth. or preventing sth. from being done 禁止性的；起阻止作用的

intricate /ˈɪntrɪkət/ *a.*
1 very detailed in design or structure 复杂精细的；盘根错节的
2 very complicated and difficult to understand or learn 复杂难解的；难理解的；难学会的

▲ **gadget** /ˈgædʒɪt/ *n.* [C] a small, useful, and cleverly-designed machine or tool 设计精巧的小机械（或工具）

▲ **apparatus** /ˌæpəˈreɪtəs/ *n.* [C, U] the machines, tools, and equipment needed for doing sth., esp. sth. technical or scientific 器械；仪器；设备

combustion /kəmˈbʌstʃən/ *n.* [U] (*fml.*) the process of burning 燃烧（过程）

transistor /trænˈzɪstə/ *n.* [C] an object that controls the flow of electricity inside a piece of electronic equipment such as a radio or television 晶体管

▲ **principle** /ˈprɪnsəpəl/ *n.*
1 [C] the basic idea that a plan or system is based on 原则；原理；基本的观念
2 [C, U] a moral rule or belief about what is right and wrong, which influences how you behave 道德原则；行为准则

rotate /rəʊˈteɪt/ *v.*
1 turn with a circular movement around a central point, or make sth. do this（使）旋转；（使）转动
2 (of people or things) replace one another in a fixed order（使）轮流；（使）轮换

rotary /ˈrəʊtəri/
a. turning around a fixed point 旋转的；转动的；旋转式的
n. [C] (*AmE* **roundabout**) a raised circular area where three or more roads join together and which cars must drive around 环形交通枢纽；环岛

▲ **blade** /bleɪd/ *n.* [C]
1 桨叶；螺旋桨叶；叶片状物
2 刀刃；刀锋；刀片

▲ **clockwise** /ˈklɒk-waɪz/ *ad.* moving in a circle in the same direction as the hands on a clock 顺时针方向地

▲ **axis** /ˈæksɪs/ *n.* [C] (*pl.* **axes**) the imaginary line around which a large round object, such as the earth, turns 轴；轴线

viable /ˈvaɪəbəl/ *a.* able to be done, or worth doing 切实可行的；值得做的

slash /slæʃ/
vt. reduce sth. by a large amount 大幅度削减
n. [C] a line (/) that separates numbers, letters, or words in writing 斜线（符号）

outflow /aʊtfləʊ/ *n.* [C]
1 the flow of water, air, etc. from sth.（水、空气等由某物中的）流出，泄漏
2 a movement of large amounts of money or large numbers of people from one place to another（大量金钱或人员的）外流

excavation /ˌekskəˈveɪʃən/ *n.*
1 [U] the process of making a hole in the ground by digging up soil, etc. 挖掘；开凿
2 [C, U] the process of digging in the ground to find things from the past（考古性的）发掘，挖掘

standby /ˈstændbaɪ/
a. kept in reserve for use when needed 备用的
n. [C] sb. or sth. that is always available to be used if it is needed in a particular situation 备用的人（或物）

corpse /kɔːps/ *n.* [C] a dead body, esp. of a human being（尤指人的）尸体

ventilate /ˈventəleɪt/ *vt.*
1 allow fresh air to enter a room or building 使通风；使空气流通
2 (*fml.*) express opinions or feelings about sth. 发表（意见或看法）；表达（感情）

diffuse /dɪˈfjuːz/ *v.*
1 make heat, light, liquid, etc. spread through sth., or spread like this 扩散；渗透；弥漫
2 spread sth. such as information, ideas, or power among a large group of people 传播；散播

▲ **dioxide** /daɪˈɒksaɪd/ *n.* [C, U] a chemical compound that contains two atoms of oxygen and one atom of another chemical element 二氧化物

▲ **layer** /ˈleɪə/ *n.* [C]
1 an amount or piece of a material or substance that covers a surface or that is between two other things 表层；层
2 a level or rank within an organization or system（组织或体系中的）层，级别，阶层

▲ **bulletin** /ˈbʊlətɪn/ *n.* [C]
1 a magazine or newspaper that a club or organization produces regularly to give information to its members（俱乐部或机构的）简报，会刊
2 an official statement about sth. important 公告；公报；告示

hinge /hɪndʒ/
v. (*usu. passive*) attach sth. using a hinge 给…装铰链
n. [C] an object, usu. made of metal, that fastens a door to a wall, or a lid to a container, and allows it to open and shut（门或箱子上的）铰链，合页

inaugurate /ɪˈnɔːgjəreɪt/ *vt.*
1 (*fml.*) start or introduce sth. new and important 开创；创始；引进
2 celebrate the fact that sb. is starting an important new job with an official ceremony 为…举行就职典礼；使正式就任

Phrases and expressions

factor sth. in include a particular amount or factor when you calculate sth. 把…计入

on a … scale in a … size; on a … level 以…规模；在…范围内

convert sth. into / to sth. change sth. into sth. 把…转换成

on a regular / daily / weekly, etc. basis regularly; every day, week, etc. 经常 / 每天 / 每周等

fill up (make sth.) become full （使）填满；（使）注满；（使）充满

clear up

1 make a place tidy by removing things you no longer want 清理；收拾
2 explain or solve sth. or make it easier to understand 解释；解决；澄清

derive from / be derived from develop from or come from 从…中取得；源自；源于

hinge on / upon sth. depend completely on sth. 依…而定；取决于…

Proper names

Chernobyl 切尔诺贝利（乌克兰北部城市）

Fukushima 福岛（日本东北部城市）

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

1 Answer the following questions.

1 What energy sources did the world depend on for industrial development in the past?
2 According to the text, what are the problems with fossil fuels?
3 What does "the honeymoon may soon be over" in Para. 2 mean?
4 According to Para. 3, what will happen with the world population growing to nine billion before 2040?
5 What point does the author want to illustrate by informing the reader about the advantages and disadvantages of different renewable energy sources?
6 What are the advantages and disadvantages of biomass energy?
7 According to the author, what should be the best solution to the world's energy problem?
8 What is the purpose of the text?

Critical thinking

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 Do you agree with the author that the world may experience an energy crisis in the near future? Why or why not?
2 What problems would be caused if there were an energy crisis?
3 World oil prices keep changing all the time. What do you think are the main factors that cause the fluctuations in oil prices?
4 Why is it important for us to develop and use more and more renewable energy?
5 What factors do you think we should consider while structuring and setting up energy projects in a particular area?

Language focus

Words in use

3 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

diffuse extinct gadget
inaugurate intricate linear slash
synthesis ventilate viable

1 These shelves are perfect for storing your cell phone, alarm clock, or other small _____ that tend to gather in the bedroom.
2 The world is now facing a new industrial and technological revolution, and the only _____ choice for us is to embrace it, not reject it.
3 Saving endangered species from becoming _____ and protecting their habitats is crucial for the balance of the ecosystem.
4 The _____ design of the vase looks simple and unique, which makes it stand out from other vases with traditional round shapes.
5 With automation, we have greatly improved productivity and _____ the time to accomplish the work.
6 The theater is equipped with a(n) _____ system of stage machinery to meet the demands of even the most complex show.
7 China's reform and opening up beginning in the late 1970s _____ an era of sustained economic growth and rising living standards in the country.
8 People now understand the need to _____ their homes to improve airflow and get rid of viruses that may cause disease.
9 Using a(n) _____ of music, relaxation, and imagery, her innovative therapy has brought significant emotional and physical healing to many.
10 With this window covering, you can have full control over how much light is let in, whether the goal is to _____ light into the room or to block it out.

Word building

可将以 -ent 结尾的形容词变形为名词，表示状态或性质。

confident		confidence
excellent		excellence
intelligent	>	intelligence
competent		**competence**
eminent		**eminence**

与某些动词结合构成名词，表示行为、状态、过程或行为的结果。常见的变体有 -sion、-tion、-ation 以及 -ition。当动词以 -fy 和 -ize 结尾时，构成的名词通常分别以 -fication 和 -ization 的形式结尾。

act		action
classify		classification
imagine		imagination
realize		realization
assert		**assertion**
condemn	>	**condemnation**
delegate		**delegation**
resign		**resignation**
restore		**restoration**
specify		**specification**
speculate		**speculation**

4 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

assertion　competence　condemnation
delegation　eminence　specification
speculation　resignation　restoration

1 The reporter ate her breakfast with the members of the _____ in their designated dining room, and then followed them to the meeting hall.
2 When Leslie was fully occupied with looking after the two young babies, Alan took over supervising the _____ of the old farmhouse.
3 We agree on the _____ that emotional intelligence is an important factor for success in the workplace as it influences communication and team collaboration.
4 The technical _____ of the device are in the brochures the company made for the consumers.
5 Daily contact with your academic supervisor is important if you are to develop professional _____ and skills.
6 Since its founding over 20 years ago, the company has strived to achieve _____ and distinction in the field of medical technology.
7 You should be respectful during the debate as unsuitable comments would face _____ from fellow participants.
8 They hope the sales manager's _____ would open a space for a more competent candidate.
9 Until a book tour last summer, Zane had not revealed herself publicly, prompting wild _____ about whether an author with such a peculiar name was a man or a woman.

Banked cloze

5 Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

A apparatuses	**F** lavish	**K** restoration
B construction	**G** processors	**L** slash
C glittering	**H** promising	**M** speculate
D interiors	**I** renders	**N** stores
E intricate	**J** resolve	**O** ventilation

It's true that greenhouses consume resources, but making the correct choices when you design, build, and run your greenhouses can make your growing operation more sustainable.

Typical greenhouse operation consumes 1) _____ amounts of plastic, from the plastic film covering on many greenhouses, to the plastic packaging of soil and fertilizers. Choosing recyclable materials, both in the 2) _____ of greenhouses and in their everyday operation, is one effective way to run sustainable greenhouses.

By their very nature, greenhouses are good at collecting energy from the 3) _____ sun and using it to warm or heat their 4) _____ to the appropriate temperature. Passive solar design, which doesn't use mechanical or electrical 5) _____ but simply a building's own structure to capture and store solar energy, is usually most people's choice for their greenhouses. Meanwhile, allowing for adequate control of 6) _____ when you design greenhouses minimizes the need for electric fans and other energy-consuming cooling solutions. A good greenhouse design also considers the installation of thermal-banking system, a process that uses the sun to heat water and then 7) _____ the water underground, where it can be used to heat the greenhouse in cooler weather. Though the thermal-banking project sounds a little 8) _____ due to the extra design and work it requires, it helps make the operation of the greenhouse more sustainable.

The operation of a greenhouse consumes energy and uses a lot of water as well. To 9) _____ this problem, you can replace traditional lighting with more energy-efficient LED lighting, and build a rainwater collection and storage system. These methods can significantly 10) _____ energy and water costs though some more investments are needed at first.

Expressions in use

6 Fill in the blanks with the expressions given below. Change the form where necessary. Each expression can be used only once.

be derived from clear up
factor in fill up hinge on
on a … basis on a … scale

1 If you say yes to every request and invitation, your schedule would quickly _____ with other people's agendas.
2 I suppose many jobs we are doing now will disappear if AI is developed and applied _____ large _____.
3 I would like to purchase my own home. I _____ rates, mortgage, and house insurance and found that the monthly payment is about the same as the rent I currently pay.
4 As one of the preferred floor coverings, carpets often require regular care in the form of vacuuming and cleaning _____ weekly _____.
5 The storm caused widespread damage throughout our city, and it's going to take weeks for us to fully _____ the debris.
6 The data used for this analysis _____ various sources and assumed to be correct and reliable, but it has not been independently verified.
7 The future of our research program does not _____ the success or failure of any single test, but the results of many tests over several years.

Structure analysis and writing

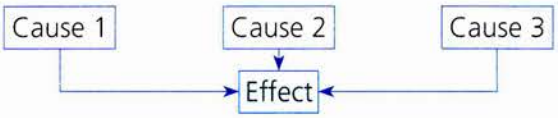
Structure analysis

Writing a cause-and-effect essay

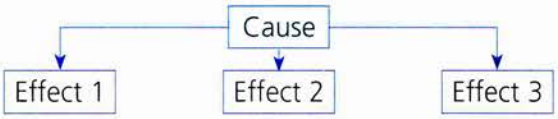
You have learned how to write a cause-and-effect essay in B2U6, B3U3, and B3U6. Cause-and-effect essays explore why things happen (causes) and what happens as a result (effects). They focus either on the causes or on the effects.

The following charts can help you understand the logical patterns of cause-and-effect essays.

1 Logical pattern of a cause-and-effect essay focusing on causes:



2 Logical pattern of a cause-and-effect essay focusing on effects:



Text A of this unit is a cause-and-effect essay focusing on causes. By presenting the problems associated not only with traditional fossil fuels and nuclear power, but also with the various kinds of renewable energy alternatives, the author intends to convince the reader why the world could face a serious energy crisis in the near future and how effective solutions can be found to deal with this problem.

Structured writing

Read the sample essay and see how a cause-and-effect essay is developed.

Topic
Why is reading important to us?

Introduction
Reading can benefit us in many ways.

Body
Point 1: Reading enlightens our mind.
Point 2: Reading develops our imagination.
Point 3: Reading boosts our confidence.

Conclusion
It is important that we develop the habit of reading.

"Reading is to the mind what exercise is to the body" is an in-depth perspective on the importance of reading by English essayist and poet Joseph Addison. Reading is important to us for a variety of reasons. But most important of all, reading helps enlighten our mind, develop our imagination, and boost our confidence.

Reading is one of the most effective ways to enlighten our mind. Just as our body needs daily exercise to be strong, our mind needs nourishment that comes through reading to be bright. Active reading ignites our mind and arms it with creative ideas. Though some people may argue that TV and movies have their role to play in the process, to me, these things are more like entertainment, and entertainment is an activity that involves less active thinking.

Reading develops our imagination. With reading, we can go anywhere in the world, or even go out of it! We can be a king, a queen, an adventurer, a detective ... The possibilities are endless. Non-readers rarely have the chance to experience these joys to the same extent.

Reading is also fundamental for us to boost our self-confidence. Having our mind equipped with knowledge, we will feel more self-assured while making judgments or expressing ideas. Non-readers or poor readers, according to some research, are likely to have a low opinion of themselves and their abilities. They tend to perform poorly in school because they cannot read and understand the subject material properly, and they often give up easily.

Since reading can benefit us in so many ways, it is important that we develop the habit of reading and take it as a great hobby. Why not go grab a book you like now and keep reading it until you reach the back cover?

7 Write a cause-and-effect essay of no less than 150 words on one of the following topics. One topic has an outline that you can follow.

Topic

Why isn't nuclear power the best energy option?

Introduction

Nuclear power poses environment, safety, and health concerns.

Body

Reason 1: Environment concerns

- Disposal of radioactive waste could be difficult.
- Equipment used in nuclear power plants could be harmful.
- Water could be polluted by nuclear power plants.

Reason 2: Safety concerns

- Nuclear disasters could happen.
- Nuclear waste could be improperly used.
- Nuclear power plants could become targets of terrorist attacks.

Reason 3: Health concerns

- Various health problems could be caused by exposure to radioactivity.

Conclusion

Nuclear power is not the best energy option. Better solutions to our energy problem need to be found.

More topics

- Why is sleep deprivation (睡眠不足) bad for you?
- Does using technology in the classroom help students learn better?

Section B

Reading skills

Identifying the author's purpose

Being able to identify the author's purpose is one important quality of an effective reader. As we know, every author writes for a purpose. There are generally three common types of writing purposes:

- **To inform:** to give information about a subject. Authors with this purpose wish to provide facts that will explain something so that the reader will know or know more about it.
- **To persuade:** to convince the reader to agree with the author's point of view on a subject or to encourage them to take a course of action. Authors with this purpose may give facts as well, but their primary goal is to argue for or prove a point of view.
- **To entertain:** to amuse or delight the reader in some way. Authors with this purpose often appeal to the reader's senses and imagination so as to interest them.

When you try to identify what type of writing you are dealing with, you can make use of the following two skills.

1 **Get clues from the main idea of the passage.**

The main idea of a reading passage is directly related to the author's purpose. The *title*, *thesis statement*, *topic sentences*, and *conclusion* of the passage usually serve to tell us the main idea of it. If the main idea communicates a well-established fact, then the author's purpose is to inform. In contrast, if the main idea expresses a strong opinion, then the author's purpose is to persuade. If the passage is to amuse the reader, the author's purpose is then to entertain. You can compare the two sample main ideas below:

- *Pain is a normal part of a physical process that lets us know something is wrong.* (To inform)
- *The Internet has had more of a positive than a negative effect on education.* (To persuade)

2 **Get clues from the language style of the passage.**

Sometimes authors disguise their purposes. In this case, you can focus on the language style of the passage to identify the author's purpose. An informative passage usually uses plain and straightforward language and conveys a neutral tone, whereas a persuasive passage often uses complex sentence structures and strong tone words or expressions such as *must*, *should*, *had better*, *have to*, *superb*, *horrifying*, *wonderful*, *absolutely*, *too much*, etc., to convey a serious tone or a strong emotion. If a reading passage uses a lot of informal language, simple sentence structures, figurative speeches, and dialogs, such as "*Yes, I have gained weight. I weighed only eight pounds when I was born*", and demonstrates a relaxing or amusing tone, then the author's purpose is generally to entertain.

Take Text A of this unit, for example. We can use the above two skills to help us identify the author's purpose.

1 The title of the text "The coming energy crisis" expresses an opinion rather than a fact.
2 The thesis statement "The eventual depletion of fossil fuels that hitherto proved so reliable has left us with no choice but to prepare for a new age of energy synthesis" (Para. 3) communicates an opinion as well.
3 The text contains many tone words and expressions that reveal a strong emotion or a clear attitude, such as:

- *Most certainly, human demand for energy will not decrease or plateau but surge as the world population grows to nine billion before 2040.* (Para. 3)
- *So, for the time being, biomass has too many costly drawbacks to be a workable alternative to fossil fuels.* (Para. 8)
- *Despite the difficulties, it is important to remember that an energy crisis is approaching at a supersonic speed and will soon be upon us.* (Para. 9)

According to the above clues, we can conclude that the purpose of Text A is to persuade.

I When you read Text B, scan it for clues that help you identify the author's purpose. Use the questions below to guide your scanning, and then decide: Is the text meant to be informative or persuasive?

1 What does the title tell us about the content of the text?
2 Are there any different points of view in Paras. 2-3?
3 A rhetorical question is a question asked merely for effect with no answer expected, or with an answer immediately provided by the questioner. Are there any rhetorical questions in the text? What are they?
4 Is there any quote in the text? Where is it from? What is its purpose?
5 How would you describe the language of the text? Is it formal, informal, evaluative, or emotional? Why do you think so?

Text B

A worldwide

1 Historically, only local governments worried about a widespread food crisis, but today, a sharp **spike** in food prices and the resulting food crisis can quickly become a worldwide phenomenon. In the past, droughts along the **equator** and in countries which account for a large portion of world wheat **exports** caused wheat prices to surge. Many worry the tight supply today will cause **inflationary** prices. They fear the skyrocketing grain costs which once harshly struck the world's poor and led to food **riots** will **recur**.

2 Is their fear grounded? Consultancy firms measuring the status of commodities like wheat don't think so. Stocks of wheat are at sufficiently high levels, and the **turnout** from some big producers is still expected to stay strong. So unlike before, the supply situation isn't desperate, meaning wheat prices should eventually calm down and level off.

3 However, this rosy picture provides only temporary security. The bigger picture **discloses** a reality not so optimistic. Though current prices may not be as sky-high as in the most panicked market of the past, they're still at higher levels than before and are likely to stay that way. The Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) sees the average prices of products classified as essential such as grain, vegetable oils, and **dairy** products rising for the next decade.

4 It doesn't take an **oracle** to **foretell** that the fight to feed the world will be a huge challenge facing the global economy over the next 20 years. Food production is

food crisis?

suffering from decades of **neglect** of agriculture, a period when the sector was starved of the resources and technology it needed to keep up with rising world demand. Though more and more people are intrigued by the issue and there is a growing global **consensus** about the need for reform in farming, we're really only at the beginning of a long, expensive process of repairing world agricultural practices. That means food prices will stay high over the next several years, as will the risk of dangerous price fluctuations like the current one with wheat.

5 Food isn't like **garments** or other products traded on world markets. The issue of food generates strong emotions. **Intermittent** uncertainty in food markets will **animate** people to act when they would otherwise remain calm. No country, for example, wants to run out of food or watch sky-high prices push people into poverty and malnourishment. When public emotions are running high enough, grain exporters and importers may take extreme measures to prevent a shortage, like **hoarding** and panic-driven **wholesale** purchases. In other words, the overreaction of market players will act like a **pistol** to the head, creating a crisis when none should exist.

6 Will current prices stay high and **volatile**? Probably yes. There are enormous structural problems with the agriculture industry, which has caused great imbalance between supply and demand. These problems have a **dual** nature, one on the production side, and one on the consumption side.

7 On the production side, global funding for rural infrastructure or technological research to keep yields growing has been very small, well below what is needed to keep the crisis at bay and to meet our future food demand. But in the past, whenever economists predicted massive shortages, technological advances like higher-yield strains of wheat would overcome the shortages and rescue civilizations from large-scale starvation.

8 On the consumption side, citizens of wealthier countries have grown accustomed to consuming more food than they need and eating more costly types of food like meat. This means more grain gets turned into **livestock** feed instead of food for people. Add in the new

demand for bio-fuels, and you get a recipe for disaster. As an **excerpt** from a **pamphlet** by an Australian philosopher explains: "... the problem isn't that we are producing too little food; rather we're not eating the food we grow. Nearly 100 million tons of grain per year is turned into bio-fuel that goes into gas tanks. The problem is that we – the relatively **affluent** – have created a system of **piracy** where we consume four or five times as much food as would be possible if we were to actually eat the crops we grow directly."

9 How can we **neutralize** this problem and **dodge** the future crisis? The solution lies at the intersection of money and time. Councilors, legislators, and government **agencies** of some countries have had the **foresight** to realize this fact and are giving more **subsidies** to agriculture.

10 More than ever, we need the appropriation of time and money away from non-essential development projects and toward creating a **coherent** international plan to deal with hunger. We are about to **rupture** at the **seams**, with the world population expected to reach a total of nine billion by 2037. It is **estimated** that feeding such a large population would require a 70 percent increase in global food production from what it is now. Why such a **discrepancy**? The rapidly growing population not only needs more basic foods, like grain, but also enjoys foods higher up on the food chain, like meat. They desire not only the basic essentials of life, but also more sophisticated technologies like automobiles that use bio-fuels!

11 All **signposts** point to the need for food production in the world to increase substantially. To achieve this, an enormous investment in agriculture from various sources is needed. Government agencies, non-profit organizations, agricultural scientists, private investors, and charitable donors, all must partner together to build the capacity of the whole world to answer this tremendous need for food.

12 While we may not be seeing all the symptoms of a food shortage **syndrome** yet, we must be clear-eyed in our on-going support for food production. The message is explicit: We are on a collision course. But the problem is **soluble**. Like climbing a **staircase**, we must do it carefully and **consistently** if we are to reach our goal and prevent a global food crisis.

(*985 words*)

New words

spike /spaɪk/ *n.* [C] (*infml.*) any sudden increase 骤增

equator /ɪˈkweɪtə/ *n.* (**the** ~) an imaginary line that goes round the earth and divides it into the northern and southern hemispheres 赤道

▲ export
n. /ˈekspɔːt/ 1 [C, usu. pl.] a product that is sold to another country 出口商品
2 [U] the business of selling and sending goods to other countries 出口
v. /ɪkˈspɔːt/ sell goods to another country 出口

▲ inflation /ɪnˈfleɪʃən/ *n.* [U] a continuing increase in prices, or the rate at which prices increase 物价上涨（率）；通货膨胀（率）

inflationary /ɪnˈfleɪʃənəri/ *a.* relating to or causing price increases 价格上涨的；（引起）通货膨胀的

▲ riot /ˈraɪət/
n. [C, U] a violent protest by a crowd of people 暴乱；骚乱
vi. protest violently about sth. 暴力抗议；发动骚乱；闹事

recur /rɪˈkɜː/ *vi.* happen again 再次发生；重现

turnout /ˈtɜːnaʊt/ *n.*
1 [C, U] quantity of production; output 产量；产额
2 [U] the number of people who come to an event 参加人数；出席人数；到场人数

disclose /dɪsˈkləʊz/ *vt.* give information to people, esp. information that was secret 透露，泄露（尤指秘密）

▲ dairy /ˈdeəri/
a. 奶牛的；奶制品的；乳品的
n. [C] 牛奶场；乳品场；乳品公司

oracle /ˈɒrəkəl/ *n.* [C]
1 (*often humorous*) a person or book that gives the best advice or information on sth. 哲人；能提供最佳建议（或信息）的人（或书）
2 sb. who the ancient Greeks believed could communicate with the gods, who gave advice to people or told them what would happen （古希腊的）传神谕者，神使

foretell /fɔːˈtel/ *vt.* say what will happen in the future; predict 预言；预示

▲ neglect /nɪˈglekt/ *n.* [U] failure to look after sth. or sb., or the condition of not being looked after 疏忽

▲ consensus /kənˈsensəs/ *n.* [sing, U] an opinion that everyone in a group agrees with or accepts 共同意见；一致看法；共识

▲ garment /ˈgɑːmənt/ *n.* [C] (*fml.*) a piece of clothing 服装；衣服

intermittent /ˌɪntəˈmɪtənt/ *a.* happening sometimes but not regularly or often 间歇的；断断续续的

animate /ˈænɪmeɪt/ *vt.* make sb. or sth. more lively, active, or interested 使活跃；使生气勃勃；激励

hoard /hɔːd/ *vt.* get and keep a large amount of sth. because it might be valuable or useful later 贮藏；囤积

wholesale /ˈhəʊlseɪl/ *a.*
1 (*only before noun*) affecting every part of sth. or every person 大规模的
2 relating to the business of selling large quantities of goods, esp. to people who are going to sell them in a shop 批发的；整批出售的

▲ pistol /ˈpɪstl/ *n.* [C] a small gun that you hold in one hand 手枪

volatile /ˈvɒlətaɪl/ *a.* likely to change suddenly and without warning 易变的；动荡不定的

▲ **dual** /ˈdjuːəl/ *a.* (*only before noun*) (of things) having two similar aspects, parts, or functions 双的；两重的；双重的

livestock /ˈlaɪvstɒk/ *n.* [pl., U] animals such as cows, sheep, and pigs that are kept on farms 家畜；牲畜

excerpt /ˈeksɜːpt/ *n.* [C] a short piece of writing or music that is taken from a longer piece 摘录；节选

pamphlet /ˈpæmflɪt/ *n.* [C] a very thin book with a paper cover, usu. given free to people （通常免费赠阅的）小册子

▲ **affluent** /ˈæfluənt/ *a.* having plenty of money, nice houses, expensive things, etc. 富裕的；富足的

▲ **piracy** /ˈpaɪərəsi/ *n.* [U]
1 the crime of attacking and stealing from ships at sea 海上抢劫；海盗行为
2 the crime of illegally copying and selling books, tapes, videos, computer programs, etc. 非法翻印；盗版行为

▲ **neutralize** /ˈnjuːtrəlaɪz/ *vt.*
1 prevent sth. from having any effect 使失效；抵消
2 make a substance chemically neutral 使中和

dodge /dɒdʒ/
vt. avoid doing sth. in a clever or dishonest way （聪明或狡猾地）躲避，逃避
v. avoid sb. or sth. by moving quickly, esp. so that sth. does not hit you or sb. does not see you 闪开；躲开

▲ **agency** /ˈeɪdʒənsi/ *n.* [C]
1 an organization or department, esp. within a government, that does a specific job 机构；（尤指政府内的）局，部，处
2 a business that provides a particular service for people or organizations 代办处；代理处；经销处；中介处

▲ **foresight** /ˈfɔːsaɪt/ *n.* [U] the good judgment to think and plan before an event, so that you are prepared for whatever may happen 预见；先见之明

subsidy /ˈsʌbsədi/ *n.* [C] an amount of money that the government or another organization pays to help to reduce the cost of a product or service 补贴；津贴；补助金

▲ **coherent** /kəʊˈhɪərənt/ *a.*
1 (of an argument, idea, or plan) clear and carefully considered, with each part of it connecting in a natural or reasonable way （论据、观点或计划）有条理的，连贯的，前后一致的
2 speaking in a way that is clear and easy to understand（说话等）条理清楚的，易于理解的

rupture /ˈrʌptʃə/
v. break or burst, or make sth. break or burst （使）破裂；（使）爆裂
n. [C, U] an occasion when sth. suddenly breaks apart or bursts（突然的）破裂，爆裂

seam /siːm/ *n.* [C] a line of stitches that joins two pieces of cloth 线缝；缝口

▲ **estimate** /ˈestɪmeɪt/ *vt.* try to judge the value, size, speed, cost, etc. of sth., without calculating it exactly 估计；估算

discrepancy /dɪˈskrepənsi/ *n.* [C, U] a difference between things that should be the same 差异；差额；不一致

signpost /ˈsaɪnpəʊst/ *n.* [C]
1 sth. that helps you understand how sth. is organized, where to go, or what will follow 线索；迹象；征兆
2 (*esp. BrE*) (*AmE* **sign**) a sign at the side of a road showing directions and distances 路标

syndrome /ˈsɪndrəʊm/ *n.* [C] a medical condition that has a particular set of effects on your body or mind 综合症状；综合征（常用于疾病名称）

▲ **soluble** /ˈsɒljəbəl/ *a.*

1 (*fml.*) (of a problem) able to be solved（问题）可解决的

2 (of a substance) able to dissolve in a liquid and become part of the liquid 可溶解的

▲ **staircase** /ˈsteəkeɪs/ *n.* [C] a set of stairs inside a building with its supports and the side parts that you hold on to（建筑物内的）楼梯

▲ **consistent** /kənˈsɪstənt/ *a.*

1 always behaving or happening in a similar, esp. positive way 一贯的；坚持的；始终如一的

2 in agreement with other facts or with typical or previous behavior, or having the same principles as sth. else 一致的；吻合的；符合的

consistently /kənˈsɪstəntli/ *ad.* 一贯地；一致地

Phrases and expressions

account for

1 form a particular amount or part of sth.（在数量或比例上）占，占据

2 be the reason why sth. exists or happens 是…的原因

calm down (of situations) become easier to deal with（情况）恢复平静，恢复正常

level off

1 stop rising or falling and become steady 变得平稳；保持稳定

2 stop going up or down and continue at the same height or amount 趋于平坦（或平稳）；作水平移动

classify sth. as sth. decide what group sth. belongs to 将…归在某一类

be starved of sth. be prevented from having enough of what you need 缺乏…

keep / hold sth. at bay prevent sth. serious, dangerous, or unpleasant from coming too close or from happening 使（严重、危险或令人不快的）某事物无法接近；防止某结果产生

rescue sth. / sb. from sth. save sth. or sb. from a situation of danger or harm 从…挽救 / 营救

get / be a recipe for sth. be likely to experience or cause a particular result, often a bad one 可能会遭遇或造成某事（常指坏的结果）

point to show the truth or importance of sth. 表明（真相或重要性）

on a collision course

1 likely to have serious trouble because your aims are very different from sb. else's（因双方目标差异太大而）很可能发生冲突的，有可能导致严重争端的

2 moving in a direction in which you will hit sth. 朝着可能会碰撞的方向移动的；可能撞上的

Proper names

The Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD)
经济合作与发展组织（简称经合组织）

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

2 Choose the best answer to each of the following questions.

1 The text mentioned all of the following factors that contribute to high food prices except _____.
- A the decrease of food supply
- B the production of bio-fuels
- C the rising costs of fertilizers
- D the growth of world population

2 Why is food different from other commodities?
- A It is more likely to cause an economic recession.
- B It needs to be stored safely before it is consumed.
- C It is produced in an environment that is entirely natural.
- D It can cause people to overreact when the market is unstable.

3 Why is the growth of grain yields currently slow according to the text?
- A Global funding for research on agricultural technology has been insufficient.
- B The climate is changing in a way that is unfavorable to the increase of grain harvests.
- C Scientists have mainly focused on researching the development of other types of food.
- D Farmers have become less interested in growing traditional crops like wheat and rice.

4 What does "a system of piracy" in Para. 8 most probably refer to?
- A A series of unconventional ways in which food is produced.
- B A series of improper ways in which rich people consume food.
- C A series of factors that cause the increase of food prices.
- D A series of challenges that human beings face about food.

5 In suggesting the need for more money to be invested in agriculture to deal with the future food crisis, the author implies that _____.
- A some countries have never thought of making the investment
- B government agencies should be the main source of the investment capital
- C different countries should take different responsibilities for the investment
- D some investments have so far been improperly directed toward non-essential projects

6 The huge gap between population growth and food demand increase is caused by all of the following except _____.
- A the growing need for basic foods
- B the increasing need for bio-fuels
- C the potential need for specialty foods
- D the rising need for more nutritious foods

7 According to the text, to meet the tremendous need for food in the future, _____.
- A it is important for the affluent countries to increase their food exports
- B it is crucial to build the food production capacity of the whole world
- C it is necessary for business firms to turn less grain into feed for livestock
- D it is essential to prevent traders from manipulating the food market

8 Which word can best describe the author's tone toward the food price issue?
- A Concerned.
- B Cautious.
- C Critical.
- D Complaining.

Critical thinking

3 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 Besides the factors mentioned in the text, what other factors do you think can cause food prices to rise?

2 What problems would be caused if food prices were too high?

3 What does "food security" mean? To ensure food security in our country, what measures do you think are important and should be taken?

4 Can you think of anyone who has made great contributions to the increase of food production in China? Tell their story briefly.

5 How should we save food in our daily life?

Collocation

Energy and food crises are two issues that our world has to strive to tackle today. The energy issue is tough and urgent. We have long relied on fossil fuels for the majority of our ***energy consumption*** (B4U6A) – a situation that may not significantly change in the near future. On top of this, ***energy demand*** (B4U6A) is expected to show a ***linear increase*** (B4U6A) of almost 50 percent in the future. Undoubtedly, this will cause an ***energy crisis*** (B4U6A) as well as the fear that our ***seemingly abundant*** (B4U6A) energy resources are starting to run out. Potential ***massive shortages*** (B4U6B) of energy could ***harshly strike*** (B4U6B) the global economy and quality of life. Fortunately, it is still possible to find ***viable alternatives*** (B4U6A). Scientists have now turned their attention to natural sources of ***renewable energy*** (B4U6A): the sun, the sea, the wind, and hot springs. These renewable energies have much lower ***environmental impacts*** (B4U6A), but some of them have ***costly drawbacks*** (B4U6A) to be workable alternatives to ***non-renewable energies*** (B4U6A). With what is done to improve them, ultimately, the ***unlimited supply*** (B4U6A) of renewable energy should ensure that the world does not fall short of its energy needs.

Similar to the energy issue, the food issue is pressing as well. Today's ***sky-high prices*** (B4U6B) of food are imposing great hardship on the poorest consumers. Though the world is now more economically developed than in the past, there are still many hungry people worldwide because of the ***tight supply*** (B4U6B) of food. Wheat is becoming increasingly difficult to grow in some areas as the land gets drier and less fertile. The ***tremendous need*** (B4U6B) for food cannot be satisfied due to extreme weather, insect attacks, and crop diseases. The ***temporary security*** (B4U6B) of food today, therefore, doesn't secure an abundant food supply for tomorrow. To feed the world and end poverty, modern agricultural technologies will have to be continuously developed.

4 The following is an extract from Professor Simpson's lecture in his economics class about the issue of energy crisis. Complete the passage with appropriate collocations from the texts.

The future development of the world is likely to consume even more energy, with the rising 1) *e*_____ *de*_____ of every country. At the same time, the tremendous risk of climate change associated with the use of fossil fuels makes the 2) *un*_____ *su*_____ and use of such energy simply impossible. World leaders need to take action on the 3) *e*_____ *cr*_____ that is taking shape before our eyes. Oil prices are soaring. The cost of coal has doubled, leading to its 4) *sk*_____ *pr*_____ of today. Countries far apart from each other are

plagued by power cuts and there have been serious problems in several nations because of the 5) *t*_____ *su*_____ of electricity. Rich states, no longer strangers to periodic blackouts, are worried about the 6) *te*_____ *se*_____ of energy supply. In the developing world, there are still people who have no easy access to electricity.

I believe that 7) *ma*_____ *sh*_____ are underway in the energy field, whose impact we have not yet fully felt. Global demand for energy shows a 8) *li*_____ *in*_____ as the population increases and the economy develops. Research shows that the world's 9) *e*_____ *con*_____ could be significantly higher by the 2030s than it is today. Yet the fossil fuels on which the world still depends are finite and will continue to have negative 10) *en*_____ *im*_____. So far, there is no global energy institution that can create economically 11) *v*_____ *al*_____ and generate feasible solutions to the potentially enormous energy problem we see emerging. The 12) *tr*_____ *n*_____ for international collaboration on energy, therefore, has never been so urgent as today.

Stories of China

An important milestone in China's solar energy development

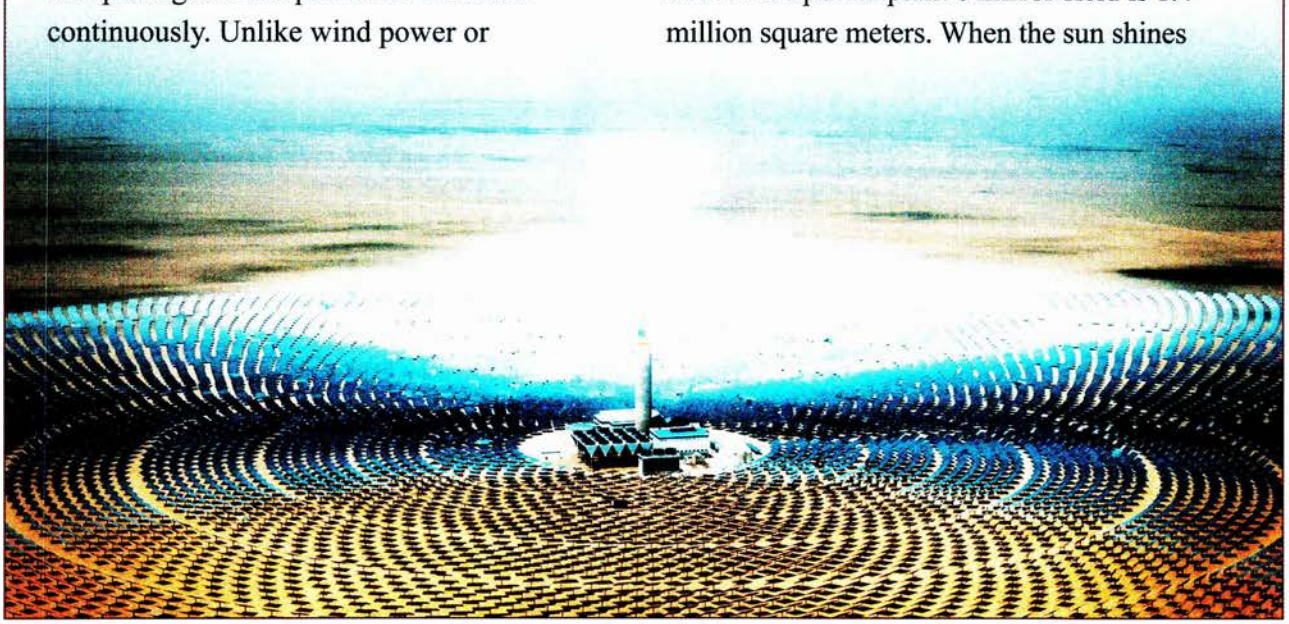
China's solar thermal power generation companies have mastered the core technology of building large-scale molten salt tower thermal power plants (熔盐塔式光热电站), and are ready to go global.

In December 2018, China's first 100-megawatt (百兆瓦) molten salt tower thermal power plant entered operation in Dunhuang, Gansu Province. The achievement marks China's emergence as one of the few countries in the world to master the technology. Being currently one of the world's largest of its kind, this power plant has a huge light-concentrating device, a great heat-absorbing tower, and a giant heat storage tank.

The plant generates power for 24 hours continuously. Unlike wind power or photovoltaic (光伏的) power generation plants, it can store solar energy, so that it can produce electricity even during cloudy days or nights. Also, molten salt tower thermal power plants are non-polluting.

A resource-saving technology company in Beijing built the plant. It chose Dunhuang because the local light conditions are good, and the vast Gobi desert is suitable for building new energy power plants. Besides, Dunhuang is an important junction on the Silk Road. Having this technology here can serve as a great example of the new achievements in sustainable energy development.

According to the company, the total reflection area of the power plant's mirror field is 1.4 million square meters. When the sun shines



down, the heliostat (日光反射装置) will reflect and concentrate the light on the top of the heat-absorbing tower, and heat the molten salt.

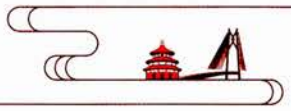
The annual power generation of the plant will reach 390 million kilowatt-hours, which can reduce carbon dioxide emissions by 350,000 metric tons per year. That is equivalent to releasing environmental benefits from 667 hectares of forest while creating economic benefits of 300 million to 400 million yuan at the same time.

Industry experts say the establishment of the plant in Dunhuang is an important milestone in the development of China's solar thermal power industry. It not only optimizes Dunhuang's new energy structure, but also offers a positive demonstration of the healthy and sustainable development of the new energy industry in Gansu, and in the whole country.

With the deepening of China's reform and opening up and the implementation of the Belt and Road Initiative, China's solar thermal technology will go global and blossom in places where developing solar power is suitable. There is no doubt that China will make a significant contribution to the development and spread of sustainable energy technologies in the world.

Exercises

Translation



Translate the following paragraph into English.

博鳌亚洲论坛（Boao Forum for Asia, or BFA）是一个总部设在中国海南省博鳌镇的国际组织。它由 29 个成员国共同发起，于 2001 年正式成立。论坛每年定期在博鳌举行会议，目前已成为亚洲以及其他洲政界、工商界和学术界领袖商讨亚洲及全球关键问题的高层次对话平台（high-level dialogue platform）。在新的历史时期，博鳌亚洲论坛将继续为亚洲及世界和平、繁荣与可持续发展做出积极贡献。

Unit project

Raising college students' consciousness of conserving energy and food

This unit is about energy and food crises. Its purpose is to help us understand the world's energy and food situations, and urge us to find effective solutions to the problems. As a college student, not only should you conserve energy and food yourself, but also you should take the responsibility to help increase other people's consciousness of conserving energy and food.

In this unit project, you will work in groups of four or five on either of the following topics: energy conservation and food conservation.

Topic 1 **If you choose the "energy conservation" topic, you can follow the steps here:**

1 Each of you first take some pictures on campus to show places where electricity is often wasted.
2 Group members gather together to look at the pictures. Make a list of the places where electricity is often wasted.
3 Group members work together to create a poster, showing students the importance of saving energy, and giving them brief tips on how to save energy in their daily lives. Try to make your poster as impressive and creative as possible.
4 Put up your poster wherever you think is appropriate on campus.
5 Report to the class what you have done, using necessary visual aids.

Topic 2 **If you choose the "food conservation" topic, here are the steps to follow:**

1 Each of you interview a few students on campus and ask them whether they sometimes waste food and what causes them to waste food. Take notes when conducting the interview.
2 Group members gather together to report on the interviews, focusing on the reasons why students sometimes waste food.
3 Group members work together to write a survey report, using the information you have gathered.
4 Give a presentation in class, using necessary visual aids. Report to your classmates what you have found as a group, especially the reasons why students waste food. Persuade them not to waste food, and suggest how to avoid wasting food.